# Principled Learning-to-Communicate with Quasi-Classical Information Structures

Xiangyu Liu[†] Haoyi You[†] Kaiqing Zhang[†]

**Abstract**

Learning-to-communicate (LTC) in partially observable environments has received increasing attention in deep multi-agent reinforcement learning, where the control and communication strategies are jointly learned. Meanwhile, the impact of communication on decision-making has been extensively studied in control theory. In this paper, we seek to formalize and better understand LTC by bridging these two lines of work, through the lens of *information structures* (ISs). To this end, we formalize LTC in decentralized partially observable Markov decision processes (Dec-POMDPs) under the common-information-based framework from decentralized stochastic control, and classify LTC problems based on the ISs before (additional) information sharing. We first show that non-classical LTCs are computationally intractable in general, and thus focus on quasi-classical (QC) LTCs. We then propose a series of conditions for QC LTCs, under which LTC preserves the QC IS after information sharing, whereas violating them can cause computational hardness in general. Further, we develop provable planning and learning algorithms for QC LTCs, and establish quasi-polynomial time and sample complexities for several QC LTC examples that satisfy the above conditions. Along the way, we also establish new results on a relationship between (strictly) QC IS and the condition of having strategy-independent common-information-based beliefs (SI-CIBs), as well as on solving Dec-POMDPs without computationally intractable oracles but beyond those with SI-CIBs, which may be of independent interest.

## I. Introduction

The learning-to-communicate (LTC) problem has emerged and gained traction in the area of (deep) multi-agent reinforcement learning (MARL) [1, 2, 3]. Unlike classical MARL, which aims to learn *control* strategies that maximize the expected accumulated rewards, LTC seeks to *jointly* optimize over both the *control* and the *communication* strategies of all the agents, as a way to mitigate the challenges due to the agents' partial observability of the environment. Despite the promising empirical successes, theoretical understanding of LTC remains largely underexplored.

On the other hand, in control theory, a rich literature has investigated the role of *communication* in decentralized/networked control [4, 5, 6, 7], inspiring us to rigorously examine LTC from such a principled perspective. Most of these studies, however, focused on linear systems, and did not explore the computational or sample complexity guarantees when the system model is not (fully) known. More recently, a few studies [8, 9] explored the settings with general discrete (non-linear) spaces, under special communication protocols and state transition dynamics (see §I-A for more detailed discussions).

[†]The authors are ordered alphabetically, and are affiliated with the University of Maryland, College Park, MD, USA, 20742. Emails: {xyliu999, yuriiyou, kaiqing}@umd.edu.

More broadly, the design of communication strategies dictates the *information structure* (IS) of the control system, which characterizes *who knows what and when* [10]. IS and its impact on the *optimization tractability*, especially for linear systems, have been extensively studied in (decentralized) stochastic control, see [11, 12] for comprehensive overviews. In this work, we seek a more principled understanding of LTC through the lens of information structures, with a focus on the computational and sample complexities of the problem.

Specifically, we formalize LTC in the general framework of decentralized partially observable Markov decision processes (Dec-POMDPs) [13], as in the empirical studies [1, 2, 3]. To achieve finite-time and sample complexity guarantees, we resort to the recent development in [14] on partially observable MARL, based on the common-information-based (CIB) framework [15, 16] from decentralized stochastic control, to model the communication and information sharing protocols among agents. We detail our contributions as follows.

**Contributions.** (i) We formalize learning-to-communicate in Dec-POMDPs under the common-information-based framework [15, 16, 14], allowing the sharing of *historical* information, and the modeling of communication costs. (ii) We classify LTCs through the lens of *information structures*, according to the ISs before (additional) information sharing, i.e., under the *baseline* sharing. We then show that LTCs with *non-classical* [11] IS of the baseline sharing can be computationally intractable in general. (iii) Given the hardness, we thus focus on *quasi-classical* (QC) LTCs, and propose a series of conditions under which LTC preserves the QC IS after (additional) information sharing, whereas violating them can cause computational hardness in general. (iv) We propose both planning and learning algorithms for QC LTCs, by converting them to Dec-POMDPs with *strategy-independent common-information-based beliefs* (SI-CIBs) [16], a condition shown to be critical for tractable computation and learning [14]. (v) Quasi-polynomial time and sample complexities of the algorithms are established for several QC LTC examples that satisfy the conditions in (iii). Along the way, we also establish new results on a relationship between *(strictly) quasi-classical* ((s)QC) ISs and the SI-CIB condition in the framework of [16], as well as solving general Dec-POMDPs without computationally intractable oracles but beyond those with SI-CIBs, which thus advances the results in [14]. These results may be of independent interest for studying general Dec-POMDPs. We conclude with some experimental results to validate the implementability and effectiveness of our algorithms.

### I-A Related Work

**Communication-control joint optimization.** The joint design of control and communication strategies has been well-studied in the control theory literature [6, 17, 18, 19, 7, 8, 9]. However, even with model knowledge, the computational complexity (and associated necessary conditions) of solving many of these models remains elusive, let alone the sample complexity when it comes to learning. Moreover, these models mostly have special structures, e.g., with linear systems [20, 7] and sometimes specific, fixed communication strategies (e.g., the event-triggered ones) [6, 17, 19, 7], or sharing only instantaneous observations [8, 9].

**Information sharing and information structures.** Information structure has been extensively studied to characterize *who knows what and when* in (decentralized) stochastic control [11, 12]. Our paper aims to formally understand LTC through the lens of information structures. The common-information-based approach to formalize information sharing in [15, 16] serves as the basis for our

work. In comparison, these results did not *optimize* or *learn* to share the information, and focused on the *structural results*, without concrete computational (and sample) complexity analysis.

**Partially observable MARL theory.** Planning and learning in partially observable MARL are known to be hard in general [21, 22, 23, 13]. Recently, [24, 25] developed polynomial-sample complexity algorithms for partially observable stochastic games, but with computationally intractable oracles; [14] developed quasi-polynomial-time and sample algorithms for such models, leveraging information sharing among the agents. In contrast, our paper focuses on *optimizing/learning to share*, together with control strategy optimization/learning.

# II. Preliminaries

**Notation.** We use $\mathbb{N}, \mathbb{Q}, \mathbb{R}$ to denote the sets of all the natural, rational, and real numbers, respectively. For an integer $m > 0$, we denote $[m] := \{1, 2, \cdots, m\}$. For a finite set $\mathcal{X}$, we use $|\mathcal{X}|$ to denote the cardinality of $\mathcal{X}$, and use $\Delta(\mathcal{X})$ to denote the probability simplex over $\mathcal{X}$. By a slight abuse of notation, we use small letters to denote both the random variables and their realizations, when it is clear from the context. In particular, this simplifies the notation as terms like $\mathbb{P}(s_h, p_h | c_h)$ may be either viewed as the numerical values with realizations $s_h, p_h, c_h$, or as a distribution-valued random variable $\mathbb{P}(s_h = \cdot, p_h = \cdot | c_h)$. For a random variable $x$, we use $\sigma(x)$ to denote the sigma-algebra generated by $x$. For $\sigma$-algebras $\mathscr{F}_1$ on the space $\mathcal{X}_1$ and $\mathscr{F}_2$ on the space $\mathcal{X}_2$, we denote by $\mathscr{F}_1 \otimes \mathscr{F}_2$ the product $\sigma$-algebra on the space $\mathcal{X}_1 \times \mathcal{X}_2$. We use $\mathbb{1}[]$ to denote the indicator function. Unless otherwise noted, the set $\{\}$ considered is ordered, such that the elements in the set are indexed.

## II-A Learning-to-Communicate Formulation

For $n > 1$ agents, a (cooperative) *learning-to-communicate* problem can be described by the components in a tuple $\mathcal{L} = \langle H, \mathcal{S}, \{\mathcal{A}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n],h\in[H]}, \{\mathcal{O}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n],h\in[H]}, \{\mathcal{M}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n],h\in[H]}, \mathbb{T}, \mathbb{O}, \mu_1, \{\mathcal{R}_h\}_{h\in[H]}, \{\mathcal{K}_h\}_{h\in[H]}\rangle$, where $H$ denotes the length of each episode, and other components are introduced as follows.

### II-A-1 Decision-making components

We use $\mathcal{S}$ to denote the state space, and $\mathcal{A}_{i,h}$ to denote the control action space of agent $i$ at timestep $h \in [H]$. We denote by $s_h \in \mathcal{S}$ the state and by $a_{i,h}$ the control action of agent $i$ at timestep $h$. We use $a_h := (a_{1,h}, \cdots, a_{n,h}) \in \mathcal{A}_h := \prod_{i\in[n]} \mathcal{A}_{i,h}$ to denote the joint control action of all the $n$ agents at timestep $h$. We denote by $\mathbb{T} = \{\mathbb{T}_h\}_{h\in[H]}$ the collection of state transition kernels, where $s_{h+1} \sim \mathbb{T}_h(\cdot | s_h, a_h) \in \Delta(\mathcal{S})$ at timestep $h$. We use $\mu_1 \in \Delta(\mathcal{S})$ to denote the initial state distribution. We denote by $\mathcal{O}_{i,h}$ the observation space and by $o_{i,h} \in \mathcal{O}_{i,h}$ the observation of agent $i$ at timestep $h$. We use $o_h := (o_{1,h}, o_{2,h}, \cdots, o_{n,h}) \in \mathcal{O}_h := \prod_{i\in[n]} \mathcal{O}_{i,h}$ to denote the joint observation of all the $n$ agents at timestep $h$. We use $\mathbb{O} = \{\mathbb{O}_h\}_{h\in[H]}$ to denote the collection of emission functions, where $o_h \sim \mathbb{O}_h(\cdot | s_h) \in \Delta(\mathcal{O}_h)$ at timestep $h$ and state $s_h \in \mathcal{S}$. Also, for each $s_h \in \mathcal{S}$, we denote by $\mathbb{O}_{i,h}(\cdot | s_h)$ the emission for agent $i$, the marginal distribution of $o_{i,h}$ given $\mathbb{O}_h(\cdot | s_h)$. At each timestep $h$, agents will receive a common reward $r_h = \mathcal{R}_h(s_h, a_h)$, where $\mathcal{R}_h : \mathcal{S} \times \mathcal{A}_h \to [0, 1]$ denotes the reward function shared by the agents.

### II-A-2 Communication components

In addition to reward-driven decision-making, agents also need to decide and learn *(what) to communicate with others*. At timestep $h$, agents share part of their information $z_h \in \mathcal{Z}_h$ with other agents,

where $\mathcal{Z}_h$ denotes the collection of all possible shared information at timestep $h$. Here we consider a general setting where the shared information $z_h$ may contain two parts, a *baseline-sharing* part $z_h^{\mathrm{b}}$ that comes from some existing sharing protocol among agents, and an *additional-sharing* part $z_{i,h}^{\mathrm{a}}$ for each agent $i$ that comes from explicit communication *to be decided/learned*, with the joint additional-sharing information $z_h^{\mathrm{a}} := \cup_{i=1}^n z_{i,h}^{\mathrm{a}}$. This general setting covers those considered in most empirical studies on LTC [1, 2, 3], with no baseline sharing. We kept the baseline sharing since our focus is on the *finite-time* and *sample* tractability of LTC, for which a certain amount of information sharing is known to be necessary [14]. Note that $z_h = z_h^{\mathrm{b}} \cup z_h^{\mathrm{a}}$ and $z_h^{\mathrm{b}} \cap z_h^{\mathrm{a}} = \emptyset$. The shared information is part of the historical observations and (both *control* and *communication*) actions. We denote by $\mathcal{Z}_h^{\mathrm{b}}, \mathcal{Z}_h^{\mathrm{a}}$, and $\mathcal{Z}_{i,h}^{\mathrm{a}}$ the collections of all possible $z_h^{\mathrm{b}}$, $z_h^{\mathrm{a}}$, and $z_{i,h}^{\mathrm{a}}$ at each timestep $h$, respectively.

At timestep $h$, the *common information* among all the agents is thus defined as the union of all the *shared information* so far: $c_{h^-} = \cup_{t=1}^{h-1} z_t \cup z_h^{\mathrm{b}}$, and $c_{h^+} = \cup_{t=1}^{h} z_t$, where $c_{h^-}$ and $c_{h^+}$ denote the (accumulated) common information *before* and *after* additional sharing, respectively. The *private information* of agent $i$ at timestep $h$ *before* and *after* additional sharing are denoted by $p_{i,h^-}$ and $p_{i,h^+}$, respectively, where $p_{i,h^-} \subseteq \{o_{i,1}, a_{i,1}, \cdots, a_{i,h-1}, o_{i,h}\} \backslash c_{h^-}, p_{i,h^+} \subseteq \{o_{i,1}, a_{i,1}, \cdots, a_{i,h-1}, o_{i,h}\} \backslash c_{h^+}$. We denote by $p_{h^-} := (p_{1,h^-}, \cdots, p_{n,h^-})$ and $p_{h^+} := (p_{1,h^+}, \cdots, p_{n,h^+})$ the joint private information before and after additional sharing at timestep $h$, respectively. We then denote by $\tau_{i,h^-} := p_{i,h^-} \cup c_{h^-}$ and $\tau_{i,h^+} := p_{i,h^+} \cup c_{h^+}$ the *information available* to agent $i$ at timestep $h$, before and after additional sharing, respectively, with $\tau_{h^-} := p_{h^-} \cup c_{h^-}, \tau_{h^+} := p_{h^+} \cup c_{h^+}$ denoting the associated joint information. We use $\mathcal{C}_{h^-}, \mathcal{C}_{h^+}, \mathcal{P}_{i,h^-}, \mathcal{P}_{i,h^+}, \mathcal{P}_{h^-}, \mathcal{P}_{h^+}, \mathcal{T}_{i,h^-}, \mathcal{T}_{i,h^+}, \mathcal{T}_{h^-}, \mathcal{T}_{h^+}$ to denote, respectively, the corresponding collections of all possible $c_{h^-}, c_{h^+}, p_{i,h^-}, p_{i,h^+}, p_{h^-}, p_{h^+}, \tau_{i,h^-}, \tau_{i,h^+}, \tau_{h^-}, \tau_{h^+}$.

We use $m_{i,h}$ to denote the *communication action* of agent $i$ at timestep $h$, and it will determine what information $z_{i,h}^{\mathrm{a}}$ she will share, through the way to be specified later. We denote by $\mathcal{M}_{i,h}$ the space of $m_{i,h}$, and by $m_h := (m_{1,h}, \cdots, m_{n,h}) \in \mathcal{M}_h := \prod_{i=1}^n \mathcal{M}_{i,h}$ the joint communication action of all the agents. We denote by $\mathcal{K}_h : \mathcal{Z}_h^{\mathrm{a}} \to [0,1]$ the *communication cost* function and by $\kappa_h = \mathcal{K}_h(z_h^{\mathrm{a}})$ the incurred communication cost at timestep $h$, due to additional sharing.

### II-A-3 System evolution

The system evolves by alternating between the communication and the control steps as follows.

***Communication step:*** At each timestep $h$, each agent $i$ observes $o_{i,h}$ and may share part of her private information via baseline sharing, receives the baseline sharing of information from others, and forms $p_{i,h^-}$ and $c_{h^-}$. Then, each agent $i$ chooses her communication action, which determines the additional sharing of information, receives the additional-sharing of information from others, forms $p_{i,h^+}$ and $c_{h^+}$, and incurs some communication cost $\kappa_h$. Formally, the evolution of information is depicted as follows, which, unless otherwise noted, will be assumed throughout the paper. We follow the convention that any quantity at $h = 0$ is empty/null.

**Assumption II.1** (*Information evolution*)**.** For each $h \in [H]$,

(a) (Baseline sharing). $z_h^{\mathrm{b}} = \chi_h(p_{(h-1)^+}, a_{h-1}, o_h)$ for some fixed transformation $\chi_h$;

(b) (Additional sharing). For each agent $i \in [n], z_{i,h}^{\mathrm{a}} = \phi_{i,h}(p_{i,h^-}, m_{i,h}) \subseteq p_{i,h^-} \cup \{m_{i,h}\}$ for some function $\phi_{i,h}$, given communication action $m_{i,h}$, and $m_{i,h} \in z_{i,h}^{\mathrm{a}}$; and the joint sharing $z_h^{\mathrm{a}}$ is thus generated by $z_h^{\mathrm{a}} = \phi_h(p_{h^-}, m_h)$, for some function $\phi_h$;

(c) (Private information before sharing). For each agent $i \in [n]$, $p_{i,h^-} = \xi_{i,h}(p_{i,(h-1)^+}, a_{i,h-1}, o_{i,h})$ for some fixed transformation $\xi_{i,h}$, and the joint private information thus evolves as $p_{h^-} = \xi_h(p_{(h-1)^+}, a_{h-1}, o_h)$ for some fixed transformation $\xi_h$;

(d) (Private information after sharing). For each agent $i \in [n]$, $p_{i,h^+} = p_{i,h^-} \backslash z^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h}$;

(e) ($(\tau_{i,h^-}, \tau_{i,h^+})$-inclusion). For each agent $i \in [n]$, $\tau_{i,h^-} \subseteq \tau_{i,h^+} \subseteq \tau_{i,(h+1)^-}$, and $o_{i,h} \in \tau_{i,h^-}$.

Note that *fixed transformations* (e.g., $\chi_h$ and $\xi_{i,h}$ above) are not affected by the *realized values* of the random variables, but dictate some *pre-defined* transformation of the input random variables. See [15, 16], and [14] for common examples of baseline sharing that admit such fixed transformations when there is no additional sharing, and examples in §A on how they can be extended to the LTC setting. It should not be confused with some general *function* (e.g., $\phi_{i,h}$ above), which may depend on the *realized values* of the input random variables. (a) and (c) on baseline sharing follow from those in [16, 14]; (b) and (d) on additional sharing dictate how the communication action affects the sharing based on private information. For example, a common choice of $(\mathcal{M}_{i,h}, \phi_{i,h})$ is that $\mathcal{M}_{i,h} = \{0,1\}^{\max_{p_{i,h^-} \in \mathcal{P}_{i,h^-}} |p_{i,h^-}|}$, and for any $p_{i,h^-} \in \mathcal{P}_{i,h^-}$ and $m_{i,h} \in \mathcal{M}_{i,h}$, $\phi_{i,h}(p_{i,h^-}, m_{i,h})$ consists of the $k$-th element (with $k \in [|p_{i,h^-}|]$) of $p_{i,h^-}$ if and only if the $k$-th element of $m_{i,h}$ is 1, while other elements are 0. As $m_{i,h}$ (dictating what to share) will be known given $z^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h}$ (what has been shared), $m_{i,h}$ is thus also modeled as being shared, i.e., $m_{i,h} \in z^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h}$. This is also consistent with the models in [8, 9] on control/communication joint optimization. (e) means that the agent has full memory of the information she had in the past and at present. We emphasize that this is closely related, but different from the common notion of *perfect recall* [26], where the agent has to recall all her own *past actions*. Condition (e), in contrast, relaxes the memorization of the actions, but includes the instantaneous observation $o_{i,h}$. This condition is satisfied by all the models and examples in [11, 15, 16, 14]. See also §A for more examples that satisfy this assumption. Note that $o_{i,h} \in \tau_{i,h^-}$ has been noted necessary in order to have *closed-loop* ISs in the literature [12], which are the focus of the present paper.

Meanwhile, for both the baseline and the additional sharing protocols, we follow the model in the series of studies on partial history/information sharing [15, 16, 14, 8, 9] that, if an agent shares, she will share the information with *all other* agents as *common information*. Additionally, we follow the convention from the literature on information structures [11, 12], by incorporating the $\sigma$-algebra of the random variables. These conventions lead to the following regularity assumption on information sharing, which requires a $\sigma$-algebra version of that any information sharing is shared to all agents. In particular, it implies that: whenever one agent can infer other agents' observation/action, it has to come from explicit *information sharing*, instead of *random variable correlation*.

**Assumption II.2.** $\forall i_1, i_2 \in [n], h_1, h_2 \in [H], i_1 \neq i_2, h_1 < h_2$, if $\sigma(o_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\tau_{i_2,h_2^-})$, then $\sigma(o_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(c_{h_2^-})$, and if $\sigma(a_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\tau_{i_2,h_2^-})$, then $\sigma(a_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(c_{h_2^-})$; if $\sigma(o_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\tau_{i_2,h_2^+})$, then $\sigma(o_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(c_{h_2^+})$, and if $\sigma(a_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\tau_{i_2,h_2^+})$, then $\sigma(a_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(c_{h_2^+})$.

Assumptions II.1-II.2 will be made throughout the paper.

***Decision-making step:*** After the communication, each agent $i$ chooses her control action $a_{i,h}$, receives a reward $r_h$, and the joint action $a_h$ drives the state to $s_{h+1} \sim \mathbb{T}_h(\cdot|s_h, a_h)$.

### II-A-4 Strategies and solution concept

At timestep $h$, each agent $i$ has two strategies, a *control* strategy and a *communication* strategy. We define a control strategy as $g^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h} : \mathcal{T}_{i,h^+} \to \mathcal{A}_{i,h}$ and a communication strategy as $g^{m}_{i,h} : \mathcal{T}_{i,h^-} \to \mathcal{M}_{i,h}$. See

Lemma G.1 for a formal argument on the use of such *deterministic* strategies without loss of optimality. We denote by $g^{\mathrm{a}}_h = (g^{\mathrm{a}}_{1,h}, \cdots, g^{\mathrm{a}}_{n,h})$ the joint control strategy and by $g^m_h = (g^m_{1,h}, \cdots, g^m_{n,h})$ the joint communication strategy. We denote by $\mathcal{G}^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h}, \mathcal{G}^m_{i,h}, \mathcal{G}^{\mathrm{a}}_h, \mathcal{G}^m_h$ the corresponding spaces of $g^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h}, g^m_{i,h}, g^{\mathrm{a}}_h, g^m_h$.

The objective of the agents in LTC is to maximize the expected accumulated sum of the reward and the negative communication cost from timestep $h = 1$ to $H$:

$$J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}, g^m_{1:H}) := \mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{L}}\left[\sum_{h=1}^{H}(r_h - \kappa_h)\,\middle|\, g^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}, g^m_{1:H}\right],$$

where the expectation $\mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{L}}$ is taken over all the randomness in the system evolution, given the strategies $(g^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}, g^m_{1:H})$. With this objective, for any $\epsilon \geq 0$, we can define the solution concept of an *$\epsilon$-team optimum* for $\mathcal{L}$ as follows.

**Definition II.3** ($\epsilon$-team optimum)**.** We call a joint strategy $(g^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}, g^m_{1:H})$ an $\epsilon$-team-optimal strategy of the LTC problem $\mathcal{L}$ if

$$\max_{\widetilde{g}^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H} \in \mathcal{G}^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}, \widetilde{g}^m_{1:H} \in \mathcal{G}^m_{1:H}} J_{\mathcal{L}}(\widetilde{g}^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}, \widetilde{g}^m_{1:H}) - J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}, g^m_{1:H}) \leq \epsilon.$$

## II-B Information Structures of LTC

In decentralized stochastic control, the notion of information structure [27, 11] captures *who knows what and when* as the system evolves. In LTC, as the additional sharing via communication will also affect the IS and is *not* determined *beforehand*, when we discuss the *IS of an LTC problem*, we will refer to that of the problem *with only baseline sharing*. In particular, an LTC $\mathcal{L}$ without additional sharing is essentially a Dec-POMDP (with potential baseline information sharing), as defined in §F for completeness. We formally define such a Dec-POMDP *induced* by $\mathcal{L}$ as follows.

**Definition II.4** (Dec-POMDP (with information sharing) induced by LTC)**.** For an LTC problem $\mathcal{L} = \langle H, \mathcal{S}, \{\mathcal{A}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n],h\in[H]}, \{\mathcal{O}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n],h\in[H]}, \{\mathcal{M}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n],h\in[H]}, \mathbb{T}, \mathbb{O}, \mu_1, \{\mathcal{R}_h\}_{h\in[H]}, \{\mathcal{K}_h\}_{h\in[H]}\rangle$, we call a Dec-POMDP (with information sharing) $\overline{\mathcal{D}}_{\mathcal{L}}$ *the Dec-POMDP (with information sharing) induced by* $\mathcal{L}$, if the agents share information only following the baseline sharing protocol of $\mathcal{L}$, i.e., without additional sharing, which can be characterized by the tuple $\overline{\mathcal{D}}_{\mathcal{L}} := \langle H, \mathcal{S}, \{\mathcal{A}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n],h\in[H]}, \{\mathcal{O}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n],h\in[H]}, \mathbb{T}, \mathbb{O}, \mu_1, \{\mathcal{R}_h\}_{h\in[H]}\rangle$, together with the baseline sharing protocol in Assumption II.1. We may refer to it as the *Dec-POMDP induced by LTC* or the *induced Dec-POMDP* for short.

In §II-A, we introduced LTC in the *state-space model*. In contrast, information structure is oftentimes more conveniently discussed under the equivalent framework of *intrinsic models* [27] (see the instantiation for Dec-POMDPs in §F for completeness). In an intrinsic model, each agent only *acts once* throughout the system evolution, and the same agent in the state-space model at different timesteps is now treated as *different agents*. There are thus $n \times H$ agents in total. Formally, for completeness, we extend the intrinsic-model-based reformulation to LTCs in §F.

(Strictly) quasi-classical ISs are important subclasses of ISs, which were first introduced for decentralized stochastic control [27, 28, 12] (see the instantiation for Dec-POMDPs in §F). An IS that is not QC is called *non-classical* [11, 12]. We extend such a categorization to LTC problems with different ISs as follows.

**Definition II.5** ((Strictly) quasi-classical LTC)**.** We call an LTC $\mathcal{L}$ *(strictly) quasi-classical* if the Dec-POMDP induced by $\mathcal{L}$ (see Definition II.4) is *(strictly) quasi-classical*. Namely, each agent in the intrinsic model of $\overline{\mathcal{D}}_{\mathcal{L}}$ knows the information (and the actions) of the agents who influence her, either directly or indirectly.

Similarly, an LTC $\mathcal{L}$ that is not QC is called *non-classical*. See §A for examples of QC and sQC LTCs. Note that the categorization above is defined based on the ISs *before* additional sharing, as an inherent property of the LTC problem, since additional sharing is the solution *to be* decided/learned. We focus on finding such a solution next.

## III. Hardness and Structural Assumptions

It is known that computing an (approximate) team-optimal strategy in Dec-POMDPs, which are LTCs *without* information-sharing, is NEXP-hard [13] in general. The hardness cannot be fully circumvented even when agents are allowed to share information: even if agents share all the information, the LTC problem becomes a Partially Observable Markov Decision Process (POMDP), which is known to be PSPACE-hard [21, 22]. Hence, additional assumptions are necessary to make LTCs computationally more tractable. We introduce several such assumptions and their justifications below, whose proofs can be found in §B. To make the justifications sharp, each lemma below is presented in a way that only the assumption to be justified is removed, while preserving other assumptions to be introduced later in the section. Each assumption will be introduced in series, following the logic to preserve the benign structures of the LTC problem, for better computational tractability.

Recently, [29] showed that *observable* POMDPs [30], a class of POMDPs with relatively *informative* observations, admit *quasi-polynomial time* algorithms to solve. Such a condition was then extended to Dec-POMDPs with information sharing in [14], which also developed quasi-polynomial time and sample complexity algorithms.

As solving LTCs is at least as hard as solving the Dec-POMDPs considered in [14], we first also make such an observability assumption on the *joint* emission function as in [14], to potentially avoid computationally intractable oracles.

**Assumption III.1** ($\gamma$-observability [30, 29, 14])**.** There exists a $\gamma > 0$ such that $\forall h \in [H]$, the emission $\mathbb{O}_h$ satisfies that $\forall b_1, b_2 \in \Delta(\mathcal{S})$, $\left\|\mathbb{O}_h^\top b_1 - \mathbb{O}_h^\top b_2\right\|_1 \geq \gamma \left\|b_1 - b_2\right\|_1$.

However, we show next that Assumption III.1 is not enough when it comes to LTC, if the baseline sharing IS is not favorable, and in particular, *non-classical* [11]. The hardness persists even under a few additional assumptions to be introduced later that will make LTC more tractable.

**Lemma III.2** (Non-classical LTCs are hard)**.** For non-classical LTCs under Assumptions III.1, III.4, III.5, and III.7, finding an $\frac{\epsilon}{H}$-team-optimal strategy is PSPACE-hard.

Note that the hardness comes from the intuition that, when communication costs are high, the additional sharing from LTC will be limited, preventing the upgrade of the IS from a non-classical one to a (quasi-)classical one, which is hard with only the *joint* observability of the emission (see Assumption III.1), even along with several other assumptions.

By Lemma III.2, we will hence focus on *quasi-classical* LTCs hereafter. Indeed, QC is also known to be critical for efficiently solving *continuous-space* and *linear* decentralized control [31, 32]. However, quasi-classicality may not be sufficient for LTC problems, since the additional sharing may *break* the QC IS, and introduce computational hardness, as argued below.

Firstly, the breaking of QC IS may result from the *communication strategies*. Specifically, the communication strategy space in §II-A-4 allows the dependence on agents' *private information*, which introduces incentives for *signaling* [11] and can also cause computational hardness, as shown next.

**Lemma III.3** (QC LTCs with full-history-dependent communication strategies are hard)**.** For QC LTCs under Assumption III.1, together with Assumptions III.5, and III.7, computing a team-optimal strategy in the general space of $(\mathcal{G}^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}, \mathcal{G}^{m}_{1:H})$ with $\mathcal{G}^{m}_{i,h} := \{g^{m}_{i,h} : \mathcal{T}_{i,h^-} \to \mathcal{M}_{i,h}\}$ is NP-hard.

The hardness in Lemma III.3 originates from the fact that when depending on the private/local information, determining the communication action can be cast as a *Team Decision problem* (TDP) [33], which is known to be hard. This will be the case even when the instantaneous observations are relatively observable (see Assumptions III.1 and III.7).

To avoid this hardness, we thus focus on communication strategies that only condition on the *common information*.

**Assumption III.4** (Common-information-based communication strategy)**.** The communication strategies take *common information* as input, with the following form:

$$\forall i \in [n], h \in [H], \quad g^{m}_{i,h} : \mathcal{C}_{h^-} \to \mathcal{M}_{i,h}. \tag{III.1}$$

Intuitively, this assumption is not unreasonable, as it means that *which historical information to share* is determined by *what has been shared* (in the common information). Note that this does not lose generality in the sense that the private information $p_{i,h^-}$ *can still be shared*. It only means that the communication action is not determined based on $p_{i,h^-}$, and the additional sharing is still dictated by $z^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h} = \phi_{i,h}(p_{i,h^-}, m_{i,h})$ (see Assumption II.1), depending on $p_{i,h^-}$. In particular, since $\phi_{i,h}$ is a general function that may depend on the *realized values* of $p_{i,h^-}$ (see the discussion after Assumption II.1), certain *prescribed* private-information-triggered sharing rules can still be accommodated through $\phi_{i,h}$ even under this assumption. For example, consider an *alarm-reporting* rule with $\mathcal{M}_{i,h} = \{0, 1\}$, where $m_{i,h} = 1$ *enables* the sharing of the private observation $o_{i,h} \in p_{i,h^-}$ only if it falls into a predefined alarm set $\mathcal{E}_{i,h} \subseteq \mathcal{O}_{i,h}$, i.e., $z^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h} = \phi_{i,h}(p_{i,h^-}, m_{i,h}) := \{o_{i,h} \in p_{i,h^-} | m_{i,h} = 1,\ o_{i,h} \in \mathcal{E}_{i,h}\} \cup \{m_{i,h}\}$, where $m_{i,h}$ itself is also included, as required by Assumption II.1 (b). Under such a $\phi_{i,h}$, the additional sharing $z^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h}$ depends on the realization of the private observation $o_{i,h}$, even though the communication action $m_{i,h}$ is determined based only on the common information.

Secondly, the breaking of QC IS may result from the *control strategies*: if some agent did *not* influence others in the baseline sharing (and thus these other agents did *not* have to access the agent's information, while still satisfying QC), while she starts to influence others by *sharing* her (*useless*) *control* actions, this will make her *control strategies* relevant. We make the following two assumptions to avoid the related pessimistic cases, each followed by a computational hardness result when (only) the condition is missing.

Specifically, sometimes the action of some agents may not influence the *state transition*. However, if they were deemed *non-influential*, but shared via additional sharing, then the QC IS may break for LTC. We thus make the following assumption.

**Assumption III.5** (Control-useless action is not used)**.** $\forall i \in [n], h \in [H]$, suppose agent $i$'s action $a_{i,h}$ does not influence the state $s_{h+1}$, namely, $\forall s_h \in \mathcal{S}, a_h \in \mathcal{A}_h, a'_{i,h} \in \mathcal{A}_{i,h}, a'_{i,h} \neq a_{i,h}, \mathbb{T}_h(\cdot|s_h, a_h) = \mathbb{T}_h(\cdot|s_h, (a'_{i,h}, a_{-i,h}))$. Then, $\forall h' > h$, the random variable $a_{i,h} \notin \tau_{h'^-}$ and $a_{i,h} \notin \tau_{h'^+}$.

**Lemma III.6** (QC LTCs without Assumption III.5 are hard)**.** For QC LTCs under Assumptions III.1, III.4, and III.7, finding a team-optimal strategy is still NP-hard.

Note that other than the justification above based on *computational hardness*, Assumption III.5 has also been *implicitly* made in the IS examples in the literature when there are *uncontrolled* state dynamics, see e.g., [16, 14]. Also, we emphasize that for common non-degenerate cases where all agents' actions *do* affect state transition, this assumption is not needed anymore.

Other than not influencing state transition, an action may also be *non-influential* if the emission functions of other agents are *degenerate*: they cannot *sense* the influence from previous agents' actions. We thus make the following assumption on the emissions, followed by a justification result.

**Assumption III.7** (Other agents' emissions are non-degenerate)**.** $\forall h \in [H], i \in [n]$, $\mathbb{O}_{-i,h}$ satisfies that $\forall b_1, b_2 \in \Delta(\mathcal{S})$ such that $b_1 \neq b_2$, $\mathbb{O}_{-i,h}^\top b_1 \neq \mathbb{O}_{-i,h}^\top b_2$, where $\mathbb{O}_{-i,h}$ denotes the joint emission except agent $i$ at timestep $h$.

**Lemma III.8** (QC LTCs without Assumption III.7 are hard)**.** For QC LTCs under Assumptions III.1, III.4, and III.5, finding an $\frac{\epsilon}{H}$-team-optimal strategy is still PSPACE-hard.

We have justified the above assumptions by showing that missing one of them may cause computational intractability of LTCs in general. Hence, Assumptions III.4, III.5, and III.7 will be made hereafter, unless otherwise noted. More importantly, as we will show later, as another justification, LTCs under Assumptions III.4, III.5, and III.7 can indeed *preserve* the QC/sQC information structure *after* additional sharing, making it possible for the overall LTC problem to be computationally more tractable. More examples that satisfy these assumptions can also be found in §A. We also present the following running example, which will be used to illustrate our approach to be introduced in §IV.

**Illustrative Example (State controlled by one controller with asymmetric delayed observation sharing):** The state transition dynamics of $\mathcal{L}$ are controlled by agent 1, i.e., $\forall h \in [H], \mathbb{T}_h(\cdot|s_h, a_{1,h}, a_{-1,h}) = \mathbb{T}_h(\cdot|s_h, a_{1,h}, a'_{-1,h})$ for all $s_h \in \mathcal{S}, a_{1,h} \in \mathcal{A}_{1,h}, a_{-1,h}, a'_{-1,h} \in \mathcal{A}_{-1,h}$. For baseline sharing, agent 1 will share all of her observations immediately, while others will share their information with a delay of $d \geq 1$, i.e., $c_{h^-} = c_{(h-1)^+} \cup \{o_{1,h}, o_{-1,h-d}\}, p_{1,h^-} = \emptyset, p_{i,h^-} = (p_{i,(h-1)^+} \cup \{o_{i,h}\}) \backslash \{o_{i,h-d}\}$. For additional sharing, the communication action spaces are defined as: $\forall h \in [H], i \in [n], \mathcal{M}_{1,h} = \{\emptyset\}, \mathcal{M}_{i,h} := \{0,1\}^d$, and for any $i \neq 1, z^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h} = \phi_{i,h}(p_{i,h^-}, m_{i,h}) := \{o_{i,h-d+k} \in p_{i,h^-} | \forall k \in [d]$, the $k$-th digit of $m_{i,h}$ is 1$\}$. One can verify that the example has a QC IS and satisfies Assumptions II.1 and III.5. We also assume that the emission functions $\{\mathbb{O}_h\}_{h\in[H]}$ satisfy Assumptions II.2, III.1, and III.7. Note that the delay $d \geq 1$ here can be arbitrary (unlike the classical QC-example of *one-step-delayed sharing* [34, 16]), and although the state transition is controlled by agent 1 only, the agents are still coupled in that the non-controller agents can affect the reward, and, more importantly, the information structure, of the team.

# IV. Solving QC LTC Problems Provably

We now study how to solve QC LTC provably, via either *planning* (with model knowledge) or *learning* (without model knowledge). The pipeline of our solution is shown in Figure 1, and proofs of the results can be found in §C.

## IV-A An Equivalent Dec-POMDP

Given any LTC $\mathcal{L}$, we can define a Dec-POMDP $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ characterized by $\langle \widetilde{H}, \widetilde{\mathcal{S}}, \{\widetilde{\mathcal{A}}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n],h\in[\widetilde{H}]}, \{\widetilde{\mathcal{O}}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n],h\in[\widetilde{H}]}, \{\widetilde{\mathbb{T}}_h\}_{h\in[\widetilde{H}]}, \{\widetilde{\mathbb{O}}_h\}_{h\in[\widetilde{H}]}, \widetilde{\mu}_1, \{\widetilde{\mathcal{R}}_h\}_{h\in[\widetilde{H}]}\rangle$, such that these two are

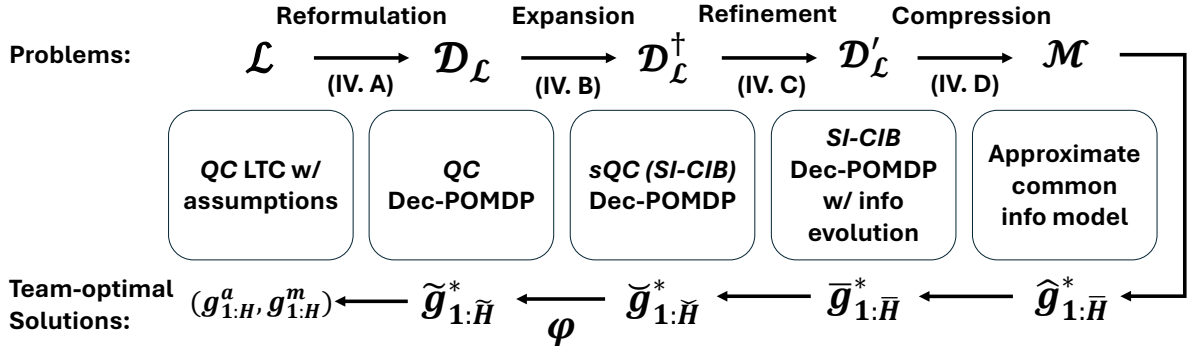



Figure 1: Illustrating the subroutines for solving the LTC problems.

equivalent (under the assumptions in §III):

| Problem | State | | Action | | Observation | | Reward | | Private Info | | Common Info | | Shared Info | | Horizon | Initial Distribution |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| $\mathcal{L}$ | $s_h$ | $s_h$ | $m_{i,h}$ | $a_{i,h}$ | $o_{i,h}$ | $\emptyset$ | $-\mathcal{K}_h$ | $\mathcal{R}_h$ | $\emptyset$ | $p_{i,h^+}$ | $c_{h^-}$ | $c_{h^+}$ | $z_h^{\mathrm{b}}$ | $z_h^{\mathrm{a}}$ | $2H$ | $\mu_1$ |
| $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ | $\widetilde{s}_{2h-1}$ | $\widetilde{s}_{2h}$ | $\widetilde{a}_{i,2h-1}$ | $\widetilde{a}_{i,2h}$ | $\widetilde{o}_{i,2h-1}$ | $\widetilde{o}_{i,2h}$ | $\widetilde{\mathcal{R}}_{2h-1}$ | $\widetilde{\mathcal{R}}_{2h}$ | $\widetilde{p}_{i,2h-1}$ | $\widetilde{p}_{i,2h}$ | $\widetilde{c}_{2h-1}$ | $\widetilde{c}_{2h}$ | $\widetilde{z}_{2h-1}$ | $\widetilde{z}_{2h}$ | $\widetilde{H}$ | $\widetilde{\mu}_1$ |

The transition kernels $\{\widetilde{\mathbb{T}}_h\}_{h\in[\widetilde{H}]}$ and emission functions $\{\widetilde{\mathbb{O}}_h\}_{h\in[\widetilde{H}]}$ can then be defined correspondingly. Note that we follow the convention of $\widetilde{\tau}_{i,h} := \widetilde{p}_{i,h} \cup \widetilde{c}_h$ for any $h \in [\widetilde{H}]$, and at the odd timestep $2t-1$ for any $t \in [H]$, we have $\widetilde{p}_{i,2t-1} = \emptyset$ under Assumption III.4, i.e., in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$, each agent only uses the common information so far for decision-making at timestep $2h-1$. Correspondingly, for any $h \in [\widetilde{H}], i \in [n]$, we denote by $\widetilde{g}_{i,h}, \widetilde{g}_h$ the agent $i$'s strategy and the joint strategy, respectively, and denote by $\widetilde{\mathcal{G}}_{i,h}, \widetilde{\mathcal{G}}_h$ their associated spaces. Moreover, to unify the presentation, we define that $\forall h \in [H]$, $\widetilde{r}_{2h-1} = \widetilde{\mathcal{R}}_{2h-1}(\widetilde{s}_{2h-1}, \widetilde{a}_{2h-1}, p_{2h-1}) := -\mathcal{K}_h(\phi_h(p_{2h-1}, \widetilde{a}_{2h-1}))$, with a slight abuse of notation, where $p_{2h-1} := p_{h^-}$ can be viewed as part of the underlying state. Similarly, we define $\widetilde{r}_{2h} = \widetilde{\mathcal{R}}_{2h}(\widetilde{s}_{2h}, \widetilde{a}_{2h}, p_{2h}) := \mathcal{R}_h(\widetilde{s}_{2h}, \widetilde{a}_{2h})$, where $p_{2h} := p_{h^+}$. Hence, the objective of $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ is defined as $J_{\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\widetilde{g}_{1:\widetilde{H}}) = \mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}}[\sum_{h=1}^{\widetilde{H}} \widetilde{r}_h | \widetilde{g}_{1:\widetilde{H}}]$.

Essentially, this reformulation splits the $H$-step control and communication decision-making procedure into a $2H$-step one. A similar splitting of the timesteps was also used in [8, 9]. In comparison, we consider a more general setting, where the state is not decoupled, and agents are allowed to share the observations and actions at the *previous* timesteps, due to the generality of our LTC formulation. The equivalence between $\mathcal{L}$ and $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ is more formally stated as follows.

**Proposition IV.1** (Equivalence between $\mathcal{L}$ and $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$)**.** Let $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ be the reformulated Dec-POMDP from $\mathcal{L}$ satisfying Assumption III.4, then the solutions of the two problems are equivalent, in the sense that $\forall g_{1:H}^m \in \mathcal{G}_{1:H}^m, g_{1:H}^{\mathrm{a}} \in \mathcal{G}_{1:H}^{\mathrm{a}}, i \in [n]$, let $\widetilde{g}_{1:\widetilde{H}} = (g_1^m, g_1^{\mathrm{a}}, \cdots, g_H^m, g_H^{\mathrm{a}})$, then $J_{\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\widetilde{g}_{1:\widetilde{H}}) = J_{\mathcal{L}}(g_{1:H}^{\mathrm{a}}, g_{1:H}^m)$. Also, $\forall \widetilde{g}_{1:\widetilde{H}} \in \widetilde{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\widetilde{H}}$, let $g_{1:H}^m = (\widetilde{g}_1, \widetilde{g}_3, \cdots, \widetilde{g}_{\widetilde{H}-1}), g_{1:H}^{\mathrm{a}} = (\widetilde{g}_2, \widetilde{g}_4, \cdots, \widetilde{g}_{\widetilde{H}})$, then $J_{\mathcal{L}}(g_{1:H}^{\mathrm{a}}, g_{1:H}^m) = J_{\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\widetilde{g}_{1:\widetilde{H}})$.

Moreover, the Dec-POMDP $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ preserves the QC information structure of $\mathcal{L}$, as shown next.

**Theorem IV.2** (Preserving (s)QC)**.** If $\mathcal{L}$ is (s)QC, then the reformulated Dec-POMDP $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ is also (s)QC.

Proofs of Proposition IV.1 and Theorem IV.2 can be found in §C-A and §C-B, respectively. By Proposition IV.1, it suffices to solve the reformulated $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ that is QC/sQC, which is our focus next.

## IV-B Strict Expansion of $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$

However, being QC does not necessarily imply $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ can be solved *without* computationally intractable oracles. Note that this is different from the continuous-space, linear quadratic case, where QC problems can be reformulated and solved efficiently [31, 32]. With nonlinear, discrete spaces, the recent results in [14] established a concrete *quasi-polynomial*-time complexity for planning, under the *strategy independence* assumption [16] on the common-information-based beliefs [15, 16]. This SI-CIB assumption was shown critical for *computational tractability* [14]: it eliminates the need to *enumerate* the past strategies in dynamic programming, which would otherwise be prohibitively large. Thus, we may need to connect QC IS to the SI-CIB condition for better computational tractability.

Interestingly, under certain conditions, one can connect these two conditions for the reformulated Dec-POMDP $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$. As the first step, we will *expand* the QC $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ by adding the *actions* of the agents who influence the later agents in the intrinsic model of $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ to the shared information. We denote the strictly expanded Dec-POMDP as $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$. We replace the $\widetilde{\ }$ notation in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ by the $\breve{\ }$ notation in $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$. All the elements remain the same, except the set of common information $\breve{c}_h$: for any $h \in [\widetilde{H}]$

$$\breve{c}_h = \widetilde{c}_h \cup \left\{ \widetilde{a}_{j,t} \,\middle|\, j \in [n], t < h, \sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{j,t}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{c}_h), \widetilde{a}_{j,t} \text{ influences } \widetilde{s}_{t+1} \right\}, \tag{IV.1}$$

and we follow the convention to define $\breve{\tau}_{i,h} := \breve{p}_{i,h} \cup \breve{c}_h$ and $\breve{z}_h = \breve{c}_h \backslash \breve{c}_{h-1}$. It is not hard to verify the following.

**Lemma IV.3.** If $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ is QC, then $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$ is sQC.

In contrast to the reformulation in §IV-A, the expansion here cannot guarantee the *equivalence* between $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ and $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$: the strategy spaces of $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$ are larger than those of $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$, as each agent can now access more information, i.e., $\widetilde{\tau}_{i,h} \subseteq \breve{\tau}_{i,h}$. Fortunately, the team-optimal value and strategy of both Dec-POMDPs are related, as shown in the following theorem.

**Theorem IV.4.** Let $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ be the QC Dec-POMDP reformulated from a QC LTC $\mathcal{L}$, and $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$ be the sQC expansion of $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$. Then, for any $\epsilon$-team-optimal strategy $\breve{g}^*_{1:\breve{H}}$ of $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$, there exists a function $\varphi$ such that $\widetilde{g}^*_{1:\widetilde{H}} = \varphi(\breve{g}^*_{1:\breve{H}}, \mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}})$ is an $\epsilon$-team-optimal strategy of $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$, with $J_{\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\widetilde{g}^*_{1:\widetilde{H}}) = J_{\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\breve{g}^*_{1:\breve{H}})$.

Theorem IV.4 shows that one can solve the QC $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ by first solving the sQC expansion $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$, and then using an oracle $\varphi$, as tabulated in Algorithm 3, to translate the solution back as a solution in the strategy spaces of $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$, without loss of optimality. Importantly, we also show in Algorithm 4 how to implement such a $\varphi$ function efficiently.

As shown below, a benefit of obtaining an *sQC* $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$ is that it also has *SI-CIBs*, making it possible to be solved without computationally intractable oracles as in [14].

**Theorem IV.5.** Let $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$ be an sQC Dec-POMDP generated from $\mathcal{L}$ after reformulation and strict expansion, then $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$ has *strategy-independent common-information-based beliefs* [16, 14]. More formally, for any $h \in [\breve{H}]$, any two different joint strategies $\breve{g}_{1:h-1}$ and $\breve{g}'_{1:h-1}$, and any common information $\breve{c}_h$ that can be reached under both $\breve{g}_{1:h-1}$ and $\breve{g}'_{1:h-1}$, for any joint private information $\breve{p}_h \in \breve{\mathcal{P}}_h$ and state $\breve{s}_h \in \breve{\mathcal{S}}$, we have

$$\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}}_h(\breve{s}_h, \breve{p}_h \,|\, \breve{c}_h, \breve{g}_{1:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}}_h(\breve{s}_h, \breve{p}_h \,|\, \breve{c}_h, \breve{g}'_{1:h-1}). \tag{IV.2}$$

## IV-C Refinement of $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$

Despite having SI-CIBs, $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$ is still not eligible for applying the results in [14]: the information evolution rules of $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$ break those in [16, 14]. Specifically, due to Assumption III.4, we set

$\widetilde{\tau}_{i,2t-1} = \widetilde{c}_{2t-1}, \widetilde{p}_{i,2t-1} = \emptyset, \forall t \in [H], i \in [n]$ in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$, which violates Assumption 1 in [16, 14]. To address this issue, we propose to further *refine* $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$ to obtain a Dec-POMDP $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$, which satisfies the information evolution rules. We replace the $\breve{}$ notation in $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$ by the $\bar{}$ notation in $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$. The elements in $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ remain the same as those in $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$, except that the private information at odd steps is now refined as: for any $t \in [H], i \in [n], \overline{p}_{i,2t-1} := p_{i,t^-}$, and we define $\overline{\tau}_{i,2t-1} := \overline{p}_{i,2t-1} \cup \overline{c}_{2t-1}$ for any $t \in [H]$. Moreover, we define the reward functions as $\overline{r}_{2t-1} = \overline{\mathcal{R}}_{2t-1}(\overline{s}_{2t-1}, \overline{a}_{2t-1}, \overline{p}_{2t-1}) := -\mathcal{K}_t(\phi_t(\overline{p}_{2t-1}, \overline{a}_{2t-1}))$, and $\overline{r}_{2t} = \overline{\mathcal{R}}_{2t}(\overline{s}_{2t}, \overline{a}_{2t}, \overline{p}_{2t}) := \mathcal{R}_t(\overline{s}_{2t}, \overline{a}_{2t})$, for any $t \in [H]$. The new Dec-POMDP $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ is not equivalent to $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$ in general, since it enlarges the strategy space at odd timesteps. However, if we define new strategy spaces in $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ as $\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{i,2t-1} : \overline{\mathcal{C}}_{2t-1} \to \overline{\mathcal{A}}_{i,2t-1}, \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{i,2t} : \overline{\mathcal{T}}_{i,2t} \to \overline{\mathcal{A}}_{i,2t}$ for each $t \in [H], i \in [n]$, and thus define $\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}$ to be the associated joint strategy space, then solving $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$ is equivalent to finding a *best-in-class* team-optimal strategy of $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ within $\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}$, as shown below.

**Theorem IV.6.** Let $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$ be an sQC Dec-POMDP generated from the strict expansion of a QC $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$, which is generated from the reformulation of a QC $\mathcal{L}$, and let $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ be the refinement of $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$ as introduced above. Then, finding an optimal strategy in $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$ is equivalent to finding an optimal strategy of $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ in the space $\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}$, and $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ satisfies the following information evolution rules: for each $h \in [\overline{H}]$:

$$\overline{c}_h = \overline{c}_{h-1} \cup \overline{z}_h, \;\; \overline{z}_h = \overline{\chi}_h(\overline{p}_{h-1}, \overline{a}_{h-1}, \overline{o}_h) \qquad \text{for each } i \in [n], \;\; \overline{p}_{i,h} = \overline{\xi}_{i,h}(\overline{p}_{i,h-1}, \overline{a}_{i,h-1}, \overline{o}_{i,h}),$$

with some functions $\{\overline{\chi}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}, \{\overline{\xi}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n],h\in[\overline{H}]}$. Furthermore, $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ has SI-CIBs with respect to the strategy space $\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}$, i.e., for any $h \in [\overline{H}], \overline{s}_h \in \overline{\mathcal{S}}, \overline{p}_h \in \overline{\mathcal{P}}_h, \overline{c}_h \in \overline{\mathcal{C}}_h, \overline{g}_{1:h-1}, \overline{g}'_{1:h-1} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:h-1}$ such that $\overline{c}_h$ is reachable under both $\overline{g}_{1:h-1}$ and $\overline{g}'_{1:h-1}$, it holds that

$$\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}_{1:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}'_{1:h-1}). \tag{IV.3}$$

**Illustrative Example:** We now recall our **Illustrative Example** of $\mathcal{L}$ in §III to construct $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$, via reformulation, expansion, and refinement. In expansion, since for any even $h \in [\widetilde{H} - 1]$, the action $\widetilde{a}_{1,h}$ influences $\widetilde{s}_{h+1}$ and $\sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{1,h}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{c}_{h+1})$, we need to add it to the common information. Therefore, the information in $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ evolves as follows:

if $h$ is odd, $\overline{z}_h = \{\overline{a}_{1,h-1}, \overline{o}_{1,h}\} \cup \{\overline{o}_{j,h-d} \in \overline{p}_{j,h-1}, j \in [2:n]\}$, $\quad \overline{p}_{1,h} = \emptyset, \forall i \in [2:n], \overline{p}_{i,h} = \overline{p}_{i,h-1} \cup \{\overline{o}_{i,h}\} \backslash \{\overline{o}_{i,h-d}\}$;
if $h$ is even, $\overline{z}_h = \phi_{\frac{h}{2}}(\overline{p}_{h-1}, \overline{a}_{h-1}), \overline{p}_{1,h} = \emptyset, \quad \forall i \in [2:n], \overline{p}_{i,h} = \overline{p}_{i,h-1} \backslash \phi_{i,\frac{h}{2}}(\overline{p}_{i,h-1}, \overline{a}_{i,h-1})$.

## IV-D Planning in QC LTC with Finite-Time Complexity

Now we focus on solving the Dec-POMDP $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ that has SI-CIBs without computationally intractable oracles, building upon our results in [14]. Given a Dec-POMDP $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ with SI-CIBs, [14] proposed to construct an $(\epsilon_r, \epsilon_z)$-*expected* approximate common-information model $\mathcal{M}$ (as defined in §C) through *finite memory* truncation of the *common information*, when the joint emission of $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ is $\gamma$-observable. Here, $\epsilon_r$ and $\epsilon_z$ denote the approximation errors for rewards and incremental common information, respectively, for which we defer a detailed introduction to §C. The effectiveness of finite-memory truncation of history has also been established for (single-agent) POMDPs in [29, 35, 36, 37].

However, the Dec-POMDP $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ obtained from LTC has two key differences from the general ones considered in [14]. First, $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ does not satisfy the $\gamma$-observability assumption *throughout* the whole

$\overline{H} = 2H$ timesteps. Fortunately, since the emissions at odd steps are still $\gamma$-observable, while those at even steps are unimportant as the states remain *unchanged* from the previous step, similar results of *belief contraction* and the near-optimality of finite-memory truncation of common information as in [14] can still be obtained (i.e., Lemma C.16). the reward functions in $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ can now depend on the *private information* $\overline{p}_h$, in addition to the action $\overline{a}_h$ and the state $\overline{s}_h$. Thanks to the existence of some *consistent* approximate common-information-based beliefs $\{\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},c}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \widehat{c}_h)\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$ (see Definition C.9), which provide the *joint* probability of $\overline{s}_h$ and $\overline{p}_h$ given the approximate common information $\widehat{c}_h$ compressed from $\overline{c}_h$, we can still properly evaluate the rewards in the algorithms of [14]. Hence, we can leverage the approaches in [14] to develop a planning algorithm for QC LTC, which approximates the optimal strategy $\overline{g}^*_{1:\overline{H}}$ by backward induction over the space of $\widehat{c}_h$. See Algorithm 1 for a detailed introduction to the planning algorithm.

Note that in each step of the backward induction (Line 6 in Algorithm 6), a *Team Decision problem* [33] needs to be solved for each $\widehat{c}_h$, which is known to be `NP-hard` in general [33]:

$$\left(\widehat{g}^*_{1,h}(\cdot|\widehat{c}_h, \cdot), \cdots, \widehat{g}^*_{n,h}(\cdot|\widehat{c}_h, \cdot)\right) \leftarrow \operatorname*{argmax}_{\gamma_h} \; Q_h^{*,\mathcal{M}}(\widehat{c}_h, \gamma_h), \tag{IV.4}$$

where the $Q$-value function and the prescription $\gamma_h$ are defined in §C. Hence, to obtain the overall computational tractability, we make the following *one-step* tractability assumption, as in [14].

**Assumption IV.7** (One-step tractability of $\mathcal{M}$)**.** The one-step Team Decision problems induced by $\mathcal{M}$ (i.e., Line 6 in Algorithm 6) can be solved in polynomial time[1] for all $h = 2t$ with $\in [H]$.

Several remarks are in order regarding this assumption. First, it can be viewed as a *minimal* assumption when it comes to computational tractability: even with $H = 1$ and no LTC, one-step TDP requires additional structures in order to be solved efficiently. Second, since the Dec-POMDP here is reformulated from an LTC problem under Assumption III.4, it suffices to only assume one-step tractability for the *control* (i.e., even) steps, since at odd steps, the strategies do not use private information, and the one-step TDP can thus be solved in polynomial time by searching the maximizer given each $\widehat{c}_h$. Third, even without Assumption IV.7, the SI-CIB property of $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ and thus the derivation of *fixed*, *tractable size* dynamic programs to solve $\mathcal{L}$ efficiently still hold. Without such efforts, intractably many TDPs may need to be solved, leaving it less hopeful for computational tractability (even under Assumption IV.7). Finally, such an assumption is satisfied for several classes of Dec-POMDPs with information sharing, see §G-B for more examples. With this assumption, we can obtain a concrete finite-time complexity guarantee for planning in LTCs as follows. Proof of the theorem can be found in §C-H.

**Theorem IV.8.** Given any QC LTC problem $\mathcal{L}$ satisfying Assumptions III.1, III.4, III.5, and III.7, we can construct a Dec-POMDP problem $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ with SI-CIBs such that for any $\epsilon > 0$, any $\epsilon$-team-optimal strategy for $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ can be converted into an $\epsilon$-team-optimal strategy for $\mathcal{L}$, and the following holds. Fix $\epsilon_r, \epsilon_z > 0$, and given any $(\epsilon_r, \epsilon_z)$-expected approximate common-information model $\mathcal{M}$ (see Definition C.7) for $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ that satisfies Assumption IV.7, there exists an algorithm that can compute a $(2\overline{H}\epsilon_r + \overline{H}^2\epsilon_z)$-team-optimal strategy for the original LTC problem $\mathcal{L}$ with time complexity $\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}|\widehat{\mathcal{C}}_h| \cdot \mathtt{poly}(|\overline{\mathcal{S}}|, \max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}|\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h|, \max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}|\overline{\mathcal{P}}_h|, \overline{H})$. In particular, for any fixed $\epsilon > 0$, if $\mathcal{L}$ has a baseline sharing protocol as one of the examples in §A, then Algorithm 1 can find an $\epsilon$-team-optimal strategy for $\mathcal{L}$ in quasi-polynomial time.

[1] By *polynomial time*, we here mean that the time-complexity depends polynomially on the LTC parameters $|\mathcal{S}|, |\mathcal{O}_h|, |\mathcal{A}_h|, |\mathcal{M}_h|, H$.

As sufficient conditions to ensure the construction of such an $\mathcal{M}$ that satisfies Assumption IV.7, as part of the definition, some examples in §A may need additional structural assumptions on the transition dynamics, emission, and reward/cost functions, while some do not. See §A and the proof of Theorem C.12 for more detailed discussions.

**Illustrative Example:** We can compress the common information by finite-memory truncation as shown in Part III, Type 3 of the proof of Theorem IV.8, and construct $\mathcal{M}$ correspondingly. Moreover, if the reward of $\mathcal{L}$ has an additive form, i.e., $\mathcal{R}_h(s_h, a_h) = \sum_{i\in[n]} \mathcal{R}_{i,h}(s_h, a_{i,h}), \forall h \in [H], s_h \in \mathcal{S}, a_h \in \mathcal{A}_h$ for some $\{\mathcal{R}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n]}$, then $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ satisfies the *Turn-based structure* introduced in §G-B and thus $\mathcal{M}$ satisfies Assumption IV.7 based on Lemma G.2. Finally, we can apply Algorithm 1 to obtain an $\epsilon$-optimal strategy of $\mathcal{L}$.

### IV-E LTC with Finite-Time and Sample Complexities

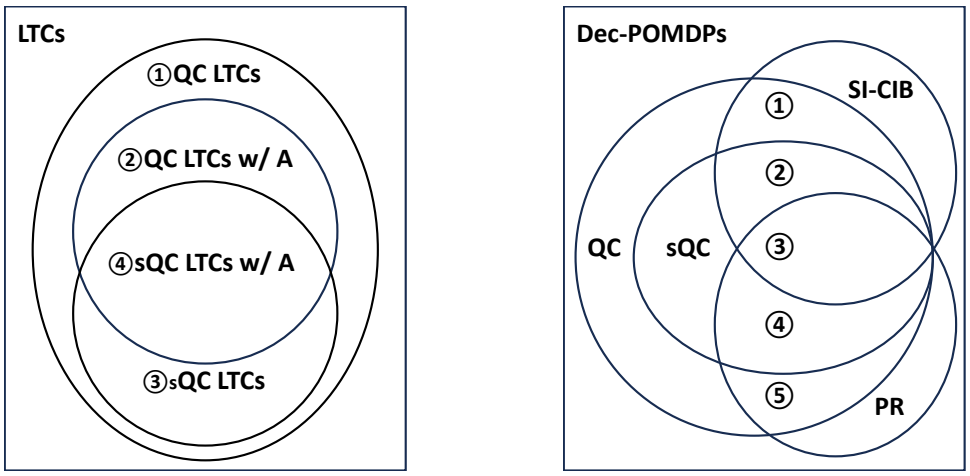
Based on the planning result, we are now ready to solve the *learning* problem with both time and sample complexity guarantees. In particular, we can treat the samples from $\mathcal{L}$ as the samples from $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$: the *reformulation* step (§IV-A) does not change the system dynamics, but only maps the information to different random variables; the *expansion* step (§IV-B) only requires agents to share more actions with each other, without changing the input and output of the environment; the *refinement* step (§IV-C) only recovers the private information the agents had in the original $\mathcal{L}$. This way, we can utilize similar algorithmic ideas in [14] to develop a learning algorithm for LTC problems. See §C for more details of the provable LTC algorithms adapted from [14]. The algorithm has the following finite-time and sample complexity guarantees. Proof of the theorem can be found in §C-I.

**Theorem IV.9.** Given any QC LTC problem $\mathcal{L}$ satisfying Assumptions III.1, III.4, III.5, and III.7, we can construct a Dec-POMDP problem $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ with SI-CIBs. Moreover, given any compression functions of common information, there exists an LTC algorithm (Algorithm 2) that learns in $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$, such that if the learned expected approximate common-information models in the algorithm (Line 7 in Algorithm 2) satisfy Assumption IV.7, then an approximate team-optimal strategy for $\mathcal{L}$ can be learned with high probability, with time and sample complexities polynomial in the parameters of the models. Specifically, if $\mathcal{L}$ has a baseline sharing protocol as one of the examples in §A, then an $\epsilon$-team-optimal strategy for $\mathcal{L}$ can be learned with high probability, with both quasi-polynomial time and sample complexities.

Again, as sufficient conditions to ensure the learned models above to satisfy Assumption IV.7, some examples in §A were defined with additional structural assumptions on the transition, emission, and reward/cost functions, while some need not. See §A and the proof of Theorem C.17 for more detailed discussions.

## V. Solving General QC Dec-POMDPs

In §IV, we developed a pipeline for solving a special class of QC Dec-POMDPs generated by LTCs, by transforming them into those *with SI-CIBs*. In fact, the pipeline can also be extended to solving general QC Dec-POMDPs, which thus advances the results in [14] that can only address Dec-POMDPs with SI-CIBs, a result of independent interest. Without much confusion given the context, we will adopt the notation for LTCs to studying general Dec-POMDPs: we set $h^+ = h^- = h$, remove the additional sharing protocol, and add $^-$ for all the notation in the Dec-POMDP, following that in $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ in §IV. We extend the results in §IV to general Dec-POMDPs as follows.




(a) (b)

Figure 2: (a) Venn diagram of LTCs with different ISs: ① QC LTCs. ② QC LTCs satisfying Assumptions III.4, III.5, and III.7. ③ sQC LTCs. ④ sQC LTCs satisfying Assumptions III.4, III.5, and III.7, which can be converted to Dec-POMDPs with SI-CIBs; (b) Venn diagram of general Dec-POMDPs with different ISs. *PR* denotes *perfect recall*. We construct examples for each area of ①-⑤ in §H.

**Theorem V.1.** Consider a Dec-POMDP $\mathcal{D}$ satisfying Assumption II.1 (e). If $\mathcal{D}$ is sQC and satisfies Assumptions II.2, III.5, and III.7, then it has SI-CIBs. Meanwhile, if $\mathcal{D}$ has SI-CIBs and perfect recall, then it is sQC (up to null sets).

Perfect recall [26] here means that the agents will never forget their own past information and actions (as formally defined in §D for completeness). Note that Assumption II.1 (e) is similar to, but different from, perfect recall: it is implied by the latter with $\overline{o}_{i,h} \in \overline{\tau}_{i,h}$. Also, Assumptions II.2, III.5, and III.7 were originally made for LTCs, and here we meant to impose them for Dec-POMDPs with $h^+ = h^- = h$. Finally, by *sQC up to null sets*, we meant that if agent $(i_1, h_1)$ influences agent $(i_2, h_2)$ in the intrinsic model of the Dec-POMDP $\mathcal{D}$, then under any strategy $\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}$, $\sigma(\overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$ and $\sigma(\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$ except the null sets generated by $\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}$. Given Theorem V.1 and the results in §IV, we can illustrate the relationship between LTCs and Dec-POMDPs with different assumptions and information structures in Figure 2, which may be of independent interest.

By Theorem V.1, one may start with a QC Dec-POMDP (with information sharing) $\mathcal{D}$ that does *not* necessarily have SI-CIBs, and then expand it (as in §IV-B) to obtain an sQC Dec-POMDP $\mathcal{D}'$. If $\mathcal{D}$ satisfies Assumptions II.2, III.5, and III.7, then $\mathcal{D}'$ has SI-CIBs and can then be solved with finite-time and sample complexity guarantees as in [14]. For instance, if $\mathcal{D}$ has an information-sharing protocol as either **Example 7** or **Example 8** in §A, one can verify that it does not have SI-CIBs. However, with the above assumptions, an approximate team-optimal strategy of $\mathcal{D}$ can still be learned with quasi-polynomial sample complexity, and without computationally intractable oracles.

## VI. Experimental Results

In this section, we demonstrate both the practical implementability and performance of our LTC algorithms via numerical experiments, and conduct ablation studies for LTC problems with different communication costs and horizons.

| Horizon/Cost | No Sharing | Cost=0.1 | Cost=0.05 | Cost=0.01 | Fully Sharing |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| H=4 w/ cost | 1.32±0.025 | 1.33±0.044 | 1.44±0.034 | 1.54±0.013 | 1.57±0.004 |
| H=4 w/o cost | - | 1.36±0.032 | 1.48±0.034 | 1.59±0.002 | - |
| H=6 w/ cost | 1.95±0.009 | 1.97±0.07 | 2.08±0.068 | 2.26±0.012 | 2.29±0.002 |
| H=6 w/o cost | - | 2.01±0.047 | 2.14±0.072 | 2.27±0.011 | - |
| H=8 w/ cost | 2.56±0.041 | 2.64±0.078 | 2.74±0.118 | 2.96±0.021 | 3.0±0.002 |
| H=8 w/o cost | - | 2.7±0.044 | 2.83±0.117 | 2.98±0.02 | - |
| H=10 w/ cost | 3.31±0.024 | 3.37±0.135 | 3.51±0.153 | 3.69±0.029 | 3.87±0.007 |
| H=10 w/o cost | - | 3.46±0.069 | 3.63±0.152 | 3.71±0.026 | - |

Table 1: Experimental results for Dectiger with different horizon lengths and cost functions.

| Horizon/Cost | No Sharing | Cost=0.1 | Cost=0.05 | Cost=0.01 | Fully Sharing |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| H=4 w/ cost | 0.14±0.003 | 0.14±0.019 | 0.15±0.002 | 0.26±0.028 | 0.48±0.023 |
| H=4 w/o cost | - | 0.14±0.019 | 0.21±0.007 | 0.33±0.023 | - |
| H=6 w/ cost | 0.33±0.02 | 0.32±0.025 | 0.4±0.009 | 0.48±0.059 | 0.38±0.075 |
| H=6 w/o cost | - | 0.32±0.025 | 0.54±0.02 | 0.62±0.075 | - |
| H=8 w/ cost | 0.52±0.084 | 0.52±0.051 | 0.58±0.072 | 0.67±0.031 | 0.4±0.022 |
| H=8 w/o cost | - | 0.52±0.051 | 0.72±0.035 | 0.82±0.074 | - |
| H=10 w/ cost | 0.73±0.02 | 0.73±0.037 | 0.9±0.169 | 1.03±0.019 | 0.15±0.188 |
| H=10 w/o cost | - | 0.73±0.037 | 1.08±0.14 | 1.25±0.062 | - |

Table 2: Experimental results for Grid3x3 with different horizon lengths and cost functions.

**Environment setup.** We conduct our experiments on two popular and modest-scale partially observable benchmarks, Dectiger [38] and Grid3x3 [39]. We train the agents in each LTC problem in the two environments with 20 different random seeds and different communication cost functions, and execute them in problems with horizons $\{4, 6, 8, 10\}$. To fit the LTC setting considered in our paper, we regularize the rewards to $[0, 1]$, and set the baseline sharing protocol as the one-step delayed information sharing [16, 14]. As for the communication costs, we set $\mathcal{K}_h(z_h^{\mathrm{a}}) = \alpha \cdot |z_h^{\mathrm{a}}|$, and set $\alpha \in \{0.01, 0.05, 0.1\}$ for ablation studies. Also, we consider 2 baseline cases under the same environment with the information structure of one-step delayed information sharing and fully sharing, respectively. The former can be viewed as an LTC problem with extremely high communication cost, thus no additional sharing; the latter corresponds to an LTC problem with no communication cost.

**Results and analysis.** The results of different horizons and communication costs over 20 random seeds are shown in Table 1 and Table 2. Additionally, the attained values are presented in Figure 3, and the learning curves are shown in Figure 4. The results show that communication is beneficial for agents to obtain higher values with better sample efficiency. Also, lower communication costs can encourage agents to share more information, and thereby achieve a better joint strategy in terms of the values attained by the team.

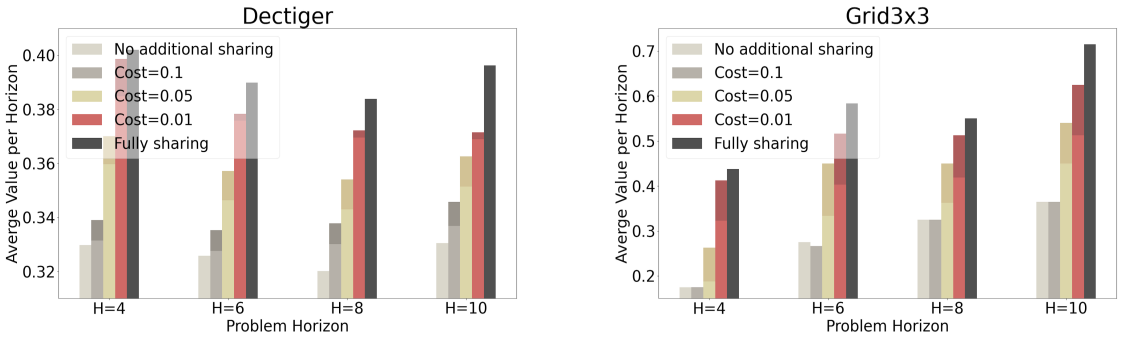



Figure 3: The time-average values achieved under different communication costs and horizons. For each bar, the dark portion and the light portion correspond to the values associated with the communication cost and the overall objective (reward minus cost) of the agents, respectively; the full bar corresponds to the values associated with the reward.

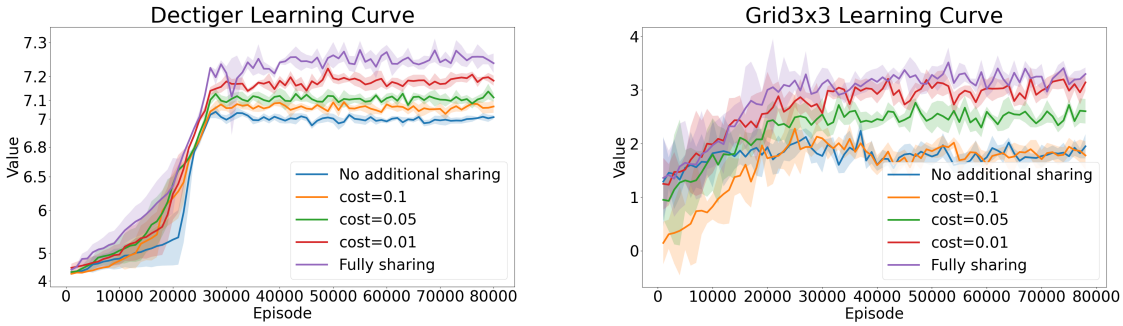



Figure 4: Learning curves, i.e., the values associated with the overall objective (reward minus cost) achieved during learning, under different communication costs.

## VII. Concluding Remarks

We formalized the learning-to-communicate problem under the common-information-based Dec-POMDP framework, and proposed a few structural assumptions for LTCs with quasi-classical information structures, under which LTCs preserve the QC IS after information sharing, whereas violating them can cause computational hardness in general. We then developed provable planning and learning algorithms for QC LTCs. Along the way, we also established a relationship between the strictly quasi-classical information structure and the condition of having strategy-independent common-information-based beliefs, as well as solving general Dec-POMDPs without computationally intractable oracles, beyond those with SI-CIBs. Our work has opened up many future directions, including the formulation, together with the development of provable planning and learning algorithms, of LTC in *non-cooperative* (game-theoretic) settings, and the relaxation of (some of) the structural assumptions when it comes to equilibrium computation.

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# Appendices

## A. Examples of QC LTC Problems

In this section, we introduce 8 examples of QC LTC problems, with 4 of them being extended from the information structures of the baseline sharing protocols considered in the literature [16, 14]. It can be shown that LTC with any of these 8 examples as baseline sharing is QC.

- **Example 1: One-step delayed information sharing.** At timestep $h \in [H]$, agents will share all the action-observation history in the private information until timestep $h-1$. Namely, for any $h \in [H], i \in [n], c_{h^-} = c_{(h-1)^+} \cup \{o_{h-1}, a_{h-1}\}$ and $p_{i,h^-} = \{o_{i,h}\}$.

- **Example 2: State controlled by one controller with asymmetric delayed information sharing.** The state transition dynamics are controlled by only one agent (without loss of generality, agent 1), i.e., $\forall h \in [H], \mathbb{T}_h(\cdot|s_h, a_{1,h}, a_{-1,h}) = \mathbb{T}_h(\cdot|s_h, a_{1,h}, a'_{-1,h})$ for all $s_h \in \mathcal{S}, a_{1,h} \in \mathcal{A}_{1,h}, a_{-1,h}, a'_{-1,h} \in \mathcal{A}_{-1,h}$. Agent 1 will share all of her information immediately, while others will share their information with a delay of $d \geq 1$ timesteps[2] in the baseline sharing. Namely, for any $h \in [H], i \neq 1$, $c_{h^-} = c_{(h-1)^+} \cup \{a_{1,h-1}, o_{1,h}, o_{-1,h-d}\}, p_{1,h^-} = \emptyset, p_{i,h^-} = (p_{i,(h-1)^+} \cup \{o_{i,h}\}) \backslash \{o_{i,h-d}\}$.

- **Example 3: Information sharing with one-directional-one-step-delay.** For convenience, we assume there are 2 agents, and this example can be readily generalized to the multi-agent case. In this case, agent 1 will share the information immediately, while agent 2 will share information with one-step delay. Namely, $c_{1^-} = \{o_{1,1}\}, p_{1,1^-} = \emptyset, p_{2,1^-} = \{o_{2,1}\}$; for any $h \geq 2, c_{h^-} = c_{(h-1)^+} \cup \{o_{1,h}, o_{2,h-1}, a_{h-1}\}, p_{1,h^-} = \emptyset, p_{2,h^-} = \{o_{2,h}\}$.

- **Example 4: Uncontrolled state process.** The state transition dynamics do not depend on the actions of agents, i.e., $\forall h \in [H], \mathbb{T}_h(\cdot|s_h, a_h) = \mathbb{T}_h(\cdot|s_h, a'_h)$ for any $s_h \in \mathcal{S}, a_h, a'_h \in \mathcal{A}_h$. All agents will share their information with a delay of $d \geq 1$ timesteps. For any $h \in [H], i \in [n]$, $c_{h^-} = c_{(h-1)^+} \cup \{o_{h-d}\}, p_{i,h^-} = (p_{i,(h-1)^+} \cup \{o_{i,h}\}) \backslash \{o_{i,h-d}\}$.

- **Example 5: One-step delayed observation sharing.** At timestep $h \in [H]$, each agent has access to the observations of all agents until timestep $h-1$ and her present observation. Namely, for any $h \in [H], i \in [n], c_{h^-} = c_{(h-1)^+} \cup \{o_{h-1}\}$ and $p_{i,h^-} = \{o_{i,h}\}$.

- **Example 6: One-step delayed observation and two-step delayed action sharing.** At timestep $h \in [H]$, each agent will share the observation history until timestep $h-1$ and action history until timestep $h-2$ from the private information. Namely, for any $h \in [H], i \in [n], c_{h^-} = c_{(h-1)^+} \cup \{o_{h-1}, a_{h-2}\}, p_{i,h^-} = \{o_{i,h}, a_{i,h-1}\}$.

- **Example 7: State controlled by one controller with asymmetric delayed observation sharing.** The state transition dynamics are controlled by only one agent (i.e., the same as **Example 2**). Agent 1 will share all of her observations immediately, while others will share their observations with a delay of $d \geq 1$ timesteps. Namely, for any $h \in [H], i \neq 1, c_{h^-} = c_{(h-1)^+} \cup \{o_{1,h}, o_{-1,h-d}\}, p_{1,h^-} = \emptyset, p_{i,h^-} = (p_{i,(h-1)^+} \cup \{o_{i,h}\}) \backslash \{o_{i,h-d}\}$.

[2] Throughout this paper, we view the delay $d$ as a *constant*, although our final bounds in §IV-D and §IV-E also apply for $d = \text{poly}\log H$. See the proofs in §C for more discussions.

- **Example 8: State controlled by one controller with asymmetric delayed observation and two-step delayed action sharing.** The state transition dynamics are controlled by only one agent (i.e., the same as **Example 2**). At timestep $h \in [H]$, agent 1 will share all of her observations immediately and her action history until timestep $h-2$, while others will share their observations with a delay of $d \geq 1$ timesteps. Namely, for any $h \in [H], i \neq 1, c_{h^-} = c_{(h-1)^+} \cup \{o_{1,h}, a_{1,h-2}, o_{-1,h-d}\}, p_{1,h^-} = \{a_{1,h-1}\}, p_{i,h^-} = (p_{i,(h-1)^+} \cup \{o_{i,h}\}) \backslash \{o_{i,h-d}\}$.

- For computational consideration (i.e., when it comes to §IV), we may need additional conditions as part of the examples' definitions:

  - **Examples 2, 4, 7, 8:** for any $h \in [H]$, the reward function $\mathcal{R}_h$ has an additive form, i.e., $\mathcal{R}_h(s_h, a_h) = \sum_{i=1}^n \mathcal{R}_{i,h}(s_h, a_{i,h})$.
  - **Examples 1, 5, 6:** either one of the following conditions holds:
    1. For any $h \in [H]$, the state $s_h$ can be controlled by one agent $ct(h)$, i.e., $\mathbb{T}_h : \mathcal{S} \times \mathcal{A}_{ct(h),h} \to \Delta(\mathcal{S})$. Furthermore, the reward function has an additive form, i.e., $\mathcal{R}_h(s_h, a_h) = \sum_{i=1}^n \mathcal{R}_{i,h}(s_h, a_{i,h})$, and the increment of the common information satisfies $z^{\mathrm{b}}_{h+1} = \chi_{h+1}(p_{h^+}, a_{ct(h),h}, o_{h+1})$;
    2. For any $h \in [H]$, the state $s_h$ can be partitioned into $n$ local states as $s_h = (s_{1,h}, s_{2,h}, \cdots, s_{n,h})$, and the transition kernel and observation emission have the factorized forms of $\mathbb{T}_h(s_{h+1} | s_h, a_h) = \prod_{i=1}^n \mathbb{T}_{i,h}(s_{i,h+1} | s_{i,h}, a_{i,h}), \mathbb{O}_h(o_h | s_h) = \prod_{i=1}^n \mathbb{O}_{i,h}(o_{i,h} | s_{i,h})$. Furthermore, the communication cost and reward functions can be decoupled as $\mathcal{K}_h(z^{\mathrm{a}}_h) = \sum_{i=1}^n \mathcal{K}_{i,h}(z^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h}), \mathcal{R}_h(s_h, a_h) = \sum_{i=1}^n \mathcal{R}_{i,h}(s_{i,h}, a_{i,h})$;
    3. This condition is only applicable to **Examples 1** and **5**. For any $h \in [H]$, the emission $\mathbb{O}_h$ satisfies that: $\forall i < j \leq n, o_{j,h} \in \mathcal{O}_{j,h}, \exists o_{i,h} \in \mathcal{O}_{i,h}$ such that $\forall s_h \in \mathcal{S}, \mathbb{O}_{\{i,j\},h}(o_{i,h}, o_{j,h} | s_h) = \mathbb{O}_{j,h}(o_{j,h} | s_h)$, where $\mathbb{O}_{\{i,j\},h}$ is the marginalized distribution of $\mathbb{O}_h$ with respect to agents $i$ and $j$.
  - **Example 3:** we do not need any additional condition.

**Remark A.1.** The additional conditions on $\mathbb{T}_h, \mathbb{O}_h, \mathcal{K}_h, \mathcal{R}_h$ are *sufficient conditions* to ensure the one-step tractability of the backward induction when solving the LTC problem (see Assumption IV.7). Note that the (s)QC information structures of these examples are unchanged even without these additional structural conditions. See the proofs in §C for more details.

In fact, the first 4 examples are all sQC LTC problems, while the other 4 examples are QC but may not be sQC problems, as shown in the following lemma.

**Lemma A.2.** Given an LTC problem $\mathcal{L}$. If the baseline sharing of $\mathcal{L}$ is one of the first 4 examples above, then $\mathcal{L}$ is sQC. If the baseline sharing of $\mathcal{L}$ is one of the last 4 examples above, then $\mathcal{L}$ is QC but may not be sQC.

*Proof.* Let $\overline{\mathcal{D}}_{\mathcal{L}}$ denote the Dec-POMDP induced by $\mathcal{L}$ (see Definition II.4). We prove this lemma case by case. For convenience, we use $\check{}$ for the notation of the variables/quantities in $\overline{\mathcal{D}}_{\mathcal{L}}$.

- **Example 1:** The information in $\overline{\mathcal{D}}_{\mathcal{L}}$ evolves as $\forall h \in [H], i \in [n], \check{c}_h = \{\check{o}_{1:h-1}, \check{a}_{1:h-1}\}$ and $\check{p}_{i,h} = \{\check{o}_{i,h}\}$. Then, for any $i_1, i_2 \in [n], h_1, h_2 \in [H], h_1 < h_2$, $\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} = \{\check{o}_{1:h_1-1}, \check{a}_{1:h_1-1}, \check{o}_{i_1,h_1}\} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_1+1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_2} \subseteq \check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}$, and $\check{a}_{i_1,h_1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_1+1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_2} \subseteq \check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}$. Therefore, we have $\sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$, and thus $\mathcal{L}$ is sQC.

- **Example 2:** The information in $\overline{\mathcal{D}}_{\mathcal{L}}$ evolves as $\forall h \in [H], i \neq 1, \check{c}_h = \{\check{a}_{1,1:h-1}, \check{o}_{1,1:h-1}, \check{o}_{-1,1:h-d}\}, \check{p}_{1,h} = \emptyset, \check{p}_{i,h} = \{o_{i,h-d+1:h}\}$. Then, for any $i_1, i_2 \in [n], h_1, h_2 \in [H], h_1 < h_2$. If $i_1 \neq 1$, then agent $(i_1, h_1)$ will not influence agent $(i_2, h_2)$. If $i_1 = 1$, then $\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} = \{\check{o}_{1,1:h_1}, \check{a}_{1,1:h_1-1}, \check{o}_{-1,1:h_1-d}\} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_1+1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_2} \subseteq \check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}$, and $\check{a}_{i_1,h_1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_1+1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_2} \subseteq \check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}$. Therefore, we have $\sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$ if agent $(i_1, h_1)$ influences agent $(i_2, h_2)$, and thus $\mathcal{L}$ is sQC.

- **Example 3:** The information in $\overline{\mathcal{D}}_{\mathcal{L}}$ evolves as $\forall h \in [H], \check{c}_h = \{\check{o}_{1:h-1}, \check{a}_{1:h-1}, \check{o}_{1,h}\}$ and $\check{p}_{1,h} = \emptyset, \check{p}_{2,h} = \{\check{o}_{2,h}\}$. Then, for any $i_1, i_2 \in [n], h_1, h_2 \in [H], h_1 < h_2$, $\check{a}_{i_1,h_1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_1+1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_2} \subseteq \check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}$. If $i_1 = 1$, then $\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} = \{\check{o}_{1:h_1-1}, \check{a}_{1:h_1-1}, \check{o}_{1,h_1}\} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_1+1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_2} \subseteq \check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}$. If $i_1 = 2$, then $\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} = \{\check{o}_{1:h_1}, \check{a}_{1:h_1-1}\} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_1+1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_2} \subseteq \check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}$. Therefore, we have $\sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$, and thus $\mathcal{L}$ is sQC.

- **Example 4:** Since in $\overline{\mathcal{D}}_{\mathcal{L}}$, for any $i_1, i_2 \in [n], h_1, h_2 \in [H]$, agent $(i_1, h_1)$ does not influence agent $(i_2, h_2)$, then $\mathcal{L}$ is sQC.

- **Example 5:** The information in $\overline{\mathcal{D}}_{\mathcal{L}}$ evolves as $\forall h \in [H], i \in [n], \check{c}_h = \{\check{o}_{1:h-1}\}$ and $\check{p}_{i,h} = \{\check{o}_{i,h}\}$. Then, for any $i_1, i_2 \in [n], h_1, h_2 \in [H], h_1 < h_2$, $\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} = \{\check{o}_{1:h_1-1}, \check{o}_{i_1,h_1}\} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_1+1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_2} \subseteq \check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}$. Hence, $\mathcal{L}$ is QC. However, for any $i_1, i_2 \in [n], h_1 < h_2 \leq H$, agent $(i_1, h_1)$ may influence agent $(i_2, h_2)$ but $\sigma(\check{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \nsubseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$. Hence, $\mathcal{L}$ may not be sQC.

- **Example 6:** The information in $\overline{\mathcal{D}}_{\mathcal{L}}$ evolves as $\forall h \in [H], i \in [n], \check{c}_h = \{\check{o}_{1:h-1}, \check{a}_{1:h-2}\}$ and $\check{p}_{i,h} = \{\check{o}_{i,h}, \check{a}_{i,h-1}\}$. Then, for any $i_1, i_2 \in [n], h_1, h_2 \in [H], h_1 < h_2$, $\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} = \{\check{o}_{1:h_1-1}, \check{a}_{1:h_1-2}, \check{o}_{i_1,h_1}, \check{a}_{i_1,h_1-1}\} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_1+1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_2} \subseteq \check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}$, and $\check{a}_{i_1,h_1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_1+1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_2} \subseteq \check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}$. Hence, $\mathcal{L}$ is QC. However, for any $i_1 \neq i_2 \in [n], h_1 \in [H-1]$, agent $(i_1, h_1)$ may influence agent $(i_2, h_1+1)$ but $\sigma(\check{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \nsubseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_2,h_1+1})$. Hence, $\mathcal{L}$ may not be sQC.

- **Example 7:** The information in $\overline{\mathcal{D}}_{\mathcal{L}}$ evolves as $\forall h \in [H], i \neq 1, \check{c}_h = \{\check{o}_{1,1:h-1}, \check{o}_{-1,1:h-d}\}, \check{p}_{1,h} = \emptyset, \check{p}_{i,h} = \{o_{i,h-d+1:h}\}$. Then, for any $i_1, i_2 \in [n], h_1, h_2 \in [H], h_1 < h_2$. If $i_1 \neq 1$, then agent $(i_1, h_1)$ will not influence agent $(i_2, h_2)$. If $i_1 = 1$, then $\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} = \{\check{o}_{1,1:h_1}, \check{o}_{-1,1:h_1-d}\} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_1+1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_2} \subseteq \check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}$. Therefore, we have $\sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$ if agent $(i_1, h_1)$ influences agent $(i_2, h_2)$. Hence, $\mathcal{L}$ is QC. However, for any $i_1 \in [n], h_1 < h_2 \leq H$, agent $(1, h_1)$ may influence agent $(i_1, h_2)$ but $\sigma(\check{a}_{1,h_1}) \nsubseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_2})$. Hence, $\mathcal{L}$ may not be sQC.

- **Example 8:** The information in $\overline{\mathcal{D}}_{\mathcal{L}}$ evolves as $\forall h \in [H], i \neq 1, \check{c}_h = \{\check{o}_{1,1:h-1}, \check{a}_{1,1:h-2}, \check{o}_{-1,1:h-d}\}, \check{p}_{1,h} = \{\check{a}_{1,h-1}\}, \check{p}_{i,h} = \{\check{o}_{i,h-d+1:h}\}$. Then, for any $i_1, i_2 \in [n], h_1, h_2 \in [H], h_1 < h_2$. If $i_1 \neq 1$, then agent $(i_1, h_1)$ will not influence agent $(i_2, h_2)$. If $i_1 = 1$, then $\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} = \{\check{o}_{1,1:h_1}, \check{a}_{1,h_1-1}, \check{o}_{-1,1:h_1-d}\} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_1+1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_2} \subseteq \check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}$. Therefore, we have $\sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$ if agent $(i_1, h_1)$ influences agent $(i_2, h_2)$. Hence, $\mathcal{L}$ is QC. However, for any $i_1 \neq 1, h_1 \in [H-1]$, agent $(1, h_1)$ may influence agent $(i_1, h_1+1)$ but $\sigma(\check{a}_{1,h_1}) \nsubseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1+1})$. Hence, $\mathcal{L}$ may not be sQC.

This completes the proof. □

# B. Deferred Details of §III

## B-A Supporting Lemmas

We start by proving several supporting lemmas that will be used in the later proofs in this section.

**Lemma B.1.** Given any QC LTC $\mathcal{L}$, its induced Dec-POMDP $\overline{\mathcal{D}}_{\mathcal{L}}$, and any $i_1, i_2 \in [n], h_1, h_2 \in [H]$. If agent $(i_1, h_1)$ influences agent $(i_2, h_2)$ in the intrinsic model of $\overline{\mathcal{D}}_{\mathcal{L}}$, then for the random variables

$\tau_{i_1,h_1^-}, \tau_{i_2,h_2^-}$ in $\mathcal{L}$, we have $\sigma(\tau_{i_1,h_1^-}) \subseteq \sigma(\tau_{i_2,h_2^-})$. Moreover, if $\mathcal{L}$ is sQC, then for random variables $a_{i_1,h_1}, \tau_{i_2,h_2^-}$ in $\mathcal{L}$, we have $\sigma(a_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\tau_{i_2,h_2^-})$.

*Proof.* We denote by $\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}, \check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}$ the information of agent $(i_1,h_1),(i_2,h_2)$ in the problem $\overline{\mathcal{D}}_{\mathcal{L}}$. From the definition of $\overline{\mathcal{D}}_{\mathcal{L}}$ being QC, if agent $(i_1,h_1)$ influences agent $(i_2,h_2)$, then $\sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$. Since for any $h \in [H], i \in [n]$, $\check{\tau}_{i,h}$ is the information of agent $(i,h)$ without additional sharing, then we know that $\tau_{i,h^-} \backslash \check{\tau}_{i,h} \subseteq \cup_{t=1}^{h-1} z_t^{\mathrm{a}}, \tau_{i,h^+} \backslash \check{\tau}_{i,h} \subseteq \cup_{t=1}^{h} z_t^{\mathrm{a}}$. Therefore, we know that $\sigma(\tau_{i_1,h_1^-} \backslash \check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\cup_{t=1}^{h-1} z_t^{\mathrm{a}}) \subseteq \sigma(c_{h_1^-}) \subseteq \sigma(c_{h_2^-}) \subseteq \sigma(\tau_{i_2,h_2^-})$. Also, we know that $\sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}) \subseteq \sigma(\tau_{i_2,h_2^-})$. Thus, we can conclude that $\sigma(\tau_{i_1,h_1^-}) \subseteq \sigma(\tau_{i_2,h_2^-})$. Moreover, if $\mathcal{L}$ is sQC, then from the definition of $\overline{\mathcal{D}}_{\mathcal{L}}$ being sQC and agent $(i_1,h_1)$ influences agent $(i_2,h_2)$ in $\overline{\mathcal{D}}_{\mathcal{L}}$, it holds that $\sigma(a_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}) \subseteq \sigma(\tau_{i_2,h_2^-})$. □

**Lemma B.2.** Let $\mathcal{L}$ be a QC LTC problem satisfying Assumptions III.5 and III.7, and $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ be the reformulated Dec-POMDP. Then, for any $i_1, i_2 \in [n], t_1, t_2 \in [H]$, if agent $(i_1, 2t_1)$ influences agent $(i_2, 2t_2)$ in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$, then $\sigma(\tau_{i_1,t_1^-}) \subseteq \sigma(\tau_{i_2,t_2^-})$ in $\mathcal{L}$. Moreover, if $\mathcal{L}$ is sQC, then $\sigma(a_{i_1,t_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\tau_{i_2,t_2^-})$.

*Proof.* We prove this case by case as follows:
1) If $a_{i_1,t_1}$ influences the underlying state $s_{t_1+1}$, then from Assumption III.7, agent $(i_1,t_1)$ influences $o_{-i_1,t_1+1}$, so there must exist $i_3 \neq i_1$, such that agent $(i_1,t_1)$ influences $o_{i_3,t_1+1}$. From part (e) of Assumption II.1 and $t_1 < t_2$ (since otherwise agent $(i_1,2t_1)$ cannot influence agent $(i_2,2t_2)$ in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$), we know that $o_{i_3,t_1+1} \in \tau_{i_3,(t_1+1)^-} \subseteq \tau_{i_3,t_2^-}$ even under no additional sharing, and then we get agent $(i_1,t_1)$ influences agent $(i_3,t_2)$ in $\overline{\mathcal{D}}_{\mathcal{L}}$ (the Dec-POMDP induced by $\mathcal{L}$). From Lemma B.1, it holds that $\sigma(\tau_{i_1,t_1^-}) \subseteq \sigma(\tau_{i_3,t_2^-})$. From Assumption II.2 and $i_3 \neq i_1$, we know that $\sigma(\tau_{i_1,t_1^-}) \subseteq \sigma(c_{t_2^-}) \subseteq \sigma(\tau_{i_2,t_2^-})$. If $\mathcal{L}$ is sQC, by Lemma B.1, we have $\sigma(a_{i_1,t_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\tau_{i_3,t_2^-})$ , and then $\sigma(a_{i_1,t_1}) \subseteq \sigma(c_{t_2^-}) \subseteq \sigma(\tau_{i_2,t_2^-})$ from Assumption II.2.
2) If $a_{i_1,t_1}$ does not influence $s_{t_1+1}$, then from Assumption III.5, for any $t > t_1, a_{i_1,t_1} \notin \tau_{t^-}$ and $a_{i_1,t_1} \notin \tau_{t^+}$, and then agent $(i_1,2t_1)$ does not influence $\widetilde{s}_{2t_1+1}$ and $\widetilde{o}_{2t_1+1}$ in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$. Thus $\widetilde{a}_{i_1,2t_1} = a_{i_1,t_1}$ does not influence $\widetilde{\tau}_{i,2t_1+1}, \forall i \in [n]$, and then it does not influence $\widetilde{a}_{i,2t_1+1}, \forall i \in [n]$. And hence, it does not influence $\widetilde{\tau}_{i,2t_1+2}$ and $\widetilde{a}_{i,2t_1+2}, \forall i \in [n]$, either. By recursion, we know that agent $(i_1,2t_1)$ does not influence agent $(i_2,2t_2)$, which leads to a contradiction to the premise of the lemma. This completes the proof. □

## B-B Proof of Lemma III.2

*Proof.* We first have the following proposition on the hardness of solving POMDPs.

**Proposition B.3.** For any $\epsilon \in [0, \frac{1}{4})$, computing an $\epsilon$-additive optimal strategy in POMDPs with rewards bounded in $[0,1/2]$ is PSPACE-hard.

*Proof of Proposition B.3.* In the proof of [22, Theorem 4.11], given any $\epsilon \in [0,1)$, it constructed POMDPs from the problems of Stochastic Satisfiability (SSAT) of the Quantified Boolean Formulae. The constructed instances in [22] satisfy that the reward values lie in $\{0,2\}$, and it was then proved that finding an $\epsilon$-relative approximately optimal solution in such POMDPs is PSPACE-hard. Also, one can verify that finding an $\epsilon$-additive approximately optimal solution in such POMDPs is PSPACE-hard.

Then, for any $\epsilon \in [0, \frac{1}{4})$, let $\epsilon_1 = 4\epsilon \in [0,1)$, and leverage the construction in [22, Theorem 4.11] with $\epsilon_1$, but scaling the reward values by $\frac{1}{4}$ such that rewards are bounded in $[0, \frac{1}{2}]$. Then, finding an $\epsilon$-additive approximately optimal solution in such POMDPs (after scaling) is PSPACE-hard. □

Now we proceed with the proof of Lemma III.2 based on Proposition B.3. Given any POMDP $\mathcal{P} = (\mathcal{S}^{\mathcal{P}}, \mathcal{A}^{\mathcal{P}}, \mathcal{O}^{\mathcal{P}}, \{\mathbb{O}_h^{\mathcal{P}}\}_{h \in [H^{\mathcal{P}}]}, \{\mathbb{T}_h^{\mathcal{P}}\}_{h \in [H^{\mathcal{P}}]}, \{\mathcal{R}_h^{\mathcal{P}}\}_{h \in [H^{\mathcal{P}}]}, \mu_1^{\mathcal{P}})$ with rewards bounded in $[0,1/2]$, we can construct an LTC $\mathcal{L}$ with any $\alpha \in (0,1)$ as follows:

- Number of agents: $n = 3$; length of episode: $H = H^{\mathcal{P}}$.
- Underlying state space: $\mathcal{S} = \mathcal{S}^{\mathcal{P}} \times [2]$. For any $s \in \mathcal{S}$, we can split $s = (s^1, s^2)$, where $s^1 \in \mathcal{S}^{\mathcal{P}}, s^2 \in [2]$. Initial state distribution: $\forall s \in \mathcal{S}, \mu_1(s) = \mu_1^{\mathcal{P}}(s^1)/2$.
- Control action space: For any $h \in [H], \mathcal{A}_{1,h} = \mathcal{A}^{\mathcal{P}}, \mathcal{A}_{2,h} = [2], \mathcal{A}_{3,h} = \{\emptyset\}$.
- Transition: For any $h \in [H], s_h, s_{h+1} \in \mathcal{S}, a_h \in \mathcal{A}_h, \mathbb{T}_h(s_{h+1} \,|\, s_h, a_h) = \mathbb{T}_h^{\mathcal{P}}(s_{h+1}^1 \,|\, s_h^1, a_{1,h}) \mathbb{1}[s_{h+1}^2 = a_{2,h}]$.
- Observation space: For any $h \in [H], \mathcal{O}_{1,h} = \mathcal{O}_h^{\mathcal{P}}, \mathcal{O}_{2,h} = \mathcal{O}_{3,h} = \mathcal{S}$.
- Emission: For any $h \in [H], o_h \in \mathcal{O}_h, s_h \in \mathcal{S}, \mathbb{O}_h(o_h \,|\, s_h) = \mathbb{O}_h^{\mathcal{P}}(o_{1,h} \,|\, s_h^1) \mathbb{O}_h'(o_{2,h} \,|\, s_h) \mathbb{O}_h'(o_{3,h} \,|\, s_h)$, where $\mathbb{O}_h'$ is defined as
$$\forall o \in \mathcal{S}, s_h \in \mathcal{S}, \qquad \mathbb{O}_h'(o \,|\, s_h) = \begin{cases} \alpha + \dfrac{1-\alpha}{|\mathcal{S}|} & \text{if } o = s_h \\ \dfrac{1-\alpha}{|\mathcal{S}|} & \text{o.w.} \end{cases}.$$
- Baseline sharing: null.
- Communication action space: For any $h \in [H], \mathcal{M}_{1,h} = \mathcal{M}_{2,h} = \{0,1\}^{2h-1}, \mathcal{M}_{3,h} = \{0,1\}^h$. For any $i \in [2], p_{i,h^-} \in \mathcal{P}_{i,h^-}, \phi_{i,h}(p_{i,h^-}, m_{i,h}) = \{o_{i,k} \,|\, \forall k \le h,$ the $(2k-1)$-th digit of $m_{i,h}$ is 1 and $o_{i,k} \in p_{i,h^-}\} \cup \{a_{i,k} \,|\, \forall k \le h-1,$ the $2k$-th digit of $m_{i,h}$ is 1 and $a_{i,k} \in p_{i,h^-}\} \cup \{m_{i,h}\}$. For agent 3, $p_{3,h^-} \in \mathcal{P}_{3,h^-}$, $\phi_{3,h}(p_{3,h^-}, m_{3,h}) = \{o_{3,k} \,|\, \forall k \le h,$ the $k$-th digit of $m_{3,h}$ is 1 and $o_{3,k} \in p_{3,h^-}\} \cup \{m_{3,h}\}$.
- Reward function: For any $h \in [H]$, $\forall s_h \in \mathcal{S}, a_h \in \mathcal{A}_h, \mathcal{R}_h(s_h, a_h) = \mathcal{R}_h^{\mathcal{P}}(s_h^1, a_{1,h})/H$.
- Communication cost function: For any $h \in [H]$, $\forall z_h^{\mathrm{a}} \in \mathcal{Z}_h^{\mathrm{a}}, \mathcal{K}_h(z_h^{\mathrm{a}}) = \mathbb{1}[z_h^{\mathrm{a}} \neq \{m_h\}]$. It means that the communication cost is 1 unless there is no additional sharing.
- We restrict the communication strategy to only use $c_h$ as input. And for any $t \in [H-1]$, we remove $a_{3,t}$ in $\tau_{h^-}, \tau_{h^+}$ for all $h > t$.

We first verify that such a construction satisfies Assumptions III.1, III.4, III.5, and III.7, but is not QC.

- $\mathcal{L}$ satisfies Assumptions III.1, III.7, because both agent 2 and agent 3 have individual $\gamma$-observability with $\gamma = \alpha$. That is, for any $b_1, b_2 \in \Delta(\mathcal{S}), i = 2, 3$, we have
$$\begin{aligned} \|\mathbb{O}_{i,h}^\top (b_1 - b_2)\|_1 &= \sum_{o_{i,h} \in \mathcal{O}_h} |\sum_{s_h \in \mathcal{S}} (b_1(s_h) - b_2(s_h)) \mathbb{O}_{i,h}(o_{i,h} \,|\, s_h)| \\ &= \sum_{o_{i,h} \in \mathcal{O}_h} |\sum_{s_h \in \mathcal{S}} (b_1(s_h) - b_2(s_h)) (\frac{1-\alpha}{|\mathcal{S}|} + \alpha \mathbb{1}[o_{i,h} = s_h])| \\ &= \sum_{o_{i,h} \in \mathcal{O}_h} \alpha |b_1(o_{i,h}) - b_2(o_{i,h})| = \alpha \|b_1 - b_2\|_1. \end{aligned}$$
- $\mathcal{L}$ satisfies Assumption III.4, because we restrict that the communication strategy can only use $c_h$ as input.
- $\mathcal{L}$ satisfies Assumption III.5 since the control actions $a_{3,t}$ (for all $t \in [H-1]$) do not influence the underlying state, and we remove $a_{3,t}$ from $\tau_h$ for any $h > t$.

- $\mathcal{L}$ is not QC, since for any $h \in [H-1]$, agent $(2,h)$ influences the state $s_{h+1}$ and then influences $o_{3,h+1}$ and $\tau_{3,h+1}$. However, agent $(3,h+1)$ does not know the information of agent $(2,h)$, i.e., $\sigma(\tau_{2,h}) \nsubseteq \sigma(\tau_{3,h+1})$.

In this LTC problem $\mathcal{L}$, let $(g^{a,*}_{1:H}, g^{m,*}_{1:H})$ be any $\epsilon$-team optimal strategy, with $\epsilon \in [0, 1/4)$. If any agent shares any information through additional sharing, i.e., $\exists h \in [H], \mathbb{P}(z^a_h \neq \{m_h\} | g^{a,*}_{1:H}, g^{m,*}_{1:H}) > 0$, we then choose the $h$ to be the minimal one, i.e., $h = \min\{h' \in [H] | \mathbb{P}(z^a_{h'} \neq \{m_{h'}\} | g^{a,*}_{1:H}, g^{m,*}_{1:H}) > 0\}$ being the first time the additional sharing occurs. This means that at this timestep $h$, there is no observation or action in $c_{h^-}$ (almost surely), since baseline sharing is null. Then, there exists an agent $i \in [2]$ such that $\mathbb{P}(z^a_{i,h} \neq \{m_{i,h}\} | g^{a,*}_{1:H}, g^{m,*}_{1:H}) > 0$.

From the construction of $\mathcal{L}$, we know that agent $i$ chooses $m_{i,h}$ based on $c_{h^-}$. It means it will always share, i.e., $\mathbb{P}(z^a_{i,h} \neq \{m_{i,h}\} | g^{a,*}_{1:H}, g^{m,*}_{1:H}) = 1$. Therefore, $\mathbb{P}(\kappa_h = 1 | g^{a,*}_{1:H}, g^{m,*}_{1:H}) = 1$, and $J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{a,*}_{1:H}, g^{m,*}_{1:H}) = \mathbb{E}[\sum_{t=1}^H r_t - \kappa_t | g^{a,*}_{1:H}, g^{m,*}_{1:H}] \leq \mathbb{E}[\sum_{t=1}^H r_t | g^{a,*}_{1:H}, g^{m,*}_{1:H}] - \mathbb{E}[\kappa_h | g^{a,*}_{1:H}, g^{m,*}_{1:H}] \leq H \cdot \frac{1}{2H} - 1 \leq -\frac{1}{2}$. Note that the rewards in $\mathcal{P}$ are bounded by $[0, \frac{1}{2}]$, and the rewards in $\mathcal{L}$ are bounded by $[0, \frac{1}{2H}]$. Hence, $(g^{a,*}_{1:H}, g^{m,*}_{1:H})$ is not an $\epsilon$-team-optimal for any $\epsilon \in [0, 1/4)$.

Therefore, any $\epsilon$-team-optimal strategy yields no additional sharing. Then, any $(g^{a,*}_{1:H}, g^{m,*}_{1:H})$ being an $\frac{\epsilon}{H}$-team-optimal strategy of $\mathcal{L}$ will directly give an $\epsilon$-optimal strategy of $\mathcal{P}$ as $\{g^{a,*}_{1,h}\}_{h \in [H]}$, since when there is no sharing, the decision process is only controlled by agent 1. From Proposition B.3, we complete the proof. □

## B-C Proof of Lemma III.3

*Proof.* We prove this result by showing a reduction from the Team Decision problem [33].

**Definition B.4** (Team decision problem (TDP))**.** Given finite sets $Y_1, Y_2, U_1, U_2$, a rational probability mass function $p : Y_1 \times Y_2 \to \mathbb{Q}$, and an integer cost function $c : Y_1 \times Y_2 \times U_1 \times U_2 \to \mathbb{N}$, find decision rules $\gamma_i : Y_i \to U_i, i = 1, 2$ that minimize the expected cost

$$J(\gamma_1, \gamma_2) = \sum_{y_1 \in Y_1, y_2 \in Y_2} c(y_1, y_2, \gamma_1(y_1), \gamma_2(y_2)) p(y_1, y_2). \tag{B.1}$$

We show the NP-hardness of solving LTC from the problem of TDP, even with $|U_1| = |U_2| = 2$ [33]. Given any TDP $\mathcal{TD} = (\widetilde{Y}_1, \widetilde{Y}_2, \widetilde{U}_1, \widetilde{U}_2, \widetilde{c}, \widetilde{p}, \widetilde{J})$ with $|\widetilde{U}_1| = |\widetilde{U}_2| = 2$, let $\widetilde{U}_1 = \{1, 2\}, \widetilde{U}_2 = \{1, 2\}$, then we can construct an $H = 3$ and 2-agent LTC $\mathcal{L}$ with two parameters $\alpha_1 \in \mathbb{R}, \alpha_2 \in (0, 1)$ (to be specified later) such that:

- Number of agents: $n = 2$.
- Underlying state: $\mathcal{S} = [2]^4$. For each $s_1 \in \mathcal{S}$, we can split $s_1$ into 4 parts as $s_1 = (s_1^1, s_1^2, s_1^3, s_1^4)$, where $s_1^1, s_1^2, s_1^3, s_1^4 \in [2]$. Similarly, $s_2, s_3 \in \mathcal{S}$ can be split in the same way.
- Initial state distribution: $\forall s_1 \in \mathcal{S}, \mu_1(s_1) = \frac{1}{16}$.
- Control action space: For the first 2 timesteps, $\forall i = 1, 2, \mathcal{A}_{i,1} = \mathcal{A}_{i,2} = \{\emptyset\}$; for $h = 3, \mathcal{A}_{i,3} = [2]$.
- Transition: $\forall s \in \mathcal{S}, a_1 \in \mathcal{A}_1, a_2 \in \mathcal{A}_2, a_3 \in \mathcal{A}_3, \mathbb{T}_1(s | s, a_1) = \mathbb{T}_2(s | s, a_2) = \mathbb{T}_3(s | s, a_3) = 1$. Note that under the transition dynamics above, $s_1 = s_2 = s_3$ always holds, for any $s_1 \in \mathcal{S}$.
- Observation space: $\mathcal{O}_{1,1} = \mathcal{O}_{2,1} = \mathcal{O}_{1,2} = \mathcal{O}_{2,2} = [2] \times \mathcal{S}, \mathcal{O}_{1,3} = \widetilde{Y}_1 \times \mathcal{S}, \mathcal{O}_{2,3} = \widetilde{Y}_2 \times \mathcal{S}$. Hence, for each $i \in [2], h \in [2], o_{i,h} \in \mathcal{O}_{i,h}$, we can split $o_{i,h}$ into 2 parts as $o_{i,h} = (o^1_{i,h}, o^2_{i,h})$, where $o^1_{i,h} \in [2], o^2_{i,h} \in \mathcal{S}$.

For each $i \in [n], o_{i,3} \in \mathcal{O}_{i,3}$, we can similarly split $o_{i,3}$ into 2 parts as $o_{i,3} = (o^1_{i,3}, o^2_{i,3})$, where $o^1_{i,3} \in \widetilde{Y}_i, o^2_{i,3} \in \mathcal{S}$.

- Baseline sharing: null.
- Communication action space: For $i \in [2], h \in \{1,2\}, \mathcal{M}_{i,h} = \{0,1\}^h$; $\phi_{i,h}$ is defined as: $\forall h \in \{1,2\}, \phi_{i,h}(p_{i,h^-}, m_{i,h}) = \{o_{i,k} | \forall k \le h, \text{the } k\text{-th digit of } m_{i,h} \text{ is 1 and } o_{i,k} \in p_{i,h^-}\}$. For $h = 3$, $\mathcal{M}_{i,3} = \{1,2\}$, and if $m_{i,3} = 1$, then $\phi_{i,3}(p_{i,3^-}, m_{i,3}) = \{o_{i,1}, o_{i,3}, m_{i,3}\}$; if $m_{i,3} = 2$, then $\phi_{i,3}(p_{i,3^-}, m_{i,3}) = \{o_{i,2}, o_{i,3}, m_{i,3}\}$.
- Emission: For any $i \in [2], h \in [2], s_h \in \mathcal{S}, o_{i,h} \in \mathcal{O}_{i,h}, \mathbb{O}_h(o_h|s_h) = \Pi_{i=1}^2 \mathbb{O}_{i,h}(o_{i,h}|s_h)$ and $\mathbb{O}_{i,h}(o_{i,h}|s_h)$ is defined as:

$$\mathbb{O}_{i,h}(o_{i,h}|s_h) = \begin{cases} \frac{1-\alpha_2}{16} & o^1_{i,h} = s_h^{i+2h-2}, o^2_{i,h} \neq s_h \\ \frac{1-\alpha_2}{16} + \alpha_2 & o^1_{i,h} = s_h^{i+2h-2}, o^2_{i,h} = s_h \\ 0 & \text{o.w.} \end{cases}.$$

For $i \in [2], h = 3$, $s_3 \in \mathcal{S}, o_3 \in \mathcal{O}_3, \mathbb{O}_3(o_3|s_3) = \widetilde{p}(o^1_{1,3}, o^1_{2,3}) \Pi_{i=1}^2 \mathbb{O}^2_{i,3}(o^2_{i,3}|s_3)$, where

$$\mathbb{O}^2_{i,3}(o^2_{i,3}|s_3) = \begin{cases} \frac{1-\alpha_2}{16} & o^2_{i,3} \neq s_3 \\ \frac{1-\alpha_2}{16} + \alpha_2 & o^2_{i,3} = s_3 \end{cases}.$$

The reward functions are defined as:

$$\mathcal{R}_1(s_1, a_1) = \mathcal{R}_2(s_2, a_2) = 0, \ \ \forall s_1, s_2 \in \mathcal{S}, a_1 \in \mathcal{A}_1, a_2 \in \mathcal{A}_2;$$
$$\mathcal{R}_3(s_3, a_3) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } (a_{1,3} = s_3^2 \text{ or } a_{1,3} = s_3^4) \text{ and } (a_{2,3} = s_3^1 \text{ or } a_{2,3} = s_3^3) \\ 0 & \text{o.w.} \end{cases}.$$

The communication cost functions are defined as:

$$\forall h \in \{1,2\}, z^{\mathrm{a}}_h \in \mathcal{Z}^{\mathrm{a}}_h, \qquad \mathcal{K}_h(z^{\mathrm{a}}_h) = 1 \text{ if } z^{\mathrm{a}}_h \neq \{m_{1,h}, m_{2,h}\}, \text{ else } 0;$$
$$\mathcal{K}_3(z^{\mathrm{a}}_3) = \begin{cases} \widetilde{c}(o^1_{1,3}, o^1_{2,3}, 1, 1)/\alpha_1 & \text{if } \{o_{1,1}, o_{2,1}\} \subseteq z^{\mathrm{a}}_3 \text{ and } \{o_{1,2}, o_{2,2}\} \cap z^{\mathrm{a}}_3 = \emptyset \\ \widetilde{c}(o^1_{1,3}, o^1_{2,3}, 2, 1)/\alpha_1 & \text{if } \{o_{1,2}, o_{2,1}\} \subseteq z^{\mathrm{a}}_3 \text{ and } \{o_{1,1}, o_{2,2}\} \cap z^{\mathrm{a}}_3 = \emptyset \\ \widetilde{c}(o^1_{1,3}, o^1_{2,3}, 1, 2)/\alpha_1 & \text{if } \{o_{1,1}, o_{2,2}\} \subseteq z^{\mathrm{a}}_3 \text{ and } \{o_{1,2}, o_{2,1}\} \cap z^{\mathrm{a}}_3 = \emptyset \\ \widetilde{c}(o^1_{1,3}, o^1_{2,3}, 2, 2)/\alpha_1 & \text{if } \{o_{1,2}, o_{2,2}\} \subseteq z^{\mathrm{a}}_3 \text{ and } \{o_{1,1}, o_{2,1}\} \cap z^{\mathrm{a}}_3 = \emptyset \\ 0 & \text{o.w.} \end{cases},$$

where we let $\alpha_0 = \max_{y_1, y_2, u_1, u_2} \widetilde{c}(y_1, y_2, u_1, u_2)$, and set $\alpha_1 = 2\alpha_0, \alpha_2 \in (0,1)$. Note that without loss of optimality, we suppose $\alpha_1 > 0$, since if $\alpha_1 = 0$, then $\widetilde{c}(y_1, y_2, u_1, u_2) = 0, \forall y_1 \in \widetilde{Y}_1, y_2 \in \widetilde{Y}_2, u_1 \in \widetilde{U}_1, u_2 \in \widetilde{U}_2$, which is a trivial instance that cannot be the one that leads to the hardness in [33]. Hence, $0 \le \kappa_3 = \mathcal{K}_3(z^{\mathrm{a}}_3) \le \frac{1}{2}$ for any $z^{\mathrm{a}}_3 \in \mathcal{Z}^{\mathrm{a}}_3$ always holds. Also, we remove $a_{i,t}$ in $\tau_{h^-}$ and $\tau_{h^+}$ for any $t \in [2], i \in [2], h > t$. Under such a construction, $\mathcal{L}$ satisfies the following conditions:

- $\mathcal{L}$ is QC: For all $i_1, i_2 \in [2], h_1, h_2 \in [3]$ with $i_1 \neq i_2$, agent $(i_1, h_1)$ does not influence $(i_2, h_2)$ because agent $(i_1, h_1)$ cannot influence the observations of agent $(i_2, h_2)$, and the baseline sharing is null. For the same agent with $i_1 = i_2$, the information-inclusion assumption in Assumption II.1 (e) ensures that $\mathcal{L}$ is QC.

- $\mathcal{L}$ satisfies Assumptions III.1 and III.7: We prove this by showing that each agent $i \in [2]$ satisfies $\gamma$-observability. For any $i \in [2], h \in [2], b_1, b_2 \in \Delta(\mathcal{S})$, let

$$\begin{aligned}
\|\mathbb{O}_{i,h}^{\top}(b_1 - b_2)\|_1 &= \sum_{o_{i,h}^1 \in [2]} \sum_{o_{i,h}^2 \in \mathcal{S}} \left| \sum_{s_h \in \mathcal{S}} (b_1(s_h) - b_2(s_h)) \mathbb{O}_{i,h}((o_{i,h}^1, o_{i,h}^2) | s_h) \right| \\
&\geq \sum_{o_{i,h}^2 \in \mathcal{S}} \left| \sum_{o_{i,h}^1 \in [2]} \sum_{s_h \in \mathcal{S}} (b_1(s_h) - b_2(s_h)) \mathbb{O}_{i,h}((o_{i,h}^1, o_{i,h}^2) | s_h) \right| \\
&= \sum_{o_{i,h}^2 \in \mathcal{S}} \left| \sum_{s_h \in \mathcal{S}} \sum_{o_{i,h}^1 \in [2]} (b_1(s_h) - b_2(s_h)) \mathbb{1}[o_{i,h}^1 = s_h^{i+2h-2}] (\frac{1-\alpha_2}{16} + \alpha_2 \mathbb{1}[o_{i,h}^2 = s_h]) \right| \\
&= \sum_{o_{i,h}^2 \in \mathcal{S}} \alpha_2 |b_1(o_{i,h}^2) - b_2(o_{i,h}^2)| = \alpha_2 \|b_1 - b_2\|_1.
\end{aligned}$$

  For any $i \in [2], h = 3$, the proof is similar, where we replace $o_{i,h}^1 \in [2]$ with $o_{i,h}^1 \in \widetilde{Y}_i$ for $h = 3$.

- $\mathcal{L}$ satisfies Assumption III.5, because the joint control action histories $a_{1:3}$ do not influence the underlying states, and we restrict the communication and control strategies to not use them as input.

- $\mathcal{L}$ does not satisfy Assumption III.4, since here we allow communication strategies $g_{i,h}^m$ to take $\tau_{i,h^-}$ as input for any $i \in [2], h \in [3]$.

We will show below that computing a team-optimal strategy of $\mathcal{L}$ can give us a team-optimal strategy of $\mathcal{TD}$. Given $(g_{1:3}^{\mathrm{a},*}, g_{1:3}^{m,*})$ being a team-optimal strategy of $\mathcal{L}$, firstly, it will have no additional sharing at timesteps $h = 1, 2$ under $(g_{1:3}^{\mathrm{a},*}, g_{1:3}^{m,*})$, namely, for $h = 1, 2, \mathbb{P}(z_h^{\mathrm{a}} = \{m_{1,h}, m_{2,h}\} | g_{1:3}^{\mathrm{a},*}, g_{1:3}^{m,*}) = 1$. If not, then for any $i \in [2]$, consider $g_{i,1}^{m,'}, g_{i,2}^{m,'}, g_{i,3}^{\mathrm{a},*}$ defined as

$$\forall \tau_{i,1^-}, \tau_{i,2^-}, \tau_{i,3^+}, g_{i,1}^{m,'}(\tau_{i,1^-}) = (0), \quad g_{i,2}^{m,'}(\tau_{i,2^-}) = (0,0), \quad g_{i,3^+}^{\mathrm{a},'}(\tau_{i,3^+}) = \begin{cases} o_{3-i,1}^1 & \text{if } o_{3-i,1} \in \tau_{i,3^+} \\ o_{3-i,2}^1 & \text{o.w.} \end{cases},$$

and replace the $g_{1:2,1}^{m,*}, g_{1:2,2}^{m,*}, g_{1:2,3}^{\mathrm{a},*}$ by $g_{1:2,1}^{m,'}, g_{1:2,2}^{m,'}, g_{1:2,3}^{\mathrm{a},'}$ in $g_{1:3}^{\mathrm{a},*}, g_{1:3}^{m,*}$ to get $(g_{1:3}^{\mathrm{a},'}, g_{1:3}^{m,'})$. It is easy to verify that $J_{\mathcal{L}}(g_{1:3}^{\mathrm{a},*}, g_{1:3}^{m,*}) < J_{\mathcal{L}}(g_{1:3}^{\mathrm{a},'}, g_{1:3}^{m,'})$, since $g_{1:3}^{\mathrm{a},'}, g_{1:3}^{m,'}$ can guarantee $r_3 = 1$ always holds; if there is no additional sharing under $g_{1:3}^{\mathrm{a},'}, g_{1:3}^{m,'}$ at first two timesteps, these two strategies have the same communication cost, otherwise $(g_{1:3}^{\mathrm{a},'}, g_{1:3}^{m,'})$ has $\sum_{h=1}^3 \kappa_h = \kappa_3 \leq \frac{1}{2}$ but $(g_{1:3}^{\mathrm{a},*}, g_{1:3}^{m,*})$ has $\sum_{h=1}^3 \kappa_h \geq 1$. This leads to the contradiction that $(g_{1:3}^{\mathrm{a},*}, g_{1:3}^{m,*})$ is a team-optimal strategy.

Also, if we replace the $g_{1:2,3}^{\mathrm{a},*}$ by $g_{1:2,3}^{\mathrm{a},'}$, the communication cost does not change and the reward can achieve optimal, i.e., $r_3 = 1$ always holds. Thus, without loss of generality, we can assume that $g_{1:2,3}^{\mathrm{a},*} = g_{1:2,3}^{\mathrm{a},'}$, since otherwise we can do the replacement and it is still a team-optimal strategy.

Therefore, $J_{\mathcal{L}}(g_{1:3}^{\mathrm{a},*}, g_{1:3}^{m,*}) = \mathbb{E}[\sum_{h=1}^3 r_h - \kappa_h | g_{1:3}^{\mathrm{a},*}, g_{1:3}^{m,*}] = 1 - \mathbb{E}[\kappa_3 | g_{1:3}^{\mathrm{a},*}, g_{1:3}^{m,*}] = 1 - \frac{1}{\alpha_1}\mathbb{E}[\widetilde{c}(o_{1,3}^1, o_{2,3}^1, m_{1,3}, m_{2,3})]$, where $m_{1,3} = g_{1,3}^{m,*}(\{\tau_{1,3^-}\}), m_{2,3} = g_{2,3}^{m,*}(\{\tau_{2,3^-}\})$, which means $(g_{1:3}^{\mathrm{a},*}, g_{1:3}^{m,*})$ can minimize $\kappa_3$ through choosing $m_3$ properly, if there is no additional sharing at first two timesteps, i.e., $\tau_{i,3^-} = \{o_{i,1}, o_{i,2}, o_{i,3}, m_{1:2}\}$. By construction, $\kappa_3$ only depends on $o_3$ and $m_3$ and is irrelevant of $\{o_{1,1}, o_{1,2}, o_{1,3}^2\}$, and $m_{i,1} = (0), m_{i,2} = (0,0), \forall i \in [2]$ always hold. Hence, $\{o_{1,1}, o_{1,2}, o_{1,3}^2\}$ are useless information for agent 1 to choose $m_{1,3}$ and minimize $\mathbb{E}[\kappa_3]$. Therefore, not using them in $g_{1,3}^{m,*}$ does not lose any optimality. Hence, we can consider the $g_{1,3}^{m,*}$ that only has $o_{1,3}^1$

as input. In the same way, we can consider the $g^{m,*}_{2,3}$ that only has $o^1_{2,3}$ as input. Therefore, $J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{\mathsf{a},*}_{1:3}, g^{m,*}_{1:3}) = 1 - \sum_{o^1_{1,3}, o^2_{1,3}} \frac{1}{\alpha_1} \widetilde{c}(o^1_{1,3}, o^1_{2,3}, g^{m,*}_{1,3}(o^1_{1,3}), g^{m,*}_{2,3}(o^1_{2,3})) \widetilde{p}(o^1_{1,3}, o^1_{2,3})$. Further, we can leverage $\widetilde{\gamma}^*_1 = g^{m,*}_{1,3}, \widetilde{\gamma}^*_2 = g^{m,*}_{2,3}$ to minimize the expected cost $\widetilde{J}$ of the TDP. Therefore, from the NP-hardness of TDPs [33, Corollary 4.1], we complete our proof. □

## B-D Proof of Lemma III.6

*Proof of Lemma III.6.* We prove this result by showing a reduction from the Team Decision problem. Given any TDP $\mathcal{TD} = (\widetilde{Y}_1, \widetilde{Y}_2, \widetilde{U}_1, \widetilde{U}_2, \widetilde{c}, \widetilde{p}, \widetilde{J})$ with $|\widetilde{U}_1| = |\widetilde{U}_2| = 2$, let $\widetilde{U}_1 = \{1, 2\}, \widetilde{U}_2 = \{1, 2\}$, then we can construct an $H = 3$ and 2-agent LTC $\mathcal{L}$ with two parameters $\alpha_1 \in \mathbb{R}, \alpha_2 \in (0, 1)$ (to be specified later) such that:

- Underlying state: $\mathcal{S} = [2]^2$. For each $s_1 \in \mathcal{S}$, we can split $s_1$ into 2 parts as $s_1 = (s^1_1, s^2_1)$, where $s^1_1, s^2_1 \in [2]$. Similarly, $s_2, s_3 \in \mathcal{S}$ can be split in the same way.
- Initial state distribution: $\forall s_1 \in \mathcal{S}, \mu_1(s_1) = \frac{1}{4}$.
- Control action space: For any $i \in [2], h = 1$, $\mathcal{A}_{i,1} = \{\emptyset\}$; for $h = 2$, $\mathcal{A}_{i,2} = \{(0, x), (x, 0) | x \in [2]\}$; We can write $a_{i,2} = (a^1_{i,2}, a^2_{i,2}), a^1_{i,2}, a^2_{i,2} \in \{0, 1, 2\}$; for $h = 3, \mathcal{A}_{i,3} = [2]$
- Transition: $\forall s \in \mathcal{S}, a_1 \in \mathcal{A}_1, a_2 \in \mathcal{A}_2, a_3 \in \mathcal{A}_3, \mathbb{T}_1(s | s, a_1) = \mathbb{T}_2(s | s, a_2) = \mathbb{T}_3(s | s, a_3) = 1$. Note that under the transition dynamics above, $s_1 = s_2 = s_3 = s_4$ always holds, for any $s_1 \in \mathcal{S}$.
- Observation space: $\mathcal{O}_{1,1} = \mathcal{O}_{2,1} = [2] \times \mathcal{S}, \mathcal{O}_{1,2} = \widetilde{Y}_1 \times \mathcal{S}, \mathcal{O}_{2,2} = \widetilde{Y}_2 \times \mathcal{S}, \mathcal{O}_{1,3} = \mathcal{O}_{2,3} = \mathcal{S}$. For each $i \in [2], o_{i,1} \in \mathcal{O}_{i,1}$, we can split $o_{i,1}$ into 2 parts as $o_{i,1} = (o^1_{i,1}, o^2_{i,1})$, where $o^1_{i,1} \in [2], o^2_{i,1} \in \mathcal{S}$. For each $i \in [2], o_{i,2} \in \mathcal{O}_{i,2}$, similarly, we can split $o_{i,2}$ into 2 parts as $o_{i,2} = (o^1_{i,2}, o^2_{i,2})$, where $o^1_{i,2} \in \widetilde{Y}_i, o^2_{i,2} \in \mathcal{S}$.
- The baseline sharing is null.
- Communication action space: For $i \in [2], h \in \{1, 2\}, \mathcal{M}_{i,h} = \{0, 1\}^{2h-1}$ and $\phi_{i,h}$ is defined as $\phi_{i,h}(p_{i,h^-}, m_{i,h}) = \{o_{i,k} \in p_{i,h^-} | \forall k \le h, \text{the } (2k-1)\text{-th digit of } m_{i,h} \text{ is } 1\} \cup \{a_{i,k} \in p_{i,h^-} | \forall k \le h-1, \text{the } 2k\text{-th digit of } m_{i,h} \text{ is } 1\} \cup \{m_{i,h}\}$; For $h = 3, \mathcal{M}_{i,3} = \{1, 2\}, \forall p_{i,3^-} \in \mathcal{P}_{i,3^-}$, $\phi_{i,3}(p_{i,3^-}, 1) = \{o_{i,2}, a_{i,2}, m_{i,3}\}$ and $\phi_{i,3}(p_{i,3^-}, 2) = \{o_{i,2}, a_{i,2}, o_{i,3}, m_{i,3}\}$.
- Emission: For $h = 1, \forall s_1 \in \mathcal{S}, o_{i,1} \in \mathcal{O}_{i,1}, \mathbb{O}_1(o_1 | s_1) = \Pi^2_{j=1} \mathbb{O}_{j,1}(o_{j,1} | s_1)$ and $\forall i \in [2], \mathbb{O}_{i,1}(o_{i,1} | s_1)$ is defined as:

$$\mathbb{O}_{i,h}(o_{i,h} | s_h) = \begin{cases} \frac{1-\alpha_2}{4} & o^1_{i,h} = s^{i+2h-2}_h, o^2_{i,h} \neq s_h \\ \frac{1-\alpha_2}{4} + \alpha_2 & o^1_{i,h} = s^{i+2h-2}_h, o^2_{i,h} = s_h \\ 0 & \text{o.w.} \end{cases},$$

  for $h = 2, \forall s_2 \in \mathcal{S}, o_2 \in \mathcal{O}_2, \mathbb{O}_2(o_2 | s_2) = \widetilde{p}(o^1_{1,2}, o^1_{2,2}) \Pi^2_{j=1} \mathbb{O}^2_{j,2}(o^2_{j,2} | s_2)$, and $\forall i \in [2], \mathbb{O}^2_{i,2}(o_{i,2} | s_2)$ is defined as:

$$\mathbb{O}^2_{i,2}(o^2_2 | s_2) = \begin{cases} \frac{1-\alpha_2}{4} & o^2_{i,2} \neq s_2 \\ \frac{1-\alpha_2}{4} + \alpha_2 & o^2_{i,2} = s_2 \\ 0 & \text{o.w.} \end{cases},$$

for $h=3, \forall s_3 \in \mathcal{S}, o_{i,3} \in \mathcal{O}_{i,3}, \mathbb{O}_3(o_3|s_3) = \Pi_{j=1}^2 \mathbb{O}_{j,3}(o_{j,3}|s_3)$, and $\forall i \in [2], \mathbb{O}_{i,3}(o_{i,3}|s_3)$ is defined as:

$$\mathbb{O}_{i,3}(o_{i,3}|s_3) = \begin{cases} \frac{1-\alpha_2}{4} & o_{i,3} \neq s_3 \\ \frac{1-\alpha_2}{4} + \alpha_2 & o_{i,3} = s_3 \\ 0 & \text{o.w.} \end{cases}.$$

- Reward functions:

$$\mathcal{R}_1(s_1, a_1) = \mathcal{R}_2(s_2, a_2) = 0, \ \ \forall s_1, s_2 \in \mathcal{S}, a_1 \in \mathcal{A}_1, a_2 \in \mathcal{A}_2;$$
$$\mathcal{R}_3(s_3, a_3) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } a_{1,3} = s_3^2 \text{ and } a_{2,3} = s_3^1 \\ 0 & \text{o.w.} \end{cases}.$$

- Communication cost functions:

$$\forall h \in [2], z_h^{\mathrm{a}} \in \mathcal{Z}_h^{\mathrm{a}}, \mathcal{K}_h(z_h^{\mathrm{a}}) = 1 \qquad \text{if } z_h^{\mathrm{a}} \neq \{m_h\}, \text{ else } 0;$$
$$\mathcal{K}_3(z_3^{\mathrm{a}}) = \begin{cases} \widetilde{c}(o_{1,2}^1, o_{2,2}^1, 1, 1)/\alpha_1 & \text{if } a_{1,2}, a_{2,2} \in z_3^{\mathrm{a}}, a_{1,2}^1 = 0, a_{2,2}^1 = 0 \\ \widetilde{c}(o_{1,2}^1, o_{2,2}^1, 2, 1)/\alpha_1 & \text{if } a_{1,2}, a_{2,2} \in z_3^{\mathrm{a}}, a_{1,2}^2 = 0, a_{2,2}^1 = 0 \\ \widetilde{c}(o_{1,2}^1, o_{2,2}^1, 1, 2)/\alpha_1 & \text{if } a_{1,2}, a_{2,2} \in z_3^{\mathrm{a}}, a_{1,2}^1 = 0, a_{2,2}^2 = 0 \\ \widetilde{c}(o_{1,2}^1, o_{2,2}^1, 2, 2)/\alpha_1 & \text{if } a_{1,2}, a_{2,2} \in z_3^{\mathrm{a}}, a_{1,2}^2 = 0, a_{2,2}^2 = 0 \\ 0 & \text{o.w.} \end{cases}.$$

Let $\alpha_0 = \max_{y_1, y_2, u_1, u_2} \widetilde{c}(y_1, y_2, u_1, u_2)$, which is supposed to be positive without loss of optimality (see a discussion in §B-C). We set $\alpha_1 = 2\alpha_0$, and hence for any $z_3^{\mathrm{a}} \in \mathcal{Z}_3^{\mathrm{a}}$, $\mathcal{K}_3(z_3^{\mathrm{a}}) \leq \frac{1}{2}$ always holds. We set $\alpha_2 \in (0,1)$. Also, we restrict agents to decide their communication strategies only based on their common information. Under such a construction, $\mathcal{L}$ satisfies the following conditions:

- $\mathcal{L}$ is QC: For any $i_1, i_2 \in [2], h_1, h_2 \in [3]$, agent $(i_1, h_1)$ does not influence $(i_2, h_2)$, because agent $(i_1, h_1)$ cannot influence the observation of agent $(i_2, h_2)$, and the baseline sharing is null.
- $\mathcal{L}$ satisfies Assumptions III.1 and III.7: We prove this by showing that each agent $i \in [2]$ satisfies $\gamma$-observability. For any $i \in [2], h = 1, b_1, b_2 \in \Delta(\mathcal{S})$, we have

$$\begin{aligned}
\|\mathbb{O}_{i,h}^\top (b_1 - b_2)\|_1 &= \sum_{o_{i,h}^1 \in [2]} \sum_{o_{i,h}^2 \in \mathcal{S}} \left| \sum_{s_h \in \mathcal{S}} (b_1(s_h) - b_2(s_h)) \mathbb{O}_{i,h}((o_{i,h}^1, o_{i,h}^2)|s_h) \right| \\
&\geq \sum_{o_{i,h}^2 \in \mathcal{S}} \left| \sum_{o_{i,h}^1 \in [2]} \sum_{s_h \in \mathcal{S}} (b_1(s_h) - b_2(s_h)) \mathbb{O}_{i,h}((o_{i,h}^1, o_{i,h}^2)|s_h) \right| \\
&= \sum_{o_{i,h}^2 \in \mathcal{S}} \left| \sum_{s_h \in \mathcal{S}} \sum_{o_{i,h}^1 \in [2]} (b_1(s_h) - b_2(s_h)) \mathbb{1}[o_{i,h}^1 = s_h^{i+2h-2}] (\frac{1-\alpha_2}{4} + \alpha_2 \mathbb{1}[o_{i,h}^2 = s_h]) \right| \\
&= \sum_{o_{i,h}^2 \in \mathcal{S}} \left| \frac{1-\alpha_2}{4} (\sum_{s_h \in \mathcal{S}} (b_1(s_h) - b_2(s_h))) + \alpha_2 (b_1(o_{i,h}^2) - b_2(o_{i,h}^2)) \right| \\
&= \sum_{o_{i,h}^2 \in \mathcal{S}} \alpha_2 |b_1(o_{i,h}^2) - b_2(o_{i,h}^2)| = \alpha_2 \|b_1 - b_2\|_1.
\end{aligned}$$

For any $i \in [2], h = 2, 3$, the proof is similar, by replacing $o^1_{i,h} \in [2]$ with $o^1_{i,h} \in \widetilde{Y}_i$ for $h = 2$ and replacing the space $o^1_{i,h} \in [2]$ with $\{\emptyset\}$ for $h = 3$.

- $\mathcal{L}$ satisfies Assumption III.4, since we restrict agents to decide their communication actions only based on the common information.
- $\mathcal{L}$ does not satisfy Assumption III.5, since the joint control action histories $a_{1:3}$ do not influence the underlying states, but they are not removed in the information.

Now, we show that any team-optimal strategy of $\mathcal{L}$ will give us the decision rules $\gamma_1, \gamma_2$ to solve $\mathcal{TD}$. Given $(g^{\mathrm{a},*}_{1:3}, g^{m,*}_{1:3})$ being a team-optimal strategy of $\mathcal{L}$, we can construct $(g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{1:3}, g^{m,'}_{1:3})$ as

$$\forall i \in [2], \forall \tau_{i,1^-}, \tau_{i,2^-}, \tau_{i,3^-}, g^{m,'}_{i,1}(\tau_{i,1^-}) = (0), \quad g^{m,'}_{i,2}(\tau_{i,2^-}) = (0,0,0), g^{m,'}_{i,3}(\tau_{i,3^-}) = 1$$

$$\forall i \in [2], \forall \tau_{i,2^+}, g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{i,2}(\tau_{i,2^+}) = \begin{cases} (0, o_{i,1}) & \text{if the first term of } [g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{i,2}(\tau_{i,2^+})] \text{ is } 0 \\ (o_{i,1}, 0) & \text{o.w.} \end{cases}$$

$$\forall i \in [2], \forall \tau_{i,3^+}, g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{i,3}(\tau_{i,3^+}) = \begin{cases} a^2_{3-i,2} & \text{if } a^1_{3-i,2} = 0 \\ a^1_{3-i,2} & \text{o.w.} \end{cases}.$$

One can verify that $J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{\mathrm{a},*}_{1:3}, g^{m,*}_{1:3}) \le J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{1:3}, g^{m,'}_{1:3})$. This is because, $(g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{1:3}, g^{m,'}_{1:3})$ can always achieve $r_3 = 1$, which means $\mathbb{E}[\sum_{h=1}^3 r_h | (g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{1:3}, g^{m,'}_{1:3})] \ge \mathbb{E}[\sum_{h=1}^3 r_h | g^{\mathrm{a},*}_{1:3}, g^{m,*}_{1:3}]$. Also, at timesteps $h = 1, 2$, $(g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{1:3}, g^{m,'}_{1:3})$ has no additional sharing; if $(g^{\mathrm{a},*}_{1:3}, g^{m,*}_{1:3})$ has additional sharing, then the communication cost $\sum_{h=1}^3 \kappa_h$ is at least 1; if $(g^{\mathrm{a},*}_{1:3}, g^{m,*}_{1:3})$ has no additional sharing, then $(g^{\mathrm{a},*}_{1:3}, g^{m,*}_{1:3})$ and $(g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{1:3}, g^{m,'}_{1:3})$ have the same communication cost of $\sum_{h=1}^3 \kappa_h = \kappa_3 \le \frac{1}{2}$. Therefore, $\mathbb{E}[\sum_{h=1}^3 \kappa_h | (g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{1:3}, g^{m,'}_{1:3})] \le \mathbb{E}[\sum_{h=1}^3 \kappa_h | g^{\mathrm{a},*}_{1:3}, g^{m,*}_{1:3}]$, and thus $J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{\mathrm{a},*}_{1:3}, g^{m,*}_{1:3}) \le J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{1:3}, g^{m,'}_{1:3})$.

From the above, we know that $(g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{1:3}, g^{m,'}_{1:3})$ is also a team-optimal strategy. Let $U_1 = f_1(a_{1,2}) := 2 - \mathbb{1}[a^1_{1,2} = 0], U_2 = f_2(a_{2,2}) := 2 - \mathbb{1}[a^1_{2,2} = 0]$, then $J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{1:3}, g^{m,'}_{1:3}) = \mathbb{E}[\sum_{h=1}^3 r_h - \kappa_h | g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{1:3}, g^{m,'}_{1:3}] = 1 - \mathbb{E}[\kappa_3 | g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{1:3}, g^{m,'}_{1:3}] = 1 - \frac{1}{\alpha_1}\mathbb{E}[\widetilde{c}(o^1_{1,2}, o^1_{2,2}, U_1, U_2)]$, where $U_1 = f_1(a_{1,2}) = f_1(g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{1,2}(\tau_{1,2^+})), U_2 = f_2(a_{2,2}) = f_2(g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{2,2}(\tau_{2,2^+}))$, which means that $(g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{1,2}, g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{2,2})$ can minimize $\kappa_3$ through properly choosing $a_2$ (and $U_{1:2}$) if there is no additional sharing in the first two timesteps, i.e., $\tau_{i,2^+} = \{o_{i,1}, a_{i,1}, o_{i,2}, m_{1:2}\}$. By construction, $\kappa_3$ only depends on $o^1_{1,2}, o^1_{2,2}$, and $U_{1:2}$, and is irrelevant of $\{o_{1,1}, a_{1,1}, o^2_{1,2}\}$, and $m_{i,1} = (0), m_{i,2} = (0,0,0), \forall i \in [2]$ always hold. Hence, $\{o_{1,1}, o_{1,2}, o^2_{1,3}\}$ are useless information for agent 1 to choose $a_{1,2}$ (and $U_1$), and to minimize $\mathbb{E}[\kappa_3]$. Therefore, not using them in $g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{1,2}$ does not lose any optimality. Hence, we can consider the $g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{1,2}$ that only has $o^1_{1,2}$ as input. In the same way, we can consider the $g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{2,2}$ that only has $o^1_{2,2}$ as input. Therefore, $J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{1:3}, g^{m,'}_{1:3}) = 1 - \sum_{o^1_{1,3}, o^2_{1,3}} \frac{1}{\alpha_1}\widetilde{c}(o^1_{1,2}, o^1_{2,2}, f_1(g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{1,2}(o^1_{1,2})), f_2(g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{2,2}(o^1_{2,2})))\widetilde{p}(o^1_{1,2}, o^1_{2,2})$. Further, we can leverage $\widetilde{\gamma}^*_1 = f_1 \circ g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{1,2}, \widetilde{\gamma}^*_2 = f_2 \circ g^{\mathrm{a},'}_{2,2}$ to minimize the expected cost $\widetilde{J}$ of the TDP, where $\circ$ denotes function composition. Therefore, from the NP-hardness of TDPs [33, Corollary 4.1], we complete our proof. □

## B-E Proof of Lemma III.8

*Proof.* We prove this by showing a reduction from the hardness of finding an $\epsilon$-optimal strategy for POMDPs (Proposition B.3). Given any POMDP $\mathcal{P} = (\mathcal{S}^{\mathcal{P}}, \mathcal{A}^{\mathcal{P}}, \mathcal{O}^{\mathcal{P}}, \{\mathbb{O}^{\mathcal{P}}_h\}_{h\in[H^{\mathcal{P}}]}, \{\mathbb{T}^{\mathcal{P}}_h\}_{h\in[H^{\mathcal{P}}]}, \{\mathcal{R}^{\mathcal{P}}_h\}_{h\in[H^{\mathcal{P}}]}, \mu^{\mathcal{P}}_1)$ with rewards bounded in $[0, \frac{1}{2}]$, we can construct an LTC $\mathcal{L}$ with 2 agents as follows:

- Number of agents: $n = 2$; length of episode: $H = H^{\mathcal{P}}$.

- $\mathcal{S} = \mathcal{S}^{\mathcal{P}} \times [2]$; for any $s \in \mathcal{S}$, we can split state as two parts: $s = (s^1, s^2), s^1 \in \mathcal{S}, s^2 \in [2]$.
- Initial state distribution: $\forall s_1 \in \mathcal{S}, \mu_1(s_1) = \frac{\mu_1^{\mathcal{P}}(s_1^1)}{2}$.
- Control action space: For any $h \in [H]$, $\mathcal{A}_{1,h} = \mathcal{A}_h^{\mathcal{P}}, \mathcal{A}_{2,h} = [2]$.
- Transition: For any $h \in [H]$, $\forall s_h, s_{h+1} \in \mathcal{S}, a_h \in \mathcal{A}_h, \mathbb{T}_h(s_{h+1} | s_h, a_h) = \mathbb{T}_h^{\mathcal{P}}(s_{h+1}^1 | s_h^1, a_{1,h}) \mathbb{1}[s_{h+1}^2 = a_{2,h}]$.
- Observation space: For any $h \in [H]$, $\mathcal{O}_{1,h} = \mathcal{O}^{\mathcal{P}}, \mathcal{O}_{2,h} = \mathcal{S}$.
- Emission: For any $h \in [H], \forall o_h \in \mathcal{O}_h, s_h \in \mathcal{S}$, $\mathbb{O}_h(o_h | s_h) = \mathbb{O}_h^{\mathcal{P}}(o_{1,h} | s_h^1) \mathbb{1}[o_{2,h} = s_h]$.
- Reward functions: For any $h \in [H]$, $\forall s_h \in \mathcal{S}, a_h \in \mathcal{A}_h, \mathcal{R}_h(s_h, a_h) = \mathcal{R}_h^{\mathcal{P}}(s_h^1, a_{1,h})/H$.
- Baseline sharing: For any $h \in [H], z_h^{\mathrm{b}} = \{o_{1,h}, a_{1,h-1}\}$.
- Communication action space: For any $h \in [H], \mathcal{M}_{1,h} = \{\emptyset\}, \mathcal{M}_{2,h} = \{0,1\}^{2h-1}$. For any $p_{1,h^-} \in \mathcal{P}_{1,h^-}, p_{2,h^-} \in \mathcal{P}_{2,h^-}, m_h \in \mathcal{M}_h, \phi_{1,h}(p_{1,h^-}, m_{1,h}) = \{m_{1,h}\}, \phi_{2,h}(p_{2,h^-}, m_{2,h}) = \{o_{2,k} | \forall k \le h,$ the $2k-1$-th digit of $m_{2,h}$ is 1 and $o_{2,k} \in p_{2,h^-}\} \cup \{a_{2,k} | \forall k < h,$ the $2k$-th digit of $m_{2,h}$ is 1 and $a_{2,k} \in p_{2,h^-}\} \cup \{m_{2,h}\}$.
- Communication cost functions: For any $h \in [H], z_h^{\mathrm{a}} \in \mathcal{Z}_h^{\mathrm{a}}, \mathcal{K}_h(z_h^{\mathrm{a}}) = \mathbb{1}[z_h^{\mathrm{a}} \neq \{m_h\}]$, which means that the communication cost is 1 unless there is no additional sharing.
- We restrict the communication strategy to only use $c_h$ as input.

We first verify that $\mathcal{L}$ is QC and satisfies Assumptions III.1, III.4, and III.5.

- $\mathcal{L}$ is QC: For any $\forall h_1 < h_2 \le H$, agent $(2, h_1)$ does not influence agent $(1, h_2)$ under baseline sharing, since agent $(2, h_1)$ does not influence $s_h^1, \forall h \in [H]$, then does not influence $o_{1,h}, \forall h \in [H]$. Also, agent 2 shares nothing via baseline sharing. Therefore, agent $(2, h_1)$ does not influence agent $(1, h_2)$. For any $h_1 < h_2 \le H$, under baseline sharing, $p_{1,h_1^-} = \emptyset$. Then, we have $\sigma(\tau_{1,h_1^-}) \subseteq \sigma(c_{h_1^-}) \subseteq \sigma(c_{h_2^-}) \subseteq \sigma(\tau_{2,h_2^-})$.
- $\mathcal{L}$ satisfies Assumption III.1: For any $h \in [H], b_1, b_2 \in \Delta(\mathcal{S})$, $\mathbb{O}_h$ satisfies that

$$
\begin{aligned}
\|\mathbb{O}_h^\top (b_1 - b_2)\|_1 &= \sum_{o_{1,h} \in \mathcal{O}^{\mathcal{P}}} \sum_{o_{2,h} \in \mathcal{S}} \left| \sum_{s_h \in \mathcal{S}} (b_1(s_h) - b_2(s_h)) \mathbb{O}_h((o_{1,h}, o_{2,h}) | s_h) \right| \\
&\ge \sum_{o_{2,h} \in \mathcal{S}} \left| \sum_{o_{1,h} \in \mathcal{O}^{\mathcal{P}}} \sum_{s_h \in \mathcal{S}} (b_1(s_h) - b_2(s_h)) \mathbb{O}_{1,h}(o_{1,h} | s_h) \mathbb{O}_{2,h}(o_{2,h} | s_h) \right| \\
&= \sum_{o_{2,h} \in \mathcal{S}} \left| \sum_{s_h \in \mathcal{S}} (b_1(s_h) - b_2(s_h)) \mathbb{O}_{2,h}(o_{2,h} | s_h) \sum_{o_{1,h} \in \mathcal{O}^{\mathcal{P}}} \mathbb{O}_{1,h}(o_{1,h} | s_h) \right| \\
&= \sum_{o_{2,h} \in \mathcal{S}} \left| \sum_{s_h \in \mathcal{S}} (b_1(s_h) - b_2(s_h)) \mathbb{1}[o_{2,h} = s_h] \right| \\
&= \sum_{o_{2,h} \in \mathcal{S}} |b_1(o_{2,h}) - b_2(o_{2,h})| = \|b_1 - b_2\|_1,
\end{aligned}
$$

  showing that $\gamma$-observability is satisfied with $\gamma = 1$.

- $\mathcal{L}$ satisfies Assumption III.4: For any $h \in [H]$, we restricted that each agent $i$ decides $m_{i,h}$ based on $c_h$ only.
- $\mathcal{L}$ satisfies Assumption III.5: For any $h \in [H-1], a_{1,h}$ influences $s^1_{h+1}$, $a_{2,h}$ influences $s^2_{h+1}$.
- $\mathcal{L}$ does not satisfy Assumption III.7. This is because for any $h \in [H]$ and fixed $s^1_h \in \mathcal{S}^{\mathcal{P}}$, we can define $s^1 = (s^1_h, 1), s^2 = (s^1_h, 2)$, and $b_1 = \delta_{s^1} \in \Delta(\mathcal{S}), b_2 = \delta_{s^2} \in \Delta(\mathcal{S})$, where $\delta_{s^1}, \delta_{s^2}$ denote the distributions over $\mathcal{S}$ only with mass on $s^1, s^2$, respectively. Then, one can verify that $b_1 \neq b_2$ but $\mathbb{O}^\top_{-1,h} b_1 = \mathbb{O}^\top_{-1,h} b_2$.

Consider the communication strategy $g^{m,'}_{1:H}$ that yields no additional sharing, namely, $\forall h \in [H], \tau_{2,h^-} \in \mathcal{T}_{2,h^-}, g^{m,'}_{2,h}(\tau_{2,h^-}) = \mathbf{0}_h$. For any $\epsilon$-optimal strategy $(g^{\mathrm{a},*}_{1:H}, g^{m,*}_{1:H})$ with $\epsilon \in [0, \frac{1}{4})$, we claim that $(g^{\mathrm{a},*}_{1:H}, g^{m,'}_{1:H})$ is also an $\epsilon$-optimal strategy. This is because, comparing to strategy $(g^{\mathrm{a},*}_{1:H}, g^{m,'}_{1:H})$, for the trajectories where $(g^{\mathrm{a},*}_{1:H}, g^{m,*}_{1:H})$ leads to no additional sharing, these two strategies output the same actions and gain the same total return; for the other trajectories where $(g^{\mathrm{a},*}_{1:H}, g^{m,*}_{1:H})$ leads to some additional sharing, i.e., $z_h \neq \{m_h\}$ for some $h \in [H]$, then it has the return of $\sum_{t=1}^H (r_t - \kappa_t) \leq \sum_{t=1}^H (r_t) - \kappa_h \leq \frac{1}{2H} \cdot H - 1 < 0$, which is less than when replacing it by $(g^{\mathrm{a},*}_{1:H}, g^{m,'}_{1:H})$ with return $\sum_{t=1}^H (r_t - \kappa_t) = \sum_{t=1}^H r_t \geq 0$. Therefore, $J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{\mathrm{a},*}_{1:H}, g^{m,'}_{1:H}) \geq J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{\mathrm{a},*}_{1:H}, g^{m,*}_{1:H})$, and $(g^{\mathrm{a},*}_{1:H}, g^{m,'}_{1:H})$ is also an $\epsilon$-optimal strategy with $\epsilon \in [0, \frac{1}{4})$.

Meanwhile, any $(g^{\mathrm{a},*}_{1:H}, g^{m,'}_{1:H})$ being an $\frac{\epsilon}{H}$-team-optimal strategy of $\mathcal{L}$ will directly give an $\epsilon$-team-optimal strategy of $\mathcal{P}$ as $\{g^{\mathrm{a},*}_{1,h}\}_{h \in [H]}$, since when there is no sharing, the decision process is only controlled by agent 1. From Proposition B.3, we complete the proof. □

**Remark B.5.** For each construction in the proofs of Lemmas III.2, III.3, III.6, and III.8, if we slightly change the construction to make it satisfy the corresponding assumption, then the associated hardness can be avoided. For example, if we require the constructed instance in the proof of Lemma III.3 to satisfy Assumption III.4, i.e., the communication strategy $g^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:3}$ only takes common information as input. Then, finding the optimal communication strategy at timestep $h = 3$ can no longer be reduced to TDPs, and such LTC problems can be computed via Algorithm 1 in polynomial time.

# C. Deferred Details of §IV

## C-A Proof of Proposition IV.1

*Proof.* Given any strategy $(g^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}, g^m_{1:H}), g^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H} \in \mathcal{G}^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}, g^m_{1:H} \in \mathcal{G}^m_{1:H}$, we can define $\widetilde{g}_{1:\widetilde{H}} = (g^m_1, g^{\mathrm{a}}_1, \cdots, g^m_H, g^{\mathrm{a}}_H)$. From the construction of $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$, comparing to applying $(g^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}, g^m_{1:H})$ in $\mathcal{L}$, if we apply $\widetilde{g}_{1:\widetilde{H}}$ in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$, then it is easy to verify that $\forall h \in [H], \widetilde{r}_{2h-1} = -\kappa_h, \widetilde{r}_{2h} = r_h$ always holds. Therefore, $J_{\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\widetilde{g}_{1:\widetilde{H}}) = J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}, g^m_{1:H})$. In the same way, for any strategy $\widetilde{g}_{1:\widetilde{H}}$, we can define $\widetilde{g}_{1:\widetilde{H}} = (g^m_1, g^{\mathrm{a}}_1, \cdots, g^m_H, g^{\mathrm{a}}_H)$, and verify that $J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}, g^m_{1:H}) = J_{\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\widetilde{g}_{1:\widetilde{H}})$. □

## C-B Proof of Theorem IV.2

*Proof.* Firstly, we prove the QC case. To show $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ is QC, we need to prove that $\forall i_1, i_2 \in [n], h_1, h_2 \in [\widetilde{H}]$, if agent $(i_1, h_1)$ influences agent $(i_2, h_2)$ with $h_1 < h_2$, then $\sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$, where we use $\widetilde{\tau}_{i,h}$ to denote the information available to agent $(i,h)$ in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$. We prove it by considering the following cases:

- If $h_1 = 2t_1 - 1$ with $t_1 \in [H]$, by the construction of $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ and Assumption III.4, we have $\widetilde{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} = \widetilde{c}_{h_1} = c_{t_1^-} \subseteq \widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}$, since common information accumulates over time by definition, and will always be included in the available information $\widetilde{\tau}_{i,h}$ in later steps with $h > h_1$. Thus, $\sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$.

- If $h_1 = 2t_1, h_2 = 2t_2$ with $t_1, t_2 \in [H]$, then $\widetilde{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} = \tau_{i_1,t_1^+} = \tau_{i_1,t_1^-} \cup z^{\mathrm{a}}_{t_1}$ by definition. Consider agent $(i_1, t_1)$ and $(i_2, t_2)$ in $\mathcal{L}$. From Lemma B.2, we know that if any agent in a control step influences another agent in a control step in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$, then the former also influences the latter in $\mathcal{L}$ under baseline sharing, and thus $\sigma(\tau_{i_1,t_1^-}) \subseteq \sigma(\tau_{i_2,t_2^-})$ since $\mathcal{L}$ is QC. This further implies $\sigma(\tau_{i_1,t_1^-}) \subseteq \sigma(\tau_{i_2,t_2^+})$ since $\sigma(\tau_{i_2,t_2^-}) \subseteq \sigma(\tau_{i_2,t_2^+})$. Also, $z^{\mathrm{a}}_{t_1} \subseteq c_{t_1^+} \subseteq c_{t_2^+} \subseteq \tau_{i_2,t_2^+} = \widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}$ by the accumulation of $c_{h^+}$ over time. Thus, we have $\sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$.
- If $h_1 = 2t_1, h_2 = 2t_2 - 1, t_1, t_2 \in [H]$, then $\widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,h_2} = \widetilde{c}_{h_2}$. Hence, $\exists i_3 \in [n], i_3 \neq i_1$, such that $\widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,h_2} \subseteq \widetilde{c}_{h_2+1} \subseteq \widetilde{\tau}_{i_3,h_2+1}$. Since agent $(i_1, h_1)$ influences agent $(i_2, h_2)$, we know that agent $(i_1, h_1)$ also influences agent $(i_3, h_2 + 1)$ in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$. From Lemma B.2, similarly as above, we know that $\sigma(\tau_{i_1,t_1^-}) \subseteq \sigma(\tau_{i_3,t_2^-})$ since $\mathcal{L}$ is QC. From Assumption II.2 and $i_1 \neq i_3$, we know that $\sigma(\tau_{i_1,t_1^-}) \subseteq \sigma(c_{t_2^-}) = \sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$. Also, it holds that $\tau_{i_1,t_1^+} \backslash \tau_{i_1,t_1^-} \subseteq c_{t_1^+} \subseteq c_{t_2^-}$. Hence, we have $\sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) = \sigma(\tau_{i_1,t_1^+}) \subseteq \sigma(c_{t_2^-}) = \sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$.

Secondly, we prove the sQC case. In $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$, for any $i_1, i_2 \in [n], h_1, h_2 \in [\widetilde{H}]$, suppose agent $(i_1, h_1)$ influences $(i_2, h_2)$. From the proof above, we know that $\sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$. We only need to prove $\sigma(\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$.

- If $h_1 = 2t_1 - 1$ with $t_1 \in [H]$, then we know that $\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1} = m_{i_1,t_1}$. From Assumption II.1, we know that $m_{i_1,t_1} \subseteq z^{\mathrm{a}}_{i_1,t_1}$. Then, we get $\sigma(\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{z}_{h_1+1}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{c}_{h_2}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$.
- If $h_1 = 2t_1, h_2 = 2t_2$ with $t_1, t_2 \in [H]$, then from Lemma B.2, we know that $\sigma(\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$.
- If $h_1 = 2t_1, h_2 = 2t_2 - 1$ with $t_1, t_2 \in [H]$, then $\widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,h_2} = \widetilde{c}_{h_2}$. Hence, $\exists i_3 \in [n], i_3 \neq i_1$, such that $\widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,h_2} \subseteq \widetilde{c}_{h_2+1} \subseteq \widetilde{\tau}_{i_3,h_2+1}$. Since agent $(i_1, h_1)$ influences $(i_2, h_2)$, we thus know that agent $(i_1, h_1)$ also influences agent $(i_3, h_2 + 1)$. Since $\mathcal{L}$ is sQC, we know that $\sigma(a_{i_1,t_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\tau_{i_3,t_2^-})$ in $\mathcal{L}$ by Lemma B.2. From Assumption II.2 and $i_1 \neq i_3$, we know that $\sigma(\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1}) = \sigma(a_{i_1,t_1}) \subseteq \sigma(c_{t_2^-}) = \sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$.

This completes the proof. □

## C-C Proof of Lemma IV.3

*Proof.* From the construction of $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$, since $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$ requires agents to share more than $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$, it is easy to observe that $\forall h \in [\widetilde{H}], i \in [n], \widetilde{c}_h \subseteq \check{c}_h, \widetilde{\tau}_{i,h} \subseteq \check{\tau}_{i,h}$.
Let $i_1, i_2 \in [n], h_1, h_2 \in [\widetilde{H}], h_1 < h_2$, and agent $(i_1, h_1)$ influences agent $(i_2, h_2)$ in $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$.

- If $h_1 = 2t_1 - 1$ with $t_1 \in [H]$, then $h_1$ is a communication step. Hence, $\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} = \check{c}_{h_1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_2}$ and $\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1} = m_{i_1,t_1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_1+1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_2}$ from Assumption II.1. Therefore, we have $\sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \cup \sigma(\check{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{c}_{h_2}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$.
- If $h_1 = 2t_1, h_2 = 2t_2 - 1$ with $t_1, t_2 \in [H]$, then $\check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2} = \check{c}_{h_2}$. If agent $(i_1, h_1)$ does not influence $(i_2, h_2)$ in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$, but agent $(i_1, h_1)$ influences $(i_2, h_2)$ in $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$, then it means $\check{a}_{i_1,h_1} \in \check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}$ but $\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1} \notin \widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}$. This can only happen when $\sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{c}_{h_2}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{c}_{h_2})$, and $\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_2}$. Also, from the construction of $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$, we know that $\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} \backslash \widetilde{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_1}$. Therefore, we have $\sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \cup \sigma(\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{c}_{h_2}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$.

  If agent $(i_1, h_1)$ influences agent $(i_2, h_2)$ in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$, then we claim that $\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1}$ influences $\widetilde{s}_{h_1+1}$ in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$, since otherwise, $\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1}$ does not influence any $\widetilde{s}_h, \widetilde{o}_h$, and $\widetilde{a}_h$ with $h > h_1$; also, from Assumption III.5, $\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1}$ is removed from $\widetilde{\tau}_h, \forall h > h_1$, and thus agent $(i_1, h_1)$ cannot influence agent $(i_2, h_2)$. Meanwhile, from the QC IS of $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$, we know that $\sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}) = \sigma(\widetilde{c}_{h_2})$. Then, from the construction of $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$, we know that $\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1}$ is added in $\check{c}_{h_2}$, i.e., $\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1} \in \check{c}_{h_2}$. Still, due to $\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} \backslash \widetilde{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_1}$, we further have $\sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \cup \sigma(\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$.

- If $h_1 = 2t_1, h_2 = 2t_2$ with $t_1, t_2 \in [H]$. If agent $(i_1, h_1)$ does not influence $(i_2, h_2)$ in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$, then it means that adding $\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1}$ in $\check{c}_{h_2}$ via strict expansion leads to such influence. Then, it must hold that $\sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{c}_{h_2}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{c}_{h_2})$, and $\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_2}$. We can conclude $\sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \cup \sigma(\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{c}_{h_2}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$.
  If agent $(i_1, h_1)$ influences $(i_2, h_2)$ in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$, then we know that $\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1}$ influences $\widetilde{s}_{h_1+1}$ in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$, similarly as shown in the case for $h_2 = 2t_2 - 1$. Therefore, from Assumption III.7, we know that there exists some $i_3 \neq i_1$ such that agent $\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1}$ influences agent $(i_3, h_1 + 1)$ in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$. Then, from the QC IS of $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$, we know that $\sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_3,h_1+1})$. Meanwhile, from Assumption II.1 (e), we know that $\widetilde{\tau}_{i_3,h_1+1} \subseteq \widetilde{\tau}_{i_3,h_2}$. Therefore, we can get $\sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_3,h_2})$ and further $\sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{c}_{h_2})$ due to Assumption II.2 and $i_3 \neq i_1$. Then, from the construction of $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$, we know that $\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1}$ is added in $\check{c}_{h_2}$. Together with $\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} \backslash \widetilde{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_2}$, we can conclude that $\sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \cup \sigma(\check{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{h_2})$.

This completes the proof. □

## C-D Proof of Theorem IV.4

*Proof.* Firstly, we claim that given any strategy $\check{g}_{1:\check{H}}$ and $\widetilde{g}_{1:\widetilde{H}} = \varphi(\check{g}_{1:\check{H}}, \mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}})$, $J_{\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\check{g}_{1:\check{H}}) = J_{\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\widetilde{g}_{1:\widetilde{H}})$, where the function $\varphi$ is given by Algorithm 3. It suffices to prove that $\widetilde{g}_{i,h}(\widetilde{\tau}_{i,h}) = \check{g}_{i,h}(\check{\tau}_{i,h})$ always holds for any $\widetilde{\tau}_{i,h}$. Namely, for any $i \in [n], h \in [\widetilde{H}]$, and $\widetilde{\tau}_{i,h}$, Algorithm 3 can compute the associated $\check{\tau}_{i,h}$ from the expansion in Equation (IV.1), and use it as the input of $\check{g}_{i,h}$ (Line 11 in Algorithm 3). Let $\check{\tau}'_{i,h}$ be the information constructed by Algorithm 3, which is the input of $\check{g}_{i,h}$ used in Line 11 in the algorithm. From the construction of the algorithm and the expansion, we have $\widetilde{\tau}_{i,h} \subseteq \check{\tau}'_{i,h}, \widetilde{\tau}_{i,h} \subseteq \check{\tau}_{i,h}$; $\check{\tau}_{i,h} \backslash \widetilde{\tau}_{i,h}$ and $\check{\tau}'_{i,h} \backslash \widetilde{\tau}_{i,h}$ only consist of some actions. For any action $\check{a}_{j,t}$ with $j \in [n], t < h$, it will be added in $\check{\tau}'_{i,h} \backslash \widetilde{\tau}_{i,h}$ if and only if it lies in $\check{\tau}_{i,h} \backslash \widetilde{\tau}_{i,h}$, since we use the same condition in construction in the algorithm as that in the expansion (i.e., Equation (IV.1)).

Since $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$ has larger strategy spaces, we have$\max_{\widetilde{g}_{1:\widetilde{H}} \in \widetilde{G}_{1:\widetilde{H}}} J_{\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\widetilde{g}_{1:\widetilde{H}}) \leq \max_{\check{g}_{1:\check{H}} \in \check{G}_{1:\check{H}}} J_{\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\check{g}_{1:\check{H}})$. Let $\check{g}^*_{1:\check{H}}$ be the strategy satisfying $J_{\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\check{g}^*_{1:\check{H}}) \geq \max_{\check{g}_{1:\check{H}} \in \check{G}_{1:\check{H}}} J_{\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\check{g}_{1:\check{H}}) - \epsilon$. Then, we have $J_{\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\varphi(\check{g}^*_{1:\check{H}}, \mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}})) = J_{\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\check{g}^*_{1:\check{H}}) \geq \max_{\check{g}_{1:\check{H}} \in \check{G}_{1:\check{H}}} J_{\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\check{g}_{1:\check{H}}) - \epsilon \geq \max_{\widetilde{g}_{1:\widetilde{H}} \in \widetilde{G}_{1:\widetilde{H}}} J_{\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\widetilde{g}_{1:\widetilde{H}}) - \epsilon$. Thus, $\varphi(\check{g}^*_{1:\check{H}}, \mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}})$ is an $\epsilon$-team-optimal strategy of $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$. □

**Lemma C.1.** For any given strategy $\check{g}_{1:\check{H}} \in \check{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\check{H}}$, implementing Algorithm 4 in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ is equivalent to implementing $\varphi(\check{g}_{1:\check{H}}, \mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}})$ in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$.

*Proof.* As shown in Theorem IV.4, Algorithm 3 can compute the associated $\check{\tau}_{i,h}$ and use it as the input of $\check{g}_{i,h}$ (Line 12). Therefore, it suffices to prove that Algorithm 4 can also compute the associated $\check{\tau}_{i,h}$ and use it as the input of $\check{g}_{i,h}$ (Line 6), i.e., Algorithm 5 can output the associated $\check{\tau}_{i,h}$ from $\widetilde{\tau}_{i,h}$ and $\check{g}_{1:h-1}$. We prove this by induction.
Firstly, when $h = 1$, it holds for any $i \in [n]$ such that $\widetilde{\tau}_{i,1} = \check{\tau}_{i,1}$. In Algorithm 5, when $h = 1$, it will never enter the for loop, and thus the output is $\widetilde{\tau}_{i,1} = \check{\tau}_{i,1}$.
Secondly, we assume for any $h < t$, the hypothesis holds. Then, for $h = t$, given any $\widetilde{\tau}_{i,t} \in \widetilde{\mathcal{T}}_{i,t}$ and $\check{g}_{1:t-1}$, let $\check{\tau}'_{i,t}$ be the output of Algorithm 5. For any $j \in [n], h' < t$, if it holds that $\sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{j,h'}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{c}_t)$ in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ and $\widetilde{a}_{j,h'} \notin \widetilde{\tau}_{i,t}$, then it can compute the associated $\check{\tau}_{j,h'}$ from induction hypothesis (Lines 5-6), compute the exact $\check{a}_{j,h'}$ based on $\check{g}_{j,h'}$ (Line 7), and add it into $\check{\tau}'_{i,h}$ (Line 8). Therefore, we know that $\check{\tau}'_{i,t} = \widetilde{\tau}_{i,t} \cup \{\widetilde{a}_{j,h'} | \sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{j,h'}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{c}_t) \text{ and } \widetilde{a}_{j,h'} \notin \widetilde{\tau}_{i,t}\} = \check{\tau}_{i,t}$. By induction, we complete the proof. □

**Remark C.2.** The difference between Algorithms 3 and 4 lies as follows. Given any $\check{g}_{1:\check{H}}$ and $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$, Algorithm 3 needs to recover the output $\widetilde{a}_{i,h}$ of $\widetilde{g}_{i,h}$ under all possible input $\widetilde{\tau}_{i,h} \in \widetilde{\mathcal{T}}_{i,h}, i \in [n], h \in$

$[\widetilde{H}]$, where the cardinality of $\widetilde{\mathcal{T}}_{i,h}$ could be exponentially large. Thus, Algorithm 3 may suffer from computational intractability. However, Algorithm 4 only requires recovering the output $\widetilde{g}_{i,h}$ under the specific $\widetilde{\tau}_{i,h}$ that occurred in the trajectory, which can be implemented in polynomial time.

### C-E Proof of Theorem IV.5

*Proof.* We first suppose that the two strategies only differ in the strategy of only one agent $(i_1, h_1)$, i.e., for any $h \in [2 : \check{H}]$, fix any $h_1 \in [h-1], i_1 \in [n]$, and for any $\check{g}_{1:h-1} \in \check{\mathcal{G}}_{1:h-1}, \check{g}'_{i_1,h_1} \in \check{\mathcal{G}}_{i_1,h_1}$, let $\check{g}'_{h_1} := (\check{g}_{1,h_1}, \cdots, \check{g}'_{i_1,h_1}, \cdots, \check{g}_{n,h_1})$ and $\check{g}'_{1:h-1} := (\check{g}_1, \cdots, \check{g}'_{h_1}, \cdots, \check{g}_{h-1})$. If $\check{c}_h$ is reachable under both $\check{g}_{1:h-1}$ and $\check{g}'_{1:h-1}$, then the following holds

$$\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}^\dagger_{\mathcal{L}}}(\check{s}_h, \check{p}_h \,|\, \check{c}_h, \check{g}_{1:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}^\dagger_{\mathcal{L}}}(\check{s}_h, \check{p}_h \,|\, \check{c}_h, \check{g}'_{1:h-1}). \tag{C.1}$$

We prove this result case by case as follows:

- If there exists some $i_3 \neq i_1$ such that $\sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_3,h})$ and $\sigma(\check{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_3,h})$, then from Assumption II.2, we know that $\sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{c}_h), \sigma(\check{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{c}_h)$. Therefore, there exist deterministic measurable functions $\alpha_1, \alpha_2$ such that $\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} = \alpha_1(\check{c}_h), \check{a}_{i_1,h_1} = \alpha_2(\check{c}_h)$, and further it holds that

  $$\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}^\dagger_{\mathcal{L}}}(\check{s}_h, \check{p}_h \,|\, \check{c}_h, \check{g}_{1:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}^\dagger_{\mathcal{L}}}(\check{s}_h, \check{p}_h \,|\, \alpha_1(\check{c}_h), \alpha_2(\check{c}_h), \check{c}_h, \check{g}_{1:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}^\dagger_{\mathcal{L}}}(\check{s}_h, \check{p}_h \,|\, \check{c}_h, \check{g}'_{1:h-1}).$$

  The last equality is due to the fact that both the input and output of $\check{g}_{i_1,h_1}$ are conditioned on.

- If for any $i_2 \neq i_1$, either $\sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \nsubseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_2,h})$ or $\sigma(\check{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \nsubseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_2,h})$, then agent $(i_1, h_1)$ does not influence any agent $(i_2, h)$ with $i_2 \neq i_1$ in $\mathcal{D}^\dagger_{\mathcal{L}}$, since otherwise, due to the sQC IS of $\mathcal{D}^\dagger_{\mathcal{L}}$, it must hold that $\sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_2,h})$ and $\sigma(\check{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_2,h})$. Moreover, we claim that such an $h_1$ has to be even, since otherwise, the agent will be at a communication step, and we must have $\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} = \check{c}_{h_1} \subseteq \check{c}_h \subseteq \check{\tau}_{i_2,h}$ by Assumption III.4 and the reformulation in §IV-A, and $\check{a}_{i_1,h_1} = m_{i_1,\frac{h_1+1}{2}} \in z^{\mathrm{a}}_{\frac{h_1+1}{2}} = \check{z}_{h_1+1} \subseteq \check{c}_h \subseteq \check{\tau}_{i_2,h}$ by Assumption II.1 (b), which violates the premise of this case. Let $k_1 := h_1/2$. Now, we claim that agent $(i_1, h_1)$ does not influence the state $\check{s}_h$ nor the information $\check{\tau}_{i_1,h}$. We prove this case by case as follows:

  - Suppose $h$ is even. If agent $(i_1, h_1)$ influences $\check{s}_{h_1+1}$, then from Assumption III.7, there exists some $i_3 \neq i_1$ such that agent $(i_1, h_1)$ influences $\check{o}_{i_3,h_1+1}$. However, from Assumption II.1 (e), we know that $\check{o}_{i_3,h_1+1} = o_{i_3,\frac{h_1}{2}+1} \in \tau_{i_3,\frac{h_1}{2}+1} \subseteq \tau_{i_3,\frac{h}{2}} = \widetilde{\tau}_{i_3,h} \subseteq \check{\tau}_{i_3,h}$, which means that agent $(i_1, h_1)$ influences agent $(i_3, h)$, leading to a contradiction. Therefore, we know that agent $(i_1, h_1)$ does not influence $\check{s}_{h_1+1}$, and thus for any $i_2 \in [n]$, it does not influence $\check{o}_{i_2,h_1+1}$. Also, from Assumption III.5, we know that $\check{a}_{i_1,h_1} \notin \check{\tau}_{i_2,h_1+1}$. Therefore, agent $(i_1, h_1)$ does not influence $\check{\tau}_{i_2,h_1+1}$ nor $\check{a}_{i_2,h_1+1}$. By recursion, we know that agent $(i_1, h_1)$ does not influence $\check{s}_{h'}$ nor $\check{\tau}_{i_2,h'}$ $\forall\ i_2 \in [n], h' > h$.
  - Suppose $h$ is odd, then $\check{p}_h = \emptyset$ by §IV-A. If agent $(i_1, h_1)$ influences $\check{s}_h$ in $\mathcal{D}^\dagger_{\mathcal{L}}$, then agent $(i_1, h_1)$ influences $\widetilde{s}_h$ in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$, since strict expansion does not change system dynamics. This implies that agent $(i_1, h_1)$ influences $s_{h_1+1}$ in $\mathcal{L}$, since otherwise, as argued above, it will not influence the later state $\check{s}_h$. Moreover, from Assumption III.7, we know that agent $(i_1, h_1)$ also influences $\widetilde{o}_{-i_1,h}$, i.e., there must exist some $i_3 \neq i_1$ such that agent $(i_1, h_1)$ influences $\widetilde{o}_{i_3,h}$ in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$. From Assumption II.1 (e), it holds that $\widetilde{o}_{i_3,h} \in \widetilde{\tau}_{i_3,h+1}$. Therefore, agent $(i_1, h_1)$

influences agent $(i_3, h+1)$ in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$. From Lemma B.2, we know that $\sigma(\tau_{i_1,k_1^-}) \subseteq \sigma(\tau_{i_3,k^-})$ in $\mathcal{L}$, where $k := (h+1)/2$. Furthermore, from Assumption II.2 and $i_3 \neq i_1$, it holds that $\sigma(\tau_{i_1,k_1^-}) \subseteq \sigma(c_{k^-})$. Also, from §IV-A, it holds that $\widetilde{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} = \tau_{i_1,k_1^+} = \tau_{i_1,k_1^-} \cup z^{\mathrm{a}}_{k_1}$ and $z^{\mathrm{a}}_{k_1} = \widetilde{z}_{h_1} \subseteq \widetilde{c}_h$. Then, we have $\sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{c}_h) = \sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_3,h})$. Based on the strict expansion from $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ to $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$, we can get $\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} \backslash \widetilde{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} \subseteq \check{c}_{h_1} \subseteq \check{\tau}_{i_3,h}$ and $\check{a}_{i_1,h_1} \in \check{c}_h$. Then, it holds that $\sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_3,h}), \sigma(\check{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_3,h})$, which leads to a contradiction to the premise that for any $i_2 \neq i_1$, either $\sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \nsubseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_2,h})$ or $\sigma(\check{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \nsubseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_2,h})$. Hence, we know that agent $(i_1, h_1)$ does not influence the state $\check{s}_h$. Additionally, for any $i_2 \neq i_1$, since agent $(i_1, h_1)$ does not influence agent $(i_2, h)$ in $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$, and $\check{\tau}_{i_1,h} = \check{c}_h = \check{\tau}_{i_2,h}$, then we know that agent $(i_1, h_1)$ does not influence $\check{\tau}_{i_1,h}$.

Combining the two cases above, we know that agent $(i_1, h_1)$ does not influence $\check{s}_h$, $\check{\tau}_{i,h}, \forall i \in [n]$, and $\check{c}_h = \cap_{i=1}^n \check{\tau}_{i,h}$ in $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$, yielding

$$\begin{aligned}
&\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\check{s}_h, \check{p}_h \,|\, \check{c}_h, \check{g}_{1:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\check{s}_h, \check{p}_h, \check{c}_h \,|\, \check{c}_h, \check{g}_{1:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\check{s}_h, \check{\tau}_h \,|\, \check{c}_h, \check{g}_{1:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\check{s}_h, \{\check{\tau}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n]} \,|\, \check{c}_h, \check{g}_{1:h-1}) \\
&= \frac{\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\check{s}_h, \{\check{\tau}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n]}, \check{c}_h \,|\, \check{g}_{1:h-1})}{\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\check{c}_h \,|\, \check{g}_{1:h-1})} = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\check{s}_h, \{\check{\tau}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n]} \,|\, \check{c}_h, \check{g}'_{1:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}}(\check{s}_h, \check{p}_h \,|\, \check{c}_h, \check{g}'_{1:h-1}).
\end{aligned}$$

Now, for any $\check{c}_h \in \check{\mathcal{C}}_h$ and any two strategy $\check{g}_{1:h-1}, \check{g}'_{1:h-1}$ that can reach the realization $\check{c}_h$ (not necessarily only different in the strategy of one agent), we can connect them by finitely many intermediate strategies $(\check{g}^0_{1:h-1} := \check{g}_{1:h-1}, \check{g}^1_{1:h-1}, \cdots, \check{g}^K_{1:h-1} := \check{g}'_{1:h-1})$, replacing the strategy of one agent at a time. We will show that all of these intermediate strategies can reach $\check{c}_h$ by induction. The claim holds for $k = 0$ trivially. Now suppose $\check{g}^{k-1}_{1:h-1}$ can reach $\check{c}_h$ and $\check{g}^k_{1:h-1}$ is constructed by replacing $\check{g}_{i_1,h_1}$ by $\check{g}'_{i_1,h_1}$ for some $i_1 \in [n], h_1 < h$. If there exists some $i_3 \neq i_1$ such that $\sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_3,h})$ and $\sigma(\check{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_3,h})$, then let $\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}$ and $\check{a}_{i_1,h_1}$ be the realization that can be determined by $\check{c}_h$. We know $\check{g}_{i_1,h_1}(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) = \check{g}'_{i_1,h_1}(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) = \check{a}_{i_1,h_1}$ since both $\check{g}_{1:h-1}$ and $\check{g}'_{1:h-1}$ can reach $\check{c}_h$, and thus $\check{g}^k_{1:h-1}$ can also reach $\check{c}_h$; Otherwise, agent $(i_1, h_1)$ can neither influence the state nor the information of other agents from the proof above, so $\check{g}^k_{1:h-1}$ can also reach $\check{c}_h$. Therefore, it suffices to suppose that the two strategies only differ in the strategy of one agent, which completes the proof.

□

## C-F Proof of Theorem IV.6

*Proof.* Firstly, from the construction of $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ and the strategy space $\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}$, we know that for any $h \in [H], i \in [n], \overline{\mathcal{C}}_{2h-1} = \check{\mathcal{C}}_{2h-1}, \overline{\mathcal{A}}_{i,2h-1} = \check{\mathcal{A}}_{i,2h-1}, \overline{\mathcal{T}}_{i,2h} = \check{\mathcal{T}}_{i,2h}, \overline{\mathcal{A}}_{i,2h} = \check{\mathcal{A}}_{i,2h}$. Therefore, $\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}} = \check{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\check{H}}$, and finding a team-optimal strategy of $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ in space $\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}$ is equivalent to finding that of $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$ in the space $\check{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\check{H}}$ by definition.

Secondly, we will prove that the Dec-POMDP $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ satisfies the information evolution rules. From Assumption II.1, it holds that, for any $i \in [n], h \in [\overline{H}]$, if $h = 2t-1$ with $t \in [H]$, then

$$\widetilde{z}_h = \chi_t(\widetilde{p}_{h-1}, \widetilde{a}_{h-1}, \widetilde{o}_h), \qquad p_{i,h} = \xi_{i,t}(\widetilde{p}_{i,h-1}, \widetilde{a}_{i,h-1}, \widetilde{o}_{i,h});$$

if $h = 2t$ with $t \in [H]$, then

$$\widetilde{z}_h = \phi_t(p_{h-1}, \widetilde{a}_{h-1}), \qquad \widetilde{p}_{i,h} = p_{i,h-1} \backslash \phi_{i,t}(p_{i,h-1}, \widetilde{a}_{i,h-1}),$$

where $\chi_t, \xi_{i,t}$ are fixed transformations and $\phi_h, \phi_{i,h}$ are additional-sharing functions. Recall that we

defined $p_{i,2t-1} = p_{i,t^-}$ for any $i \in [n], t \in [H]$. From the expansion (Equation (IV.1)), we know that $\check{z}_h = \check{c}_h \backslash \check{c}_{h-1}$. Also, from the refinement, we know that $\forall i \in [n], h \in [\overline{H}], \overline{z}_h = \check{z}_h, \overline{c}_h = \check{c}_h, \overline{a}_{i,h} = \check{a}_{i,h} = \widetilde{a}_{i,h}, \overline{o}_{i,h} = \check{o}_{i,h} = \widetilde{o}_{i,h}$, and $\forall t \in [H], \overline{p}_{i,2t-1} = p_{i,t^-}, \overline{p}_{i,2t} = \widetilde{p}_{i,2t}$.

Then, we can construct $\{\overline{\chi}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}, \{\overline{\xi}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n],h\in[\overline{H}]}$ accordingly as follows:

- If $h = 2t-1$ with $t \in [H]$, we define $\overline{\chi}_h, \{\overline{\xi}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n]}$ as

$$\forall i \in [n], \overline{\xi}_{i,h} := \xi_{i,t}, \quad \forall \overline{p}_{h-1} \in \overline{\mathcal{P}}_{h-1}, \overline{a}_{h-1} \in \overline{\mathcal{A}}_{h-1}, \overline{o}_h \in \overline{\mathcal{O}}_h,$$
$$\overline{\chi}_h(\overline{p}_{h-1}, \overline{a}_{h-1}, \overline{o}_h) := \chi_t(\overline{p}_{h-1}, \overline{a}_{h-1}, \overline{o}_h) \cup \rho_h^1 \backslash \rho_h^2, \text{ where}$$
$$\rho_h^1 := \{\widetilde{a}_{j,h-1} \mid j \in [n], \sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{j,h-1}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{c}_h), \widetilde{a}_{j,h-1} \text{ influences } \widetilde{s}_h\} \backslash \chi_t(\overline{p}_{h-1}, \overline{a}_{h-1}, \overline{o}_h) \text{ if } h > 1, \text{otherwise } \emptyset.$$
$$\rho_h^2 := \{\widetilde{a}_{j,h_0} \mid j \in [n], h_0 < h-1, \sigma(\widetilde{a}_{j,h_0}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{c}_{h-1}), \widetilde{a}_{j,h_0} \text{ influences } \widetilde{s}_{h_0+1}\} \cap \chi_t(\overline{p}_{h-1}, \overline{a}_{h-1}, \overline{o}_h).$$

Note that there exist some functions $f_h^1, f_h^2$ such that $\rho_h^1 = f_h^1(\overline{p}_{h-1}, \overline{a}_{h-1}, \overline{o}_h), \rho_h^2 = f_h^2(\overline{p}_{h-1}, \overline{a}_{h-1}, \overline{o}_h)$. This is because, $\rho_h^1 \subseteq \{\overline{a}_{i,h-1}\}_{i\in[n]}$; which element $\overline{a}_{j,h-1}$ is in $\rho_h^1$ is based on whether $\sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{j,h-1}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{c}_h)$ and whether $\widetilde{a}_{j,h-1}$ influences $\widetilde{s}_h$, which is the property of the problem $\mathcal{D}_\mathcal{L}$. Similarly, $\rho_h^2 \subseteq \chi_t(\overline{p}_{h-1}, \overline{a}_{h-1}, \overline{o}_h)$, and which element $\overline{a}_{j,h_0}$ is in $\rho_h^2$ is based on whether $\sigma(\widetilde{a}_{j,h_0}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{c}_{h-1}), \widetilde{a}_{j,h_0}$ influences $\widetilde{s}_{h_0+1}$. Now we will show that $\overline{\chi}_h, \{\overline{\xi}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n]}$ satisfy

$$\overline{c}_h = \overline{c}_{h-1} \cup \overline{z}_h, \ \ \overline{z}_h = \overline{\chi}_h(\overline{p}_{h-1}, \overline{a}_{h-1}, \overline{o}_h), \qquad \text{for each } i \in [n], \ \ \overline{p}_{i,h} = \overline{\xi}_{i,h}(\overline{p}_{i,h-1}, \overline{a}_{i,h-1}, \overline{o}_{i,h}).$$

For functions $\{\overline{\xi}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n]}$, based on the construction of $\mathcal{D}'_\mathcal{L}$ from $\mathcal{D}_\mathcal{L}$, we know that $\overline{p}_{i,h-1} = \widetilde{p}_{i,h-1}, \overline{a}_{i,h-1} = \widetilde{a}_{i,h-1}, \overline{o}_{i,h-1} = \widetilde{o}_{i,h-1}$, and $\overline{p}_{i,h} = p_{i,t^-} = p_{i,h}$.

For function $\overline{\chi}_h$, it is easy to verify that $\overline{z}_h \backslash \widetilde{z}_h = (\overline{c}_h \backslash \widetilde{c}_h) \backslash (\overline{c}_{h-1} \backslash \widetilde{c}_{h-1})$ and $\widetilde{z}_h \backslash \overline{z}_h = (\overline{c}_{h-1} \backslash \widetilde{c}_{h-1}) \backslash (\overline{c}_h \backslash \widetilde{c}_h)$. Together with the fact that $\overline{z}_h = \widetilde{z}_h \cup (\overline{z}_h \backslash \widetilde{z}_h) \backslash (\widetilde{z}_h \backslash \overline{z}_h)$, it suffices to show that $\rho_h^1 = \overline{z}_h \backslash \widetilde{z}_h, \rho_h^2 = \widetilde{z}_h \backslash \overline{z}_h$. From the expansion, we know that for any $h' \in [\overline{H}], \overline{c}_{h'} \backslash \widetilde{c}_{h'}$ only consists of some actions at the even timesteps, since the actions at odd timesteps cannot influence the underlying state. Therefore, $\overline{z}_h \backslash \widetilde{z}_h$ and $\widetilde{z}_h \backslash \overline{z}_h$ only consist of some actions at the even timesteps.

For any $\widetilde{a}_{i,2t_1}, i \in [n], t_1 < t$, if $\widetilde{a}_{i,2t_1}$ influences $\widetilde{s}_{2t_1+1}$, then from Assumption III.7, there exists $i_2 \neq i$ such that $\widetilde{a}_{i,2t_1}$ influences $\widetilde{o}_{i_2,2t_1+1}$ and thus influences $\widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,2t_1+1}$ due to Assumption II.1 (e). From the QC IS of $\mathcal{D}_\mathcal{L}$, we know that $\sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i,2t_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,2t_1+1})$, and thus $\sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i,2t_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{c}_{2t_1+1})$ due to Assumption II.2 and $i_2 \neq i$. Therefore, from Equation (IV.1), we know that $\widetilde{a}_{i,2t_1} \in \check{c}_{2t_1+1}$. This means, if any action $\widetilde{a}_{i,2t_1}$ influences underlying state $\widetilde{s}_{2t_1+1}$, we have $\widetilde{a}_{i,2t_1} \in \check{c}_{2t_1+1} = \overline{c}_{2t_1+1}$, since it will be added in $\check{c}_{2t_1+1}$ via expansion.

Therefore, if any action $\overline{a}_{i,h_1} = \widetilde{a}_{i,h_1}$ with $i \in [n], h_1 < h$ is in $(\overline{c}_h \backslash \widetilde{c}_h) \backslash (\overline{c}_{h-1} \backslash \widetilde{c}_{h-1})$, then it can only happen if $h_1 = h-1$. Also, for any $i \in [n]$, if $\overline{a}_{i,h-1} \in \rho_h^1$, then $\sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i,h-1}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{c}_h), \widetilde{a}_{i,h-1}$ influences $\widetilde{s}_h$, and furthermore, $\overline{a}_{i,h-1} \notin \chi_t(\overline{p}_{h-1}, \overline{a}_{h-1}, \overline{o}_h)$. Then, it means $\overline{a}_{i,h-1} \notin \widetilde{c}_h$. Therefore, $\overline{a}_{i,h-1} \in (\overline{c}_h \backslash \widetilde{c}_h) \backslash (\overline{c}_{h-1} \backslash \widetilde{c}_{h-1})$ and we proved that $\rho_h^1 \subseteq \overline{z}_h \backslash \widetilde{z}_h$. Also, for any $i \in [n]$, $\overline{a}_{i,h-1} \in \overline{z}_h \backslash \widetilde{z}_h$ only if $\overline{a}_{i,h-1}$ is added via expansion and $\overline{a}_{i,h-1} \notin \chi_t(\overline{p}_{h-1}, \overline{a}_{h-1}, \overline{o}_h)$. Then, this can only happen if $\sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i,h-1}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{c}_h)$ and $\widetilde{a}_{i,h-1}$ influences $\widetilde{s}_h$. Therefore, we proved that $\overline{z}_h \backslash \widetilde{z}_h \subseteq \rho_h^1$. Combining the two parts we obtain $\rho_h^1 = \overline{z}_h \backslash \widetilde{z}_h$.

If any action $\overline{a}_{i,h_1}$ with $i \in [n], h_1 < h$ is in $\widetilde{z}_h \backslash \overline{z}_h = (\overline{c}_{h-1} \backslash \widetilde{c}_{h-1}) \backslash (\overline{c}_h \backslash \widetilde{c}_h)$, then we will know that $\overline{a}_{i,h_1} \in \overline{c}_{h-1}$, then $h_1 + 1 \leq h-1$ and $\sigma(\overline{a}_{i,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\overline{c}_{h-1})$. Also, from the proof above, we know that $\overline{a}_{i,h_1}$ influences the state $\overline{s}_{h_1+1}$, then together with $\overline{a}_{i,h_1} \in \widetilde{z}_h$, we have $\overline{a}_{i,h_1} \in \{\widetilde{a}_{j,h_0} \mid j \in [n], h_0 < h-1, \sigma(\widetilde{a}_{j,h_0}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{c}_{h-1}), \widetilde{a}_{j,h_1} \text{ influences } \widetilde{s}_{h_1+1}\} \cap \widetilde{z}_h$. Therefore, $\widetilde{z}_h \backslash \overline{z}_h \subseteq \rho_h^2$. Meanwhile, for any $i \in [n], h_1 < h$, if $\overline{a}_{i,h_1} \in \rho_h^2$, then it holds $\overline{a}_{i,h_1} \in \widetilde{z}_h$, $h_1 < h-1$, and $\overline{a}_{i,h_1}$ influences $\overline{s}_{h_1+1}$. Then,

from above, we know that $\overline{a}_{i,h_1} = \breve{a}_{i,h_1}$ will be added in $\breve{c}_{h_1+1} = \overline{c}_{h_1+1} \subseteq \overline{c}_{h-1}$ since $h_1 < h-1$. Then, $\overline{a}_{i,h_1} \notin \overline{z}_h = \overline{c}_h \backslash \overline{c}_{h-1}$. Therefore, $\overline{a}_{i,h_1} \in \widetilde{z}_h \backslash \overline{z}_h$, and then $\rho_h^2 \subseteq \widetilde{z}_h \backslash \overline{z}_h$. Combining the two parts we obtain $\rho_h^2 = \widetilde{z}_h \backslash \overline{z}_h$.

- If $h = 2t$ with $t \in [H]$, we define $\overline{\chi}_h, \{\overline{\xi}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n]}$ as

$$\forall i \in [n], \overline{p}_{i,h-1} \in \overline{\mathcal{P}}_{i,h-1}, \overline{a}_{i,h-1} \in \overline{\mathcal{A}}_{i,h-1}, \overline{o}_{i,h} \in \overline{\mathcal{O}}_{i,h}, \overline{\xi}_{i,h}(\overline{p}_{i,h-1}, \overline{a}_{i,h-1}, \overline{o}_{i,h}) = \overline{p}_{i,h-1} \backslash \phi_{i,t}(\overline{p}_{i,h-1}, \overline{a}_{i,h-1})$$
$$\forall \overline{p}_{h-1} \in \overline{\mathcal{P}}_{h-1}, \overline{a}_{h-1} \in \overline{\mathcal{A}}_{h-1}, \overline{o}_h \in \overline{\mathcal{O}}_h, \overline{\chi}_h(\overline{p}_{h-1}, \overline{a}_{h-1}, \overline{o}_h) = \phi_t(\overline{p}_{h-1}, \overline{a}_{h-1}).$$

  Now we will show that $\overline{\chi}_h, \{\overline{\xi}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n]}$ satisfy

$$\overline{c}_h = \overline{c}_{h-1} \cup \overline{z}_h, \;\; \overline{z}_h = \overline{\chi}_h(\overline{p}_{h-1}, \overline{a}_{h-1}, \overline{o}_h), \qquad \text{for each } i \in [n], \;\; \overline{p}_{i,h} = \overline{\xi}_{i,h}(\overline{p}_{i,h-1}, \overline{a}_{i,h-1}, \overline{o}_{i,h}).$$

  For functions $\{\overline{\xi}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n]}$, based on the construction of $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ from $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$, we know that $\overline{p}_{i,h-1} = p_{i,t^-} = p_{i,h-1}, \overline{a}_{i,h-1} = \widetilde{a}_{i,h-1}$ and $\overline{p}_{i,h} = \widetilde{p}_{i,h}$.

  For function $\overline{\chi}_h$, we know that $\overline{p}_{h-1} = p_{t^-} = p_{h-1}, \overline{a}_{h-1} = \widetilde{a}_{h-1}$, so it suffices to show that $\widetilde{z}_h = \overline{z}_h$. As shown above, $\widetilde{z}_h \backslash \overline{z}_h$ and $\overline{z}_h \backslash \widetilde{z}_h$ only consist of some actions at the even timesteps. Moreover, for any action $\widetilde{a}_{i,2t_1}$ with $i \in [n], t_1 < t$ that influences $\widetilde{s}_{2t_1+1}$, it will be added in $\overline{c}_{2t_1+1}$ via expansion (if $\widetilde{a}_{i,2t_1} \notin \widetilde{c}_{2t_1+1}$); if $\widetilde{a}_{i,2t_1}$ does not influence $\widetilde{s}_{2t_1+1}$, then it will never be added via expansion. Therefore, $\overline{z}_h \backslash \widetilde{z}_h = \emptyset$. Also, if some action $\widetilde{a}_{i,2t_1} \in \widetilde{z}_h \backslash \overline{z}_h$, then we know that $\widetilde{a}_{i,2t_1} \in \widetilde{z}_h = \phi_t(\overline{p}_{h-1}, \widetilde{a}_{h-1})$, and further we know that $\widetilde{a}_{i,2t_1} \in \overline{p}_{h-1} = p_{i,t^-}$. However, if $\widetilde{a}_{i,2t_1}$ influences $\widetilde{s}_{2t_1+1}$, then it will be added in $\overline{c}_{2t_1+1}$ and cannot lie in $\overline{p}_{h-1}$; if $\widetilde{a}_{i,2t_1}$ does not influence $\widetilde{s}_{2t_1+1}$, then from Assumption III.5, $\widetilde{a}_{i,2t_1} \notin p_{i,t^-}$. Therefore, we know that $\widetilde{z}_h \backslash \overline{z}_h = \emptyset$, and get $\widetilde{z}_h = \overline{z}_h$.

Thirdly, we prove that such a Dec-POMDP $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ has SI-CIBs with respect to the strategy space $\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}$.

Similarly as the proof of Theorem IV.5, it suffices to prove the case that the two strategies only differ in the strategy of only one agent $(i_1, h_1)$, i.e., for any $h \in [2 : \overline{H}], \overline{s}_h \in \overline{\mathcal{S}}, \overline{p}_h \in \overline{\mathcal{P}}_h, \overline{c}_h \in \overline{\mathcal{C}}_h, i_1 \in [n], h_1 < h, \overline{g}_{1:h-1}, \overline{g}'_{i_1,h_1} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{i_1:h_1}$, let $\overline{g}'_{h_1} := (\overline{g}_{1,h_1}, \cdots, \overline{g}'_{i_1,h_1}, \cdots, \overline{g}_{n,h_1})$ and $\overline{g}'_{1:h-1} := (\overline{g}_1, \cdots, \overline{g}'_{h_1}, \cdots, \overline{g}_{h-1})$. If $\overline{c}_h$ is reachable from both $\overline{g}_{1:h-1}$ and $\overline{g}'_{1:h-1}$, it holds that

$$\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}_{1:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}'_{1:h-1}). \tag{C.2}$$

We prove this case by case. If $h = 2t$ with $t \in [H]$, then from the result of Theorem IV.5, it holds that

$$\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}_{1:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}^\dagger_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}_{1:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}^\dagger_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}'_{1:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}'_{1:h-1}).$$

Therefore, now we consider the case that $h = 2t-1$ with $t \in [H]$.

Suppose $h_1$ is odd, which means that $\overline{a}_{h_1}$ corresponds to the communication action in $\mathcal{L}$. Then, it holds that $\overline{c}_{h_1} \subseteq \overline{c}_h, \overline{a}_{i_1,h_1} = m_{i_1,\frac{h_1+1}{2}} \in \overline{c}_h$, then

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}_{1:h-1}) &= \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_{h_1}, \overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}, \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}_{1:h-1}) \\ &= \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_{h_1}, \overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}, \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}_{1:h-1} \backslash \overline{g}_{i_1,h_1}) = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}'_{1:h-1}),\end{aligned}$$

where the second equality is because the input and output of $\overline{g}_{i_1,h_1}$ are $\overline{c}_{h_1}$ and $\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}$.

Suppose $h_1$ is even, which means that $h_1$ is a control timestep, and let $t_1 = \frac{h_1}{2}$. If $\sigma(\overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\overline{c}_h)$

and $\sigma(\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\overline{c}_h)$, then there exist deterministic measurable functions $\overline{\alpha}_1, \overline{\alpha}_2$ such that $\overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} = \overline{\alpha}_1(\overline{c}_h), \overline{a}_{i_1,h_1} = \overline{\alpha}_2(\overline{c}_h)$, and further it holds that

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}_{1:h-1}) &= \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{\alpha}_1(\overline{c}_h), \overline{\alpha}_2(\overline{c}_h), \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}_{1:h-1}) \\ &= \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}, \overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}, \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}_{1:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}, \overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}, \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}'_{1:h-1}).\end{aligned}$$

If $\sigma(\overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \nsubseteq \sigma(\overline{c}_h)$ or $\sigma(\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \nsubseteq \sigma(\overline{c}_h)$, then since $h_1$ is even, $\overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} = \check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}, \overline{a}_{i_1,h_1} = \check{a}_{i_1,h_1}$. Also, we know that $\overline{c}_h = \check{c}_h$, then it holds that $\sigma(\check{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \nsubseteq \sigma(\check{c}_h)$ or $\sigma(\check{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \nsubseteq \sigma(\check{c}_h)$. Firstly, from the sQC of $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$, we know that agent $(i_1,h_1)$ does not influence agent $(i_2,h)$ in $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$ for any $i_2 \neq i_1$. Then, as shown in the proof of Theorem IV.5, we know that agent $(i_1,h_1)$ does not influence $\check{s}_{h_1+1} = \overline{s}_{h_1+1}$ and does not influence $\check{c}_{h'} = \overline{c}_{h'}$ for any $h' \leq h$. Secondly, from Assumption II.1, we know that for any $i \in [n], p_{i,(t_1+1)^-} = \xi_{i,t_1+1}(p_{i,t_1^+}, a_{i,t_1}, o_{i,t_1+1})$, where $\xi_{i,t_1+1}$ is a fixed transformation. Also, from Assumption III.5, we know that $a_{i,t_1} \notin p_{i,(t_1+1)^-}$. Therefore, we can write $p_{i,(t_1+1)^-} = \xi_{i,t_1+1}(p_{i,t_1^+}, o_{i,t_1+1})$. From the definition of refinement, we know that $\overline{p}_{i,h_1+1} = \xi_{i,t_1+1}(p_{i,t_1^+}, \overline{o}_{i,h_1+1})$. Since agent $(i_1,h_1)$ does not influence $\overline{s}_{h_1+1}$, it does not influence $\overline{o}_{i,h_1+1}$. Also, agent $(i_1,h_1)$ does not influence $\overline{c}_{h_1+1}$ and $p_{i,h_1^+}$ (which happens before choosing $a_{i_1,t_1} = \overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}$). Therefore, agent $(i_1,h_1)$ does not influence $\overline{\tau}_{i,h_1+1}$, and thus does not influence $\overline{a}_{i,h_1+1}$ for any $i \in [n]$. Thirdly, we know that for any $i \in [n], \overline{p}_{i,h_1+2} = \overline{\xi}_{i,h_1+2}(\overline{p}_{i,h_1+1}, \overline{a}_{i,h_1+1}, \overline{o}_{i,h_1+2})$, where $\overline{o}_{i,h_1+2} = \emptyset$. Since agent $(i_1,h_1)$ does not influence $\overline{p}_{i,h_1+1}$ and $\overline{a}_{i,h_1+1}$, it does not influence $\overline{p}_{i,h_1+2}$. Also, we know that it does not influence $\overline{\tau}_{i,h_1+2}$. Therefore, agent $(i_1,h_1)$ does not influence $\overline{\tau}_{i,h_1+2}$, and thus does not influence $\overline{a}_{i,h_1+2}$. This way, we know that agent $(i_1,h_1)$ does not influence $\overline{\tau}_{i,h'}$ for any $i \in [n], h_1 < h' \leq h$.
Finally, since we proved that agent $(i_1,h_1)$ does not influence $\overline{s}_h$, $\overline{\tau}_{i,h}, \forall i \in [n]$, and $\overline{c}_h = \cap_{i=1}^n \overline{\tau}_{i,h}$. Therefore, we have

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}_{1:h-1}) &= \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h, \overline{c}_h | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}_{1:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{\tau}_h | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}_{1:h-1}) \\ &= \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \{\overline{\tau}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n]} | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}_{1:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \{\overline{\tau}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n]} | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}'_{1:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}'_{1:h-1}).\end{aligned}$$

□

## C-G Important Auxiliary Definitions

**Definition C.3** (Full-history strategy)**.** Given any Dec-POMDP $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ constructed from an LTC problem $\mathcal{L}$ after reformulation, strict expansion, and refinement, we define the strategy $g_h : \prod_{t=1}^{h} \overline{\mathcal{O}}_t \times \prod_{t=1}^{h-1} \overline{\mathcal{A}}_t \to \overline{\mathcal{A}}_h$ that uses the full joint observation-action history as a *full-history strategy*, and define $\mathcal{G}_h$ as the space of all such possible $g_h$, i.e., $\mathcal{G}_h = \{g_h : \prod_{t=1}^{h} \overline{\mathcal{O}}_t \times \prod_{t=1}^{h-1} \overline{\mathcal{A}}_t \to \overline{\mathcal{A}}_h\}$.

**Definition C.4** (Perfect recall [26])**.** We say that agent $i$ has perfect recall if $\forall h = 2, \cdots, \overline{H}$, it holds that $\overline{\tau}_{i,h-1} \cup \{\overline{a}_{i,h-1}\} \subseteq \overline{\tau}_{i,h}$. If for any $i \in [n]$, agent $i$ has perfect recall, we call that the Dec-POMDP has a perfect recall property.

The following definitions are important for solving the Dec-POMDP constructed from LTC.

**Definition C.5** (Value function)**.** For each $h \in [\overline{H}]$, given common information $\overline{c}_h$ and strategy $\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}$, the value function conditioned on the common information is defined as:

$$V_h^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}, \mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{c}_h) := \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}}\left[\sum_{h'=h}^{\overline{H}} \overline{\mathcal{R}}_{h'}(\overline{s}_{h'}, \overline{a}_{h'}, \overline{p}_{h'}) \middle| \overline{c}_h\right], \tag{C.3}$$

where $\overline{\mathcal{R}}_{h'}$ takes $\bar{s}_{h'}, \bar{a}_{h'}, \bar{p}_{h'}$ as input.

**Definition C.6** (Prescription and Q-value function)**.** *Prescription* is an important concept in the common-information-based framework [15, 16]. For any $h \in [\overline{H}], i \in [n]$, the *prescription* of agent $i$ at timestep $h$ is defined as $\gamma_{i,h} \in \Gamma_{i,h}$, where $\Gamma_{i,h} := \overline{\mathcal{A}}_{i,h} = \mathcal{M}_{i,\frac{h+1}{2}}$ if $h = 2k-1, k \in [H]$, and $\Gamma_{i,h} := \{\gamma_{i,h} : \overline{\mathcal{P}}_{i,h} \to \overline{\mathcal{A}}_{i,h}\}$ if $h = 2k, k \in [H]$. We use $\gamma_h := (\gamma_{1,h}, \cdots, \gamma_{n,h})$ to denote the joint prescription and $\Gamma_h$ to denote the joint prescription space. The prescriptions are the marginalization of the strategies $\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}$, i.e., $\forall k \in [H], \gamma_{i,2k-1} = \overline{g}_{i,2k-1}(\bar{c}_{2k-1}), \gamma_{i,2k}(\cdot) = \overline{g}_{i,2k}(\bar{c}_{2k}, \cdot)$. Then, for any $\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}$, we can define the Q-value function as

$$Q_h^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}, \mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\bar{c}_h, \gamma_h) := \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}}\left[\sum_{h'=h}^{\overline{H}} \overline{\mathcal{R}}_{h'}(\bar{s}_{h'}, \bar{a}_{h'}, \bar{p}_{h'}) \,\middle|\, \bar{c}_h, \gamma_h\right]. \tag{C.4}$$

Note that for any $i \in [n]$, and any odd timestep $2k-1$ with $k \in [H]$, by Assumption III.4, we consider the strategies that only take common information as input. Thus, the prescription $\gamma_{i,2k-1} = \bar{a}_{i,2k-1}$. To unify the notation, we may also write it as $\gamma_{i,2k-1}(\cdot) = \overline{g}_{i,2k-1}(\bar{c}_{2k-1}, \cdot)$, where $\cdot$ takes the value $\emptyset$ rather than $\bar{p}_{i,2k-1}$.

**Definition C.7** (Expected approximate common-information model)**.** We define an *expected approximate common-information model* of $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ as

$$\mathcal{M} := \left(\{\widehat{\mathcal{C}}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}+1]}, \{\widehat{\phi}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}, \{\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},z}\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}, \Gamma, \{\widehat{\mathcal{R}}_h^{\mathcal{M}}\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}\right)$$

where $\Gamma = \{\Gamma_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$ is the joint prescription space, $\widehat{\mathcal{C}}_h$ is the space of approximate common information at timestep $h$. $\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},z} : \widehat{\mathcal{C}}_h \times \Gamma_h \to \Delta(\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{h+1})$ gives the probability of $\bar{z}_{h+1}$ under $\widehat{c}_h$ and $\gamma_h$. $\widehat{\mathcal{R}}_h^{\mathcal{M}} : \widehat{\mathcal{C}}_h \times \Gamma_h \to [-1, 1]$ gives the reward at timestep $h$ given $\widehat{c}_h$ and $\gamma_h$. Then, we call that $\mathcal{M}$ is an $(\epsilon_r(\mathcal{M}), \epsilon_z(\mathcal{M}))$-*expected approximate common-information model* of $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$, if it has some compression function $\text{Compress}_h$ such that $\widehat{c}_h = \text{Compress}_h(\bar{c}_h)$ for each $h \in [\overline{H}+1]$, and satisfies the following:

- There exists a transformation function $\widehat{\phi}_h$ for all $h \in [\overline{H}]$ such that

$$\widehat{c}_{h+1} = \widehat{\phi}_{h+1}(\widehat{c}_h, \bar{z}_{h+1}), \qquad \text{where } \bar{z}_{h+1} = \bar{c}_{h+1} \backslash \bar{c}_h. \tag{C.5}$$

- For any $\overline{g}_{1:h-1}$ and any prescription $\gamma_h \in \Gamma_h$, it holds that

$$\mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\bar{a}_{1:h-1}, \bar{o}_{1:h} \sim \overline{g}_{1:h-1}} |\mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}[\overline{\mathcal{R}}_h(\bar{s}_h, \bar{a}_h, \bar{p}_h) \,|\, \bar{c}_h, \gamma_h] - \widehat{\mathcal{R}}_h^{\mathcal{M}}(\widehat{c}_h, \gamma_h)| \le \epsilon_r(\mathcal{M}). \tag{C.6}$$

- For any $\overline{g}_{1:h-1}$ and any prescription $\gamma_h \in \Gamma_h$, it holds that

$$\mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\bar{a}_{1:h-1}, \bar{o}_{1:h} \sim \overline{g}_{1:h-1}} \|\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\cdot \,|\, \bar{c}_h, \gamma_h) - \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},z}(\cdot \,|\, \widehat{c}_h, \gamma_h)\|_1 \le \epsilon_z(\mathcal{M}). \tag{C.7}$$

**Definition C.8** (Value functions under $\mathcal{M}$)**.** Given any expected approximate common-information model $\mathcal{M}$ of a Dec-POMDP $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$, any strategy $\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}$, and $h \in [\overline{H}]$, we define the value function

and Q-value functions under $\mathcal{M}$ as

$$
\begin{aligned}
&V_h^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_h) = \widehat{\mathcal{R}}_h^{\mathcal{M}}(\mathrm{Compress}_h(\overline{c}_h), \{\overline{g}_{j,h}(\overline{c}_h,\cdot)\}_{j\in[n]}) + \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{M}}[V_{h+1}^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_{h+1})|\mathrm{Compress}_h(\overline{c}_h), \{\overline{g}_{j,h}(\overline{c}_h,\cdot)\}_{j\in[n]}],\\
&Q_h^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_h,\gamma_h) = \widehat{\mathcal{R}}_h^{\mathcal{M}}(\mathrm{Compress}_h(\overline{c}_h),\gamma_h) + \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{M}}[V_{h+1}^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_{h+1})|\mathrm{Compress}_h(\overline{c}_h),\gamma_h],\\
&Q_h^{*,\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_h,\gamma_h) = \max_{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} Q_h^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_h,\gamma_h).
\end{aligned}
$$

**Definition C.9** (Model-belief consistency)**.** We say the expected approximate common-information model $\mathcal{M}$ of $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ is *consistent with* some approximate common-information-based beliefs $\{\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},c}(\overline{s}_h,\overline{p}_h|\widehat{c}_h)\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$, if it satisfies the following: for all $h\in[H]$,

$$
\begin{aligned}
\mathbb{P}_{2h-1}^{\mathcal{M},z}(\overline{z}_{2h}|\widehat{c}_{2h-1},\gamma_{2h-1}) &= \sum_{\overline{s}_{2h-1}} \sum_{\substack{\overline{p}_{2h-1}:\\ \overline{\chi}_{2h}(\overline{p}_{2h-1},\gamma_{2h-1},\overline{o}_{2h}=\emptyset)=\overline{z}_{2h}}} \mathbb{P}_{2h-1}^{\mathcal{M},c}(\overline{s}_{2h-1},\overline{p}_{2h-1}|\widehat{c}_{2h-1}),\\
\mathbb{P}_{2h}^{\mathcal{M},z}(\overline{z}_{2h+1}|\widehat{c}_{2h},\gamma_{2h}) &= \sum_{\overline{s}_{2h}} \sum_{\substack{\overline{p}_{2h},\overline{a}_{2h},\overline{o}_{2h+1}:\\ \overline{\chi}_{2h+1}(\overline{p}_{2h},\overline{a}_{2h},\overline{o}_{2h+1})=\overline{z}_{2h+1}}} \Big(\mathbb{P}_{2h}^{\mathcal{M},c}(\overline{s}_{2h},\overline{p}_{2h}|\widehat{c}_{2h})\mathbb{1}[\overline{a}_{2h}=\gamma_{2h}(\overline{p}_{2h})]\\
&\qquad \sum_{\overline{s}_{2h+1}} \overline{\mathbb{T}}_{2h}(\overline{s}_{2h+1}|\overline{s}_{2h},\overline{a}_{2h})]\overline{\mathbb{O}}_{2h+1}(\overline{o}_{2h+1}|\overline{s}_{2h+1})\Big),
\end{aligned}
\tag{C.8}
$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
\widehat{\mathcal{R}}_{2h-1}^{\mathcal{M}}(\widehat{c}_{2h-1},\gamma_{2h-1}) &= \sum_{\overline{s}_{2h-1}}\sum_{\overline{p}_{2h-1}} \mathbb{P}_{2h-1}^{\mathcal{M},c}(\overline{s}_{2h-1},\overline{p}_{2h-1}|\widehat{c}_{2h-1})\overline{\mathcal{R}}_{2h-1}(\overline{s}_{2h-1},\gamma_{2h-1},\overline{p}_{2h-1}),\\
\widehat{\mathcal{R}}_{2h}^{\mathcal{M}}(\widehat{c}_{2h},\gamma_{2h}) &= \sum_{\overline{s}_{2h},\overline{p}_{2h},\overline{a}_{2h}} \mathbb{P}_{2h}^{\mathcal{M},c}(\overline{s}_{2h},\overline{p}_{2h}|\widehat{c}_{2h})\mathbb{1}[\overline{a}_{2h}=\gamma_{2h}(\overline{p}_{2h})]\overline{\mathcal{R}}_{2h}(\overline{s}_{2h},\overline{a}_{2h},\overline{p}_{2h}).
\end{aligned}
\tag{C.9}
$$

**Definition C.10** (Strategy-dependent approximate common-information model)**.** Given an expected approximate common-information model $\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}$ of $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ (as in Definition C.7) and $\overline{H}$ joint strategies $g^{1:\overline{H}}$, where each $g^h\in\mathcal{G}_{1:\overline{H}}$ for $h\in[\overline{H}]$ (as in Definition C.3), we say $\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}$ is a *strategy-dependent expected approximate common-information model*, denoted as $\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H}})$, if it is consistent with the *strategy-dependent* beliefs $\{\mathbb{P}_h^{g^h,\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h,\overline{p}_h|\widehat{c}_h)\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$ (as per Definition C.9).

**Definition C.11** (Length of approximate common information)**.** Given the compression functions $\{\mathrm{Compress}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$, we define an integer $\widehat{L}>0$ as the minimum length such that there exists a mapping $\widehat{f}_h:\overline{\mathcal{O}}_{\max\{1,h-\widehat{L}\}:h}\times\overline{\mathcal{A}}_{\max\{1,h-\widehat{L}\}:h-1}\to\widehat{\mathcal{C}}_h$ that satisfies: for each $h\in[\overline{H}+1]$ and joint history $\{\overline{o}_{1:h},\overline{a}_{1:h-1}\}$, we have $\widehat{f}_h(x_h)=\widehat{c}_h$, where $x_h=\{\overline{o}_{\max\{h-\widehat{L},1\}},\overline{a}_{\max\{h-\widehat{L},1\}},\overline{o}_{\max\{h-\widehat{L},1\}+1},\cdots,\overline{a}_{h-1},\overline{o}_h\}$.

## C-H Main Results for Planning in QC LTCs

**Theorem C.12** (Full version of Theorem IV.8)**.** Given any QC LTC problem $\mathcal{L}$ satisfying Assumptions III.1, III.4, III.5, and III.7, we can construct a Dec-POMDP problem $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ with SI-CIBs such that for any $\epsilon>0$, solving an $\epsilon$-team-optimal strategy in $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ can give us an $\epsilon$-team-optimal strategy of $\mathcal{L}$, and the following holds. Fix $\epsilon_r,\epsilon_z>0$ and given any $(\epsilon_r,\epsilon_z)$-expected approximate common-information model $\mathcal{M}$ for $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ that satisfies Assumption IV.7, there exists an algorithm that can compute a $(2\overline{H}\epsilon_r+\overline{H}^2\epsilon_z)$-team-optimal strategy for the original LTC problem $\mathcal{L}$ with time complexity $\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}|\widehat{\mathcal{C}}_h|\cdot \mathrm{poly}(|\overline{\mathcal{S}}|,|\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h|,|\overline{\mathcal{P}}_h|,\overline{H})$. In particular, for any fixed $\epsilon>0$, if $\mathcal{L}$ has a baseline sharing protocol as one

of the examples in §A, one can construct such an $\mathcal{M}$ and apply Algorithm 1 to compute an $\epsilon$-team-optimal strategy for $\mathcal{L}$ with the following complexities:

- **Examples 1, 3, 5, 6:** $\mathrm{poly}(\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}(|\overline{\mathcal{O}}_h||\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h|)^{C\gamma^{-4}\log(\frac{|\overline{\mathcal{S}}|}{\epsilon})}, |\overline{\mathcal{S}}|, \overline{H}, \frac{1}{\epsilon})$;
- **Examples 2, 4, 7, 8:** $\mathrm{poly}(\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}(|\overline{\mathcal{O}}_h||\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h|)^{C\gamma^{-4}\log(\frac{|\overline{\mathcal{S}}|}{\epsilon})+2d}, |\overline{\mathcal{S}}|, \overline{H}, \frac{1}{\epsilon})$,

for some universal constant $C > 0$. Recall that $\gamma$ is the constant in Assumption III.1. And $d$ is the delayed step of sharing, which is a constant as stated in §A. Note that if $d = \mathrm{poly}\log H$, the complexity is still quasi-polynomial.

*Proof.* We divide the proof into the following three **Parts**.

**Part I:** Given any QC LTC problem $\mathcal{L}$ satisfying Assumptions III.1, III.4, III.5, and III.7, we can construct a Dec-POMDP problem $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ with SI-CIBs such that finding an $\epsilon$-team-optimal strategy can give us an $\epsilon$-team-optimal strategy of $\mathcal{L}$, as shown in Algorithm 1.

**Part II:** Given any $(\epsilon_r, \epsilon_z)$-expected approximate common-information model $\mathcal{M}$ of the Dec-POMDP $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$, we aim to show that there exists an algorithm, Algorithm 6, that can output an $\epsilon$-team-optimal strategy of $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ with $\epsilon = 2\overline{H}\epsilon_r + \overline{H}^2\epsilon_z$. Then, together with the result in **Part I**, we can further conclude that the output of Algorithm 1 is an $\epsilon$-team-optimal strategy of $\mathcal{L}$.

First, we need to prove that solving $\mathcal{M}$ can get the $\epsilon$-team-optimal strategy of $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$. We prove the following 2 lemmas first.

**Lemma C.13.** For any strategy $\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}$, and $h \in [\overline{H}]$, we have

$$\mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}}[|V_h^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{c}_h) - V_h^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_h)|] \le (\overline{H}-h+1)\epsilon_r + \frac{(\overline{H}-h+1)(\overline{H}-h)}{2}\epsilon_z. \tag{C.10}$$

*Proof.* We prove it by induction. For $h = \overline{H}+1$, we have $V_h^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{c}_h) = V_h^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_h) = 0$.
For the step $h \le \overline{H}$, we have

$$\begin{aligned}
&\mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}}[|V_h^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{c}_h) - V_h^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_h)|] \\
\le&\mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}}\left[|\mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}}[\overline{\mathcal{R}}_h(\overline{s}_h,\overline{a}_h,\overline{p}_h)|\overline{c}_h,\{\overline{g}_{j,h}(\overline{c}_h,\cdot)\}_{j\in[n]}] - \widehat{\mathcal{R}}_h^{\mathcal{M}}(\widehat{c}_h,\{\overline{g}_{j,h}(\overline{c}_h,\cdot)\}_{j\in[n]})|\right] \\
&+\mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}}\left[|\mathbb{E}_{\overline{z}_{h+1}\sim\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{c}_h,\{\overline{g}_{j,h}(\overline{c}_h,\cdot)\}_{j\in[n]})}[V_h^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{c}_h\cup\overline{z}_{h+1})] - \mathbb{E}_{\overline{z}_{h+1}\sim\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},z}(\cdot|\widehat{c}_h,\{\overline{g}_{j,h}(\overline{c}_h,\cdot)\}_{j\in[n]})}[V_h^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_h\cup\overline{z}_{h+1})]|\right] \\
\le&\epsilon_r + (\overline{H}-h)\mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{a}_{1:h-1},\overline{o}_{1:h}\sim\overline{g}_{1:h-1}}\|\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\cdot|\overline{c}_h,\gamma_h) - \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},z}(\cdot|\widehat{c}_h,\gamma_h)\|_1 + \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{a}_{1:h-1},\overline{o}_{1:h}\sim\overline{g}_{1:h-1}}\left[|V_{h+1}^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{c}_{h+1}) - V_{h+1}^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_{h+1})|\right] \\
\le&\epsilon_r + (\overline{H}-h)\epsilon_z + (\overline{H}-h)\epsilon_r + \frac{(\overline{H}-h)(\overline{H}-h-1)}{2}\epsilon_z \\
\le&(\overline{H}-h+1)\epsilon_r + \frac{(\overline{H}-h)(\overline{H}-h+1)}{2}\epsilon_z.
\end{aligned}$$

In the third line of this proof, we had $\overline{z}_{h+1} \sim \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\cdot|\overline{c}_h, \{\overline{g}_{j,h}(\overline{c}_h,\cdot)\}_{j\in[n]})$, where $\overline{z}_{h+1}$ is generated as

$$\begin{aligned}
&\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{z}_{h+1}|\overline{c}_h,\gamma_h)\\
=&\sum_{\overline{s}_h\in\overline{\mathcal{S}},\overline{p}_h\in\overline{\mathcal{P}}_h}\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h,\overline{p}_h|\overline{c}_h)\sum_{\overline{s}_{h+1}\in\overline{\mathcal{S}},\overline{o}_{h+1}\in\overline{\mathcal{O}}_{h+1}}\overline{\mathbb{T}}_h(\overline{s}_{h+1}|\overline{s}_h,\overline{a}_h)\overline{\mathbb{O}}_{h+1}(\overline{o}_{h+1}|\overline{s}_{h+1})\mathbb{1}[\overline{\chi}_{h+1}(\overline{p}_h,\overline{a}_h,\overline{o}_{h+1})],
\end{aligned}$$

with $\gamma_h = \{\overline{g}_{j,h}(\overline{c}_h,\cdot)\}_{j\in[n]}, \overline{a}_h = \gamma_h(\overline{p}_h)$ if $h = 2k$, and $\overline{a}_h = \gamma_h$ otherwise, for $k \in [H]$. □

**Lemma C.14.** Let $\widehat{g}^*_{1:\overline{H}} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}$ be the strategy output by Algorithm 6, then for any $h \in [\overline{H}], \overline{c}_h \in \overline{\mathcal{C}}_h, \overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}$, it holds that

$$V_h^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_h) \le V_h^{\widehat{g}^*_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_h). \tag{C.11}$$

*Proof.* We prove it by induction. For $h = \overline{H}+1$, we have $V_h^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_h) = V_h^{\widehat{g}^*_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_h) = 0$. For the timestep $h \le \overline{H}$, we have

$$\begin{aligned}
V_h^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_h) &= \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{M}}[\widehat{r}_h^{\mathcal{M}}(\widehat{c}_h,\{\overline{g}_{j,h}(\overline{c}_h,\cdot)\}_{j\in[n]}) + V_{h+1}^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_{h+1})|\widehat{c}_h,\overline{g}_h]\\
&\le \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{M}}[\widehat{r}_h^{\mathcal{M}}(\widehat{c}_h,\{\overline{g}_{j,h}(\overline{c}_h,\cdot)\}_{j\in[n]}) + V_{h+1}^{\widehat{g}^*_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_{h+1})|\widehat{c}_h,\overline{g}_h]\\
&= Q_h^{\widehat{g}^*_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_h,\{\overline{g}_{j,h}(\overline{c}_h,\cdot)\}_{j\in[n]})\\
&\le Q_h^{\widehat{g}^*_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_h,\{\widehat{g}_{j,h}(\overline{c}_h,\cdot)\}_{j\in[n]})\\
&= V_h^{\widehat{g}^*_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_h).
\end{aligned}$$

For the first inequality, we use the induction hypothesis. For the second inequality, we use the property of argmax in algorithm and $V_h^{\widehat{g}^*_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_h) = V_h^{\widehat{g}^*_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\widehat{c}_h)$. By induction, we complete the proof. □

We now go back to the proof of the theorem. Let $\widehat{g}^*_{1:\overline{H}}$ be the solution output by Algorithm 6, then for any $\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}, h \in [\overline{H}], \overline{c}_h \in \overline{\mathcal{C}}_h$, we have

$$\begin{aligned}
&\mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}}\left[V_h^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{c}_h) - V_h^{\widehat{g}^*_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{c}_h)\right]\\
&= \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}}\left[\left(V_h^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{c}_h) - V_h^{\widehat{g}^*_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_h)\right) + \left(V_h^{\widehat{g}^*_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_h) - V_h^{\widehat{g}^*_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{c}_h)\right)\right]\\
&\le \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}}\left[\left(V_h^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{c}_h) - V_h^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_h)\right) + \left(V_h^{\widehat{g}^*_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{M}}(\overline{c}_h) - V_h^{\widehat{g}^*_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{c}_h)\right)\right]\\
&\le (\overline{H}-h+1)\epsilon_r + \frac{(\overline{H}-h)(\overline{H}-h+1)}{2}\epsilon_z + (\overline{H}-h+1)\epsilon_r + \frac{(\overline{H}-h)(\overline{H}-h+1)}{2}\epsilon_z\\
&= 2(\overline{H}-h+1)\epsilon_r + (\overline{H}-h)(\overline{H}-h+1)\epsilon_z.
\end{aligned} \tag{C.12}$$

For the first inequality, we use Lemma C.14. For the second inequality, we use Lemma C.13. Then, we can apply $h = 1$ to Equation (C.12) and have $J_{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}) \le J_{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\widehat{g}^*_{1:\overline{H}}) + 2\overline{H}\epsilon_r + \overline{H}^2\epsilon_z$. Note that if $\mathcal{M}$ (the model constructed in the Line 4 in Algorithm 1) satisfies Assumption IV.7, then Algorithm 1 has time complexity $\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}|\widehat{\mathcal{C}}_h| \cdot \mathrm{poly}(|\overline{\mathcal{S}}|, \max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}|\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h|, \max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}|\overline{\mathcal{P}}_h|, \overline{H})$. This is because there are at most $\overline{H}\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}|\widehat{\mathcal{C}}_h|$ iterations in Algorithm 6 (called in Line 5 in Algorithm 1), and for each iteration, it has $\mathrm{poly}(|\overline{\mathcal{S}}|, \max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}|\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h|, \max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}||\overline{\mathcal{P}}_h|)$ time complexity due to Assumption IV.7. This

completes the proof of **Part II**.

**Part III:** If the baseline sharing of $\mathcal{L}$ is one of the 8 examples in §A, we can construct an expected approximate common-information model $\mathcal{M}$ of $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ with $\epsilon_r = \epsilon_z = \epsilon$, and $\mathcal{M}$ satisfies Assumption IV.7 and is consistent with some belief.

We first prove the following lemmas, which are useful for bounding the errors $\epsilon_r, \epsilon_z$.

**Lemma C.15.** Given any belief $\{\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},c}(\bar{s}_h, \bar{p}_h | \widehat{c}_h)\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$ such that an expected approximate common-information model $\mathcal{M}$ is consistent with such belief, it holds that for any $h \in [\overline{H}], \overline{\mathcal{C}}_h, \gamma_h \in \Gamma_h$:

$$\|\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\cdot|\bar{c}_h, \gamma_h) - \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},z}(\cdot|\widehat{c}_h, \gamma_h)\|_1 \le \|\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\cdot,\cdot|\bar{c}_h) - \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},c}(\cdot,\cdot|\widehat{c}_h)\|_1,$$
$$|\mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}[\mathcal{R}_h(\bar{s}_h, \bar{a}_h, \bar{p}_h)|\bar{c}_h, \gamma_h] - \widehat{\mathcal{R}}_h^{\mathcal{M}}(\widehat{c}_h, \gamma_h)| \le \|\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\cdot,\cdot|\bar{c}_h) - \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},c}(\cdot,\cdot|\widehat{c}_h)\|_1,$$

where $\widehat{c}_h$ =Compress$_h(\bar{c}_h)$.

*Proof.* Adapted from Lemma 4 in [14] by changing the reward function of $r_{i,h}(s_h, a_h)$ to $\mathcal{R}_h(\bar{s}_h, \bar{a}_h, \bar{p}_h)$. Note that the latter can still be evaluated given the common-information-based belief, $\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\bar{s}_h, \bar{p}_h|\bar{c}_h)$. □

Then, we define the belief states following the notation in [29, 14] as $\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_1(\emptyset) = \mu_1$, $\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_h(\bar{o}_{1:h}, \bar{a}_{1:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\bar{s}_h = \cdot|\bar{o}_{1:h}, \bar{a}_{1:h-1}), \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_h(\bar{o}_{1:h-1}, \bar{a}_{1:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\bar{s}_h = \cdot|\bar{o}_{1:h-1}, \bar{a}_{1:h-1})$, where $\overline{\boldsymbol{b}} \in \Delta(\mathcal{S})$. Also, for any $L \ge 1$, we define the approximate beliefs of states using the most recent $L$-step history as:

$$\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'_h(\bar{o}_{h-L+1:h}, \bar{a}_{h-L:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\bar{s}_h = \cdot|\bar{s}_{h-L} \sim \mathrm{Unif}(\overline{\mathcal{S}}), \bar{o}_{h-L+1:h}, \bar{a}_{h-L:h-1})$$
$$\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'_h(\bar{o}_{h-L+1:h-1}, \bar{a}_{h-L:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\bar{s}_h = \cdot|\bar{s}_{h-L} \sim \mathrm{Unif}(\overline{\mathcal{S}}), \bar{o}_{h-L+1:h-1}, \bar{a}_{h-L:h-1}).$$

Moreover, for any set $N \subseteq [n]$, we define $\bar{o}_{N,h} = \{\bar{o}_{i,h}\}_{i\in N}$. We can also define the beliefs of states given historical observations and actions as: for any $N \subseteq [n]$,

$$\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_h(\bar{o}_{1:h-1}, \bar{a}_{1:h-1}, \bar{o}_{N,h}) = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\bar{s}_h = \cdot|\bar{o}_{1:h-1}, \bar{a}_{1:h-1}, \bar{o}_{N,h})$$
$$\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'_h(\bar{o}_{h-L+1:h-1}, \bar{a}_{h-L:h-1}, \bar{o}_{N,h}) = \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\bar{s}_h = \cdot|\bar{s}_{h-L} \sim \mathrm{Unif}(\overline{\mathcal{S}}), \bar{o}_{h-L+1:h-1}, \bar{a}_{h-L:h-1}, \bar{o}_{N,h}).$$

Let $S = |\mathcal{S}|$ be the cardinality of the state space $\mathcal{S}$, we have the following lemma.

**Lemma C.16.** There is a constant $C \ge 1$ such that the following holds. Given any LTC problem $\mathcal{L}$ satisfying Assumption III.1, and let $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ be the Dec-POMDP after reformulation, strict expansion, and refinement. Let $\epsilon \ge 0$, fix a strategy $\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}$ and indices $1 \le h - L < h - 1 \le \overline{H}$. If $L \ge C\gamma^{-4}\log(\frac{|\overline{\mathcal{S}}|}{\epsilon})$, then the following set of inequalities hold

$$\mathbb{E}_{\bar{o}_{1:h}, \bar{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}}\|\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_h(\bar{o}_{1:h}, \bar{a}_{1:h-1}) - \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'_h(\bar{o}_{h-L+1:h}, \bar{a}_{h-L:h-1})\|_1 \le \epsilon \tag{C.13}$$
$$\mathbb{E}_{\bar{o}_{1:h-1}, \bar{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}}\|\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_h(\bar{o}_{1:h-1}, \bar{a}_{1:h-1}) - \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'_h(\bar{o}_{h-L+1:h-1}, \bar{a}_{h-L:h-1})\|_1 \le \epsilon \tag{C.14}$$
$$\mathbb{E}_{\bar{o}_{1:h}, \bar{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}}\|\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_h(\bar{o}_{1:h-1}, \bar{a}_{1:h-1}, \bar{o}_{N,h}) - \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'_h(\bar{o}_{h-L+1:h-1}, \bar{a}_{h-L:h-1}, \bar{o}_{N,h})\|_1 \le \epsilon. \tag{C.15}$$

*Proof.* Given any LTC problem $\mathcal{L}$, we can construct a Dec-POMDP $\check{\mathcal{D}}$ such that the transition and emission functions of $\check{\mathcal{D}}$ are the same as $\mathcal{L}$, and $\check{\mathcal{D}}$ has a fully-sharing information structure, which means that it shares all the $o_{1:h-1}, a_{1:h}$ as common information at timestep $h$. Since $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ is constructed

from $\mathcal{L}$ after reformulation, expansion, and refinement, for any $h \in [\overline{H}]$, then for any $t \in [H]$, $\overline{o}_{2t} = \emptyset$ always holds and $\overline{a}_{2t-1}$ does not influence the underlying states. Therefore, we have

$$\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_h(\overline{o}_{1:h}, \overline{a}_{1:h-1}) = \boldsymbol{b}_{\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor}(o_{1:\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor}, a_{1:\lfloor \frac{h-1}{2} \rfloor}) = \check{\boldsymbol{b}}_{\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor}(\check{o}_{1:\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor}, \check{a}_{1:\lfloor \frac{h-1}{2} \rfloor})$$
$$\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_h(\overline{o}_{1:h-1}, \overline{a}_{1:h-1}) = \boldsymbol{b}_{\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor}(o_{1:\lfloor \frac{h}{2} \rfloor}, a_{1:\lfloor \frac{h-1}{2} \rfloor}) = \check{\boldsymbol{b}}_{\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor}(\check{o}_{1:\lfloor \frac{h}{2} \rfloor}, \check{a}_{1:\lfloor \frac{h-1}{2} \rfloor}),$$

where $\boldsymbol{b}$ and $\check{\boldsymbol{b}}$ are the beliefs of states similarly defined as $\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}$, but with respect to the models $\mathcal{L}$ and $\check{\mathcal{D}}$, respectively. For the approximate beliefs of the state, similarly, for any $h \in [\overline{H}]$, we have

$$\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'_h(\overline{o}_{h-L+1:h-1}, \overline{a}_{h-L:h-1}) = \boldsymbol{b}'_{\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor}(o_{\lfloor \frac{h-L+2}{2} \rfloor:\lfloor \frac{h}{2} \rfloor}, a_{\lfloor \frac{h-L}{2} \rfloor:\lfloor \frac{h-1}{2} \rfloor}) = \check{\boldsymbol{b}}'_{\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor}(\check{o}_{\lfloor \frac{h-L+2}{2} \rfloor:\lfloor \frac{h}{2} \rfloor}, \check{a}_{\lfloor \frac{h-L}{2} \rfloor:\lfloor \frac{h-1}{2} \rfloor})$$
$$\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'_h(\overline{o}_{h-L+1:h}, \overline{a}_{h-L:h-1}) = \boldsymbol{b}'_{\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor}(o_{\lfloor \frac{h-L+2}{2} \rfloor:\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor}, a_{\lfloor \frac{h-L}{2} \rfloor:\lfloor \frac{h-1}{2} \rfloor}) = \check{\boldsymbol{b}}'_{\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor}(\check{o}_{\lfloor \frac{h-L+2}{2} \rfloor:\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor}, \check{a}_{\lfloor \frac{h-L}{2} \rfloor:\lfloor \frac{h-1}{2} \rfloor}),$$

where $\boldsymbol{b}'$ and $\check{\boldsymbol{b}}'$ are the belief states similarly defined as $\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'$ with respect to models $\mathcal{L}$ and $\check{\mathcal{D}}$. Also, since for any $t \in [H]$, $\overline{a}_{2t-1}$ are communication actions, $\overline{o}_{2t} = \emptyset$ is null, and $\overline{s}_{2t-1} = \overline{s}_{2t}$ always holds. Then, we can write Equations (C.13) and (C.14) as

$$\mathbb{E}_{\{\overline{o}_{2t-1}\}_{t=1}^{\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor}, \{\overline{a}_{2t}\}_{t=1}^{\lfloor \frac{h-1}{2} \rfloor} \sim \overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}} \|\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_h(\overline{o}_{1:h}, \overline{a}_{1:h-1}) - \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'_h(\overline{o}_{h-L+1:h}, \overline{a}_{h-L:h-1})\|_1 \leq \epsilon \tag{C.16}$$

$$\mathbb{E}_{\{\overline{o}_{2t-1}\}_{t=1}^{\lfloor \frac{h}{2} \rfloor}, \{\overline{a}_{2t}\}_{t=1}^{\lfloor \frac{h-1}{2} \rfloor} \sim \overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}} \|\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_h(\overline{o}_{1:h-1}, \overline{a}_{1:h-1}) - \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'_h(\overline{o}_{h-L+1:h-1}, \overline{a}_{h-L:h-1})\|_1 \leq \epsilon. \tag{C.17}$$

Since $\check{\mathcal{D}}$ has a fully-sharing IS, given any strategy $\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}$, we can construct a strategy $\check{g}_{1:H}$ such that, for any $\overline{a}_{1:h-1}, \overline{o}_{1:h}$

$$\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\{\overline{o}_{2t-1}\}_{t=1}^{\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor}, \{\overline{a}_{2t}\}_{t=1}^{\lfloor \frac{h-1}{2} \rfloor} | \overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}) = \mathbb{P}^{\check{\mathcal{D}}}(\check{o}_{1:\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor}, \check{a}_{1:\lfloor \frac{h-1}{2} \rfloor} | \check{g}_{1:H}).$$

Since $\check{\mathcal{D}}$ satisfies Assumption III.1, we can apply Theorem 10 in [14] with $\check{g}_{1:H}$ to get the result that there is a constant $C_0 \geq 1$ such that if $L' \geq C_0 \gamma^{-4} \log(\frac{S}{\epsilon})$, the following holds

$$\mathbb{E}_{\check{o}_{1:\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor}, \check{a}_{1:\lfloor \frac{h-1}{2} \rfloor} \sim \check{g}_{1:H}} \|\check{\boldsymbol{b}}_{\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor}(\check{o}_{1:\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor}, \check{a}_{1:\lfloor \frac{h-1}{2} \rfloor}) - \check{\boldsymbol{b}}'_{\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor}(\check{o}_{\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor - L'+1:\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor}, \check{a}_{\lfloor \frac{h}{2} \rfloor - L':\lfloor \frac{h-1}{2} \rfloor})\|_1 \leq \epsilon \tag{C.18}$$

$$\mathbb{E}_{\check{o}_{1:\lfloor \frac{h}{2} \rfloor}, \check{a}_{1:\lfloor \frac{h-1}{2} \rfloor} \sim \check{g}_{1:H}} \|\check{\boldsymbol{b}}_{\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor}(\check{o}_{1:\lfloor \frac{h}{2} \rfloor}, \check{a}_{1:\lfloor \frac{h-1}{2} \rfloor}) - \check{\boldsymbol{b}}'_{\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor}(\check{o}_{\lfloor \frac{h+1}{2} \rfloor - L'+1:\lfloor \frac{h}{2} \rfloor}, \check{a}_{\lfloor \frac{h}{2} \rfloor - L':\lfloor \frac{h-1}{2} \rfloor})\|_1 \leq \epsilon. \tag{C.19}$$

We choose $C = 3C_0, L = 2L' + 1$. If $L \geq C\gamma^{-4} \log(\frac{|\mathcal{S}|}{\epsilon})$, we have $L' \geq C_0 \gamma^{-4} \log(\frac{|\overline{\mathcal{S}}|}{\epsilon})$. Therefore, we can get Equations (C.16) and (C.17).

For Equation (C.15), we can apply Equation (E.10) of Theorem 10 in [14] with a slight change as

$$\mathbb{E}^{\check{\mathcal{D}}}_{\check{o}_{1:h}, \check{a}_{1:h-1} \sim \check{g}_{1:H}} \|\check{\boldsymbol{b}}_h(\check{o}_{1:h-1}, \check{a}_{1:h-1}, \check{o}_{N,h}) - \check{\boldsymbol{b}}'_h(\check{o}_{h-L+1:h-1}, \check{a}_{h-L:h-1}, \check{o}_{N,h})\|_1 \leq \epsilon. \tag{C.20}$$

This still holds we change the posterior update $F^q(P : \check{o}_{1,h})$ to $F^q(P : \check{o}_{N,h})$, when applying Lemma 12 in the proof of Theorem 10 in [14]. Therefore, we can use the same arguments to prove Equation (C.15) from Equation (C.20) as above, which completes the proof. □

Then, we discuss the 8 examples of QC LTC given in §A case by case. For each of them, we compress the common information as $\{\widehat{c}_h\}_{h \in [\overline{H}]}$ using a finite-memory truncation, construct beliefs $\{\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},c}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \widehat{c}_h)\}_{h \in [\overline{H}]}$, and then construct an expected approximate common-information model $\mathcal{M}$

according to $\{\widehat{c}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$, $\{\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},c}(\bar{s}_h,\bar{p}_h|\widehat{c}_h)\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$, and Definition C.9. Note that after reformulation, strict expansion, and refinement, **Example 5** will be the same as **Example 1**, and **Example 7** will be the same as **Example 2**; **Example 6** is similar to **Example 1**, and **Example 8** is similar to **Example 2**. Hence, we categorize the examples into 6 **Types**, and verify that the constructed $\mathcal{M}$ is an $(\epsilon_r,\epsilon_z)$-expected approximate common-information model with $\epsilon_r=\epsilon_z=\epsilon$ and satisfies Assumption IV.7.

**Type 1:** Baseline sharing of $\mathcal{L}$ is one of **Examples 1** and **5** in §A. Then, common information should be that for any $t\in[H]$, $\bar{c}_{2t-1}=\{\bar{o}_{1:2t-2},\bar{a}_{1:2t-2}\}$, $\bar{c}_{2t}=\{\bar{o}_{1:2t-2},\bar{a}_{1:2t-1},\bar{o}_{N,2t-1}\}$, $N\subseteq[n]$, where $N$ is the set of agents that choose to share their observations through additional sharing, and $N$ can be inferred from $\bar{c}_{2t}$. Then, we have that $\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{2t-1}(\bar{s}_{2t-1},\bar{p}_{2t-1}|\bar{c}_{2t-1})=\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{1:2t-2},\bar{a}_{1:2t-2})(\bar{s}_{2t-1})\overline{\mathbb{O}}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{2t-1}|\bar{s}_{2t-1})$. Fix compression length $L>0$, for timestep $2t-1$, we define the approximate common information as $\widehat{c}_{2t-1}=\{\bar{o}_{2t-L:2t-2},\bar{a}_{2t-1-L:2t-2}\}$, and the approximate common information conditioned belief as $\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{M},c}_{2t-1}(\bar{s}_{2t-1},\bar{p}_{2t-1}|\widehat{c}_{2t-1})=\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{2t-L:2t-2},\bar{a}_{2t-1-L:2t-2})(\bar{s}_{2t-1})\overline{\mathbb{O}}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{2t-1}|\bar{s}_{2t-1})$. Also, we have $\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{2t}(\bar{s}_{2t},\bar{p}_{2t}|\bar{c}_{2t})=\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{1:2t-2},\bar{a}_{1:2t-2},\bar{o}_{N,2t-1})(\bar{s}_{2t-1})\mathbb{P}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{-N,2t-1}|\bar{s}_{2t-1},\bar{o}_{N,2t-1})$, where $\mathbb{P}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{-N,2t-1}|\bar{s}_{2t-1},\bar{o}_{N,2t-1})=\frac{\overline{\mathbb{O}}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{N,2t-1},\bar{o}_{-N,2t-1}|\bar{s}_{2t-1})}{\sum_{\bar{o}'_{-N,2t-1}}\overline{\mathbb{O}}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{N,2t-1},\bar{o}'_{-N,2t-1}|\bar{s}_{2t-1})}$, we used the belief at timestep $2t-1$ since $\bar{s}_{2t}=\bar{s}_{2t-1}$, and we noted that $\bar{p}_{2t}=\bar{o}_{-N,2t-1}$. For timestep $2t$, we define the approximate common information a $\widehat{c}_{2t}=\{\bar{o}_{2t-L:2t-2},\bar{a}_{2t-L-1:2t-1},\bar{o}_{N,2t-1}\}$, and the common information conditioned belief as $\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{M},c}_{2t}(\bar{s}_{2t},\bar{p}_{2t}|\widehat{c}_{2t})=\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{2t-L:2t-2},\bar{a}_{2t-1-L:2t-2},\bar{o}_{N,2t-1})(\bar{s}_{2t-1})\mathbb{P}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{-N,2t-1}|\bar{s}_{2t-1},\bar{o}_{N,2t-1})$. After that, we can construct $\{\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{M},z}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]},\{\widehat{\mathcal{R}}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$ based on $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ and $\{\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{M},c}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$.

Now, we need to verify that Definition C.7 is satisfied.

- The $\{\widehat{c}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$ satisfied Equation (C.5), since for any $h\in[\overline{H}]$, $\widehat{c}_{h+1}\subseteq\widehat{c}_h\cup\bar{z}_h$.
- Note that for any $\bar{c}_{2t-1}$ and the corresponding $\widehat{c}_{2t-1}$ constructed above, according to Lemma C.15, we have:

$$\begin{aligned}
&\|\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{2t-1}(\cdot,\cdot|\bar{c}_{2t-1})-\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{M},c}_{2t-1}(\cdot,\cdot|\widehat{c}_{2t-1})\|_1\\
&\quad=\sum_{\bar{s}_{2t-1},\bar{o}_{2t-1}}|\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{1:2t-2},\bar{a}_{1:2t-2})(\bar{s}_{2t-1})\overline{\mathbb{O}}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{2t-1}|\bar{s}_{2t-1})\\
&\qquad\qquad-\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{2t-L:2t-1},\bar{a}_{2t-1-L:2t-2})(\bar{s}_{2t-1})\overline{\mathbb{O}}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{2t-1}|\bar{s}_{2t-1})|\\
&\quad\le\|\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{1:2t-2},\bar{a}_{1:2t-2})-\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{2t-L:2t-1},\bar{a}_{2t-1-L:2t-2})\|_1.
\end{aligned}$$

For any $\bar{c}_{2t}$ and the corresponding $\widehat{c}_{2t}$ constructed above, according to Lemma C.15, we have:

$$\begin{aligned}
&\|\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{2t}(\cdot,\cdot|\bar{c}_{2t})-\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{M},c}_{2t}(\cdot,\cdot|\widehat{c}_{2t})\|_1\\
&\quad=\sum_{\bar{s}_{2t-1},\bar{o}_{-N,2t-1}}|\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{1:2t-2},\bar{a}_{1:2t-2},\bar{o}_{N,2t-1})(\bar{s}_{2t-1})\mathbb{P}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{-N,2t-1}|\bar{s}_{2t-1},\bar{o}_{N,2t-1})\\
&\qquad\qquad-\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{2t-L:2t-2},\bar{a}_{2t-1-L:2t-2},\bar{o}_{N,2t-1})(\bar{s}_{2t-1})\mathbb{P}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{-N,2t-1}|\bar{s}_{2t-1},\bar{o}_{N,2t-1})|\\
&\quad\le\|\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{1:2t-2},\bar{a}_{1:2t-2},\bar{o}_{N,2t-1})-\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{2t-L:2t-2},\bar{a}_{2t-1-L:2t-2},\bar{o}_{N,2t-1})\|_1.
\end{aligned}$$

If we choose $L\ge C\gamma^{-4}\log(\frac{|\overline{\mathcal{S}}|}{\epsilon})$, then from Lemma C.16, we have that for any $h\in[\overline{H}]$

$$\mathbb{E}_{\bar{o}_{1:h},\bar{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}}\|\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_h(\cdot,\cdot|\bar{c}_h)-\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{M},c}_h(\cdot,\cdot|\widehat{c}_h)\|_1\le\epsilon.$$

- Based on Lemma G.2, $\mathcal{M}$ satisfies Assumption IV.7 since: **Turn-based structures** in §G-B is satisfied if the additional condition 1) in §A holds; **Factorized structures** in §G-B is satisfied if the additional condition 2) in §A holds; **Nested private information** in §G-B is satisfied if the additional condition 3) in §A holds.

Therefore, based on Lemma C.15, such a model is an $(\epsilon_r, \epsilon_z)$-expected approximate common-information model with $\epsilon_r = \epsilon_z = \epsilon$ and satisfies Assumption IV.7.

**Type 2:** Baseline sharing of $\mathcal{L}$ is **Example 3** in §A. Then, common information should be that for any $t \in [H], \bar{c}_{2t-1} = \{\bar{o}_{1:2t-2}, \bar{a}_{1:2t-2}, \bar{o}_{1,2t-1}\}, \bar{c}_{2t} = \{\bar{o}_{1:2t-2}, \bar{a}_{1:2t-1}, \bar{o}_{N,2t-1}\}, N \subseteq [n], 1 \in N$. Here $N$ is the same as defined in **Type 1**, but it must satisfy that $1 \in N$. Similarly as **Type 1**, we construct $\widehat{c}_{2t-1} = \{\bar{o}_{2t-L:2t-2}, \bar{a}_{2t-L-1:2t-2}, \bar{o}_{1,2t-1}\}, \widehat{c}_{2t} = \{\bar{o}_{2t-L:2t-2}, \bar{a}_{2t-L-1:2t-1}, \bar{o}_{N,2t-1}\}$, and approximate common information conditioned belief as $\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{M},c}_{2t-1}(\bar{s}_{2t-1}, \bar{p}_{2t-1} | \widehat{c}_{2t-1}) = \bar{\boldsymbol{b}}'_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{2t-L:2t-2}, \bar{a}_{2t-1-L:2t-2}, \bar{o}_{1,2t-1})(\bar{s}_{2t-1})\mathbb{P}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{-1,2t-1} | \bar{s}_{2t-1}, \bar{o}_{1,2t-1}), \mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{M},c}_{2t}(\bar{s}_{2t}, \bar{p}_{2t} | \widehat{c}_{2t}) = \bar{\boldsymbol{b}}'_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{2t-L:2t-2}, \bar{a}_{2t-1-L:2t-2}, \bar{o}_{N,2t-1})(\bar{s}_{2t-1})\mathbb{P}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{-N,2t-1} | \bar{s}_{2t-1}, \bar{o}_{N,2t-1})$, where we used the belief at timestep $2t-1$, similarly as **Type 1**. After that, we can construct $\{\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{M},z}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}, \{\widehat{\mathcal{R}}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$ based on $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ and $\{\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{M},c}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$. Now, we need to verify Definition C.7 is satisfied.

- The $\{\widehat{c}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$ satisfies Equation (C.5), since for any $h \in [\overline{H}]$, $\widehat{c}_{h+1} \subseteq \widehat{c}_h \cup \bar{z}_h$.
- Note that for any $\bar{c}_{2t-1}$ and the corresponding $\widehat{c}_{2t-1}$ constructed above, according to Lemma C.15, we have:

$$
\begin{aligned}
&\|\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{2t-1}(\cdot,\cdot|\bar{c}_{2t-1}) - \mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{M},c}_{2t-1}(\cdot,\cdot|\widehat{c}_{2t-1})\|_1 \\
&= \sum_{\bar{s}_{2t-1}, \bar{o}_{-1,2t-1}} |\bar{\boldsymbol{b}}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{1:2t-2}, \bar{a}_{1:2t-1}, \bar{o}_{1,2t-1})(\bar{s}_{2t-1})\mathbb{P}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{-1,2t-1} | \bar{s}_{2t-1}, \bar{o}_{1,2t-1}) \\
&\qquad - \bar{\boldsymbol{b}}'_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{2t-L:2t-2}, \bar{a}_{2t-1-L:2t-2}, \bar{o}_{1,2t-1})(\bar{s}_{2t-1})\mathbb{P}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{-1,2t-1} | \bar{s}_{2t-1}, \bar{o}_{1,2t-1})| \\
&\leq \|\bar{\boldsymbol{b}}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{1:2t-2}, \bar{a}_{1:2t-1}, \bar{o}_{1,2t-1}) - \bar{\boldsymbol{b}}'_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{2t-L:2t-2}, \bar{a}_{2t-1-L:2t-2}, \bar{o}_{1,2t-1})\|_1.
\end{aligned}
$$

For any $\bar{c}_{2t}$ and the corresponding $\widehat{c}_{2t}$ constructed above, according to Lemma C.15, we have:

$$
\begin{aligned}
&\|\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{2t}(\cdot,\cdot|\bar{c}_{2t}) - \mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{M},c}_{2t}(\cdot,\cdot|\widehat{c}_{2t})\|_1 \\
&= \sum_{\bar{s}_{2t-1}, \bar{o}_{-N,2t-1}} |\bar{\boldsymbol{b}}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{1:2t-2}, \bar{a}_{1:2t-2}, \bar{o}_{N,2t-1})(\bar{s}_{2t-1})\mathbb{P}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{-N,2t-1} | \bar{s}_{2t-1}, \bar{o}_{N,2t-1}) \\
&\qquad - \bar{\boldsymbol{b}}'_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{2t-L:2t-2}, \bar{a}_{2t-1-L:2t-2}, \bar{o}_{N,2t-1})(\bar{s}_{2t-1})\mathbb{P}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{-N,2t-1} | \bar{s}_{2t-1}, \bar{o}_{N,2t-1})| \\
&\leq \|\bar{\boldsymbol{b}}_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{1:2t-2}, \bar{a}_{1:2t-2}, \bar{o}_{N,2t-1}) - \bar{\boldsymbol{b}}'_{2t-1}(\bar{o}_{2t-L:2t-2}, \bar{a}_{2t-1-L:2t-2}, \bar{o}_{N,2t-1})\|_1.
\end{aligned}
$$

If we choose $L \geq C\gamma^{-4}\log(\frac{|\overline{\mathcal{S}}|}{\epsilon})$, then from Lemma C.16, we have that for any $h \in [\overline{H}]$

$$
\mathbb{E}_{\bar{o}_{1:h}, \bar{a}_{1:h-1} \sim \bar{g}_{1:\overline{H}}} \|\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_h(\cdot,\cdot|\bar{c}_h) - \mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{M},c}_h(\cdot,\cdot|\widehat{c}_h)\|_1 \leq \epsilon.
$$

- Based on Lemma G.2, $\mathcal{M}$ satisfies Assumption IV.7, since the condition **Nested private information** in §G-B is satisfied.

Therefore, based on Lemma C.15, such a model is an $(\epsilon_r, \epsilon_z)$-expected approximate common-information model with $\epsilon_r = \epsilon_z = \epsilon$ and satisfies Assumption IV.7.

**Type 3:** Baseline sharing of $\mathcal{L}$ is one of **Examples 2** and **7** in §A. Then, the common information should be that, for any $h \in [\overline{H}], \overline{c}_h = \{\overline{o}_{1:h-2d}, \overline{a}_{1,1:h-1}, \{\overline{a}_{-1,2t-1}\}_{t=1}^{\lfloor \frac{h}{2} \rfloor}, \overline{o}_{1,h-2d+1:h}, \overline{o}_M\}$, where $M \subseteq \{(i,t) | 1 < i \leq n, h-2d+1 \leq t \leq h\}$, $\overline{o}_M = \{\overline{o}_{i,t} | (i,t) \in M\}$, and the $-1$ index means all the agents except agent 1. The corresponding private information is defined as $\overline{p}_h = \{\overline{o}_{i,t} | 1 < i \leq n, h-2d < t \leq h, (i,t) \notin M\}$. Actually, $\overline{o}_M$ is the observation shared by the additional sharing in $\mathcal{L}$. Denote $f_{\tau,h-2d} = \{\overline{o}_{1:h-2d}, \overline{a}_{1,1:h-2d-1}, \{\overline{a}_{-1,2t-1}\}_{t=1}^{\lfloor \frac{h-2d}{2} \rfloor}\}, f_a = \{\overline{a}_{1,h-2d:h-1}, \{\overline{a}_{-1,2t-1}\}_{t=\lfloor \frac{h-2d}{2} \rfloor+1}^{\lfloor \frac{h}{2} \rfloor}\}, f_o = \{\overline{o}_{1,h-2d+1:h}, \overline{o}_M\}$, we can then compute the common-information-based belief as

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_h) &= \sum_{\overline{s}_{h-2d}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{s}_{h-2d}, f_a, f_o) \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_{h-2d} | f_{\tau,h-2d}, f_a, f_o) \\
&= \sum_{\overline{s}_{h-2d}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{s}_{h-2d}, f_a, f_o) \frac{\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_{h-2d}, f_a, f_o | f_{\tau,h-2d})}{\sum_{\overline{s}'_{h-2d}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}'_{h-2d}, f_a, f_o | f_{\tau,h-2d})}.
\end{aligned}$$

Denote the probability $P_h(f_o | \overline{s}_{h-2d}, f_a) := \Pi_{t=1}^{2d} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{o}_{1,h-2d+t}, \overline{o}_{M_{h-2d+t}} | \overline{s}_{h-2d}, \overline{a}_{1,h-2d:h-2d+t})$, where $M_{h-2d+t} = \{(i, h-2d+t) | (i, h-2d+t) \in M\}$ denotes the set of observations at timestep $h-2d+t$ and shared through additional sharing. With such notation, we have

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_{h-2d} | f_{\tau,h-2d}, f_a, f_o) =& \frac{\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{1:h-2d}, \overline{a}_{1:h-2d-1})(\overline{s}_{h-2d}) P_h(f_o | \overline{s}_{h-2d}, f_a)}{\sum_{\overline{s}'_{h-2d}} \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{1:h-2d}, \overline{a}_{1:h-2d-1})(\overline{s}'_{h-2d}) P_h(f_o | \overline{s}'_{h-2d}, f_a)} \\
=& F^{P_h(\cdot|\cdot,f_a)}(\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{1:h-2d}, \overline{a}_{1:h-2d-1}); f_o)(\overline{s}_{h-2d}),
\end{aligned}$$

where $F^{P_h(\cdot|\cdot,f_a)}(\cdot; f_o) : \Delta(\mathcal{S}) \to \Delta(\mathcal{S})$ is the posterior belief update function, which is defined as: $F^{P_h(\cdot|\cdot,f_a)}(\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}; f_o)(\overline{s}) = \frac{\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}(\overline{s}) P_h(f_o | \overline{s}, f_a)}{\sum_{\overline{s}' \in \overline{\mathcal{S}}} \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}(\overline{s}') P_h(f_o | \overline{s}', f_a)}$ for any $\overline{s} \in \overline{\mathcal{S}}, \overline{\boldsymbol{b}} \in \Delta(\overline{\mathcal{S}})$.

Then, we can define the approximate common information as $\widehat{c}_h := \{\overline{o}_{h-2d-L+1:h-2d}, \overline{o}_{1,h-2d+1:h}, \overline{a}_{1,h-2d-L:h-1}, \{\overline{a}_{-1,2t-1}\}_{t=\lfloor \frac{h-2d+1}{2} \rfloor}^{\lfloor \frac{h}{2} \rfloor}, \overline{o}_M\}$ and the corresponding approximate common information conditioned belief as

$$\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},c}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \widehat{c}_h) = \sum_{\overline{s}_{h-2d}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{s}_{h-2d}, f_a, f_o) F^{P_h(\cdot|\cdot,f_a)}(\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{h-2d-L+1:h-2d}, \overline{a}_{h-2d-L:h-2d-1}); f_o)(\overline{s}_{h-2d}).$$

After that, we can construct $\{\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},z}\}_{h \in [\overline{H}]}, \{\widehat{\mathcal{R}}_h\}_{h \in [\overline{H}]}$ based on $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ and $\{\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},c}\}_{h \in [\overline{H}]}$. Now we verify that Definition C.7 is satisfied.

- By definition, the $\{\widehat{c}_h\}_{h \in [\overline{H}]}$ satisfies Equation (C.5).
- For any $\overline{c}_h$ and the corresponding $\widehat{c}_h$ constructed above, according to Lemma C.15, we have:

$$\begin{aligned}
&\|\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\cdot, \cdot | \overline{c}_h) - \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},c}(\cdot, \cdot | \widehat{c}_h)\|_1 \\
&\quad \leq \|F^{P_h(\cdot|\cdot,f_a)}(\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{1:h-2d}, \overline{a}_{1:h-2d-1}); f_o) - F^{P_h(\cdot|\cdot,f_a)}(\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{h-2d-L+1:h-2d}, \overline{a}_{h-2d-L:h-2d-1}); f_o)\|_1.
\end{aligned}$$

If we choose $L \geq C\gamma^{-4} \log(\frac{|\overline{\mathcal{S}}|}{\epsilon})$, then for any strategy $\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}$, by taking expectations over

$f_{\tau,h-2d}, f_a, f_o$, from Lemma C.16 and Lemma 12 in [14], we have that for any $h \in [\overline{H}]$

$$\mathbb{E}_{\overline{o}_{1:h},\overline{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}}\|\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\cdot,\cdot\,|\,\overline{c}_h) - \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},c}(\cdot,\cdot\,|\,\widehat{c}_h)\|_1 \le \epsilon.$$

- Based on Lemma G.2, $\mathcal{M}$ satisfies Assumption IV.7, since the condition **Turn-based structures** in §G-B is satisfied.

Therefore, based on Lemma C.15, such a model is an $(\epsilon_r, \epsilon_z)$-expected approximate common-information model with $\epsilon_r = \epsilon_z = \epsilon$ and satisfies Assumption IV.7.

**Type 4:** Baseline sharing of $\mathcal{L}$ is **Example 4** in §A. Then, the common information should be that for any $h \in [\overline{H}]$, $\overline{c}_h = \{\overline{o}_{1:h-2d}, \{\overline{a}_{2t-1}\}_{t=1}^{\lfloor \frac{h}{2} \rfloor}, \overline{o}_M\}$, where $M \subseteq \{(i,t)\,|\,i \in [n], h-2d+1 \le t \le h\}$. Then, we denote $f_{\tau,h-2d} = \{\overline{o}_{1:h-2d}, \{\overline{a}_{2t-1}\}_{t=1}^{\lfloor \frac{h}{2} \rfloor}\}, f_o = \{\overline{o}_M\}$. We can compute the common-information-based belief as

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h\,|\,\overline{c}_h) &= \sum_{\overline{s}_{h-2d}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h\,|\,\overline{s}_{h-2d}, f_o)\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_{h-2d}\,|\,f_{\tau,h-2d}, f_o) \\ &= \sum_{\overline{s}_{h-2d}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h\,|\,\overline{s}_{h-2d}, f_o)\frac{\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_{h-2d}, f_o\,|\,f_{\tau,h-2d})}{\sum_{\overline{s}'_{h-2d}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}'_{h-2d}, f_o\,|\,f_{\tau,h-2d})}.\end{aligned}$$

Denote the probability $P_h(f_o\,|\,\overline{s}_{h-2d}) := \Pi_{t=1}^{2d}\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{o}_{1,h-2d+t}, \overline{o}_{M_{h-2d+t}}\,|\,\overline{s}_{h-2d})$, where $M_{h-2d+t} = \{(i, h-2d+t)\,|\,(i,h-2d+t) \in M\}$ denotes the set of observations at timestep $h-2d+t$ and shared through additional sharing. Since the actions do not influence the underlying states, here we use the belief notation $\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_k(\overline{o}_{1:k}), \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_k(\overline{o}_{k-L:k}), \forall k \in [\overline{H}], L < k$. With such notation, we have

$$\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_{h-2d}\,|\,f_{\tau,h-2d}, f_o) = \frac{\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{1:h-2d})(\overline{s}_{h-2d})P_h(f_o\,|\,\overline{s}_{h-2d})}{\sum_{\overline{s}'_{h-2d}}\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{1:h-2d})(\overline{s}'_{h-2d})P_h(f_o\,|\,\overline{s}'_{h-2d})} = F^{P_h(\cdot\,|\,\cdot)}(\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{1:h-2d}); f_o)(\overline{s}_{h-2d}),$$

where $F^{P_h(\cdot\,|\,\cdot)}(\cdot; f_o) : \Delta(\mathcal{S}) \to \Delta(\mathcal{S})$ is the posterior belief update function, as discussed in **Type 3**.
Then, we define the approximate common information as $\widehat{c}_h := \{\overline{o}_{h-2d-L+1:h-2d}, \{\overline{a}_{2t-1}\}_{t=\lfloor \frac{h-2d+1}{2} \rfloor}^{\lfloor \frac{h}{2} \rfloor}, \overline{o}_M\}$ and the corresponding approximate common information conditioned belief as

$$\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},c}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h\,|\,\widehat{c}_h) = \sum_{\overline{s}_{h-2d}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h\,|\,\overline{s}_{h-2d}, f_o)F^{P_h(\cdot\,|\,\cdot)}(\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{h-2d-L+1:h-2d}); f_o)(\overline{s}_{h-2d}).$$

Furthermore, we can construct $\{\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},z}\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}, \{\widehat{\mathcal{R}}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$ based on $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ and $\{\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},c}\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$. Now we verify that Definition C.7 is satisfied.

- By definition, the $\{\widehat{c}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$ satisfies Equation (C.5).
- For any $\overline{c}_h$ and the corresponding $\widehat{c}_h$ constructed above, according to Lemma C.15, we have:

$$\begin{aligned}&\|\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\cdot,\cdot\,|\,\overline{c}_h) - \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},c}(\cdot,\cdot\,|\,\widehat{c}_h)\|_1 \\ &\quad\le \|F^{P(\cdot\,|\,\cdot)}(\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{1:h-2d}); f_o) - F^{P(\cdot\,|\,\cdot)}(\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{h-2d-L+1:h-2d}); f_o)\|_1.\end{aligned}$$

If we choose $L \ge C\gamma^{-4}\log(\frac{|\overline{\mathcal{S}}|}{\epsilon})$, then for any strategy $\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}$, by taking expectations over $f_{\tau,h-2d}, f_o$,

from Lemma C.16 and Lemma 12 in [14], we have that for any $h \in [\overline{H}]$

$$\mathbb{E}_{\overline{o}_{1:h},\overline{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}}\|\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\cdot,\cdot|\overline{c}_h) - \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},c}(\cdot,\cdot|\widehat{c}_h)\|_1 \le \epsilon.$$

- Based on Lemma G.2, $\mathcal{M}$ satisfies Assumption IV.7, since the condition of **Turn-based structures** in §G-B is satisfied.

Therefore, based on Lemma C.15, such a model is an $(\epsilon_r, \epsilon_z)$-expected approximate common-information model with $\epsilon_r = \epsilon_z = \epsilon$ and satisfies Assumption IV.7.

**Type 5:** Baseline sharing of $\mathcal{L}$ is **Example 6**. Note that after reformulation, expansion, and refinement, the common information in **Example 6** is the same as that in **Example 1**. The only difference is in private information: for any $t \in [H-1]$, $i \in [n]$, $\overline{a}_{i,2t} \in \overline{p}_{i,2t+1}$ always holds, and $\overline{a}_{i,2t} \in \overline{p}_{i,2t+2}$ may happen. Meanwhile, $\overline{a}_{i,2t} \in \overline{c}_{2t+1} \subseteq \overline{c}_{2t+2}$ always holds. Therefore, we can use the same expected approximate common-information model as **Type 1**: $\forall t \in [H], \widehat{c}_{2t-1} = \{\overline{o}_{2t-L:2t-2}, \overline{a}_{2t-1-L:2t-2}\}, \widehat{c}_{2t} = \{\overline{o}_{2t-L:2t-2}, \overline{a}_{2t-1-L:2t-1}, \overline{o}_{N,2t-1}\}$. We construct the approximate common information conditioned belief as $\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{M},c}_{2t-1}(\overline{s}_{2t-1}, \overline{p}_{2t-1}|\widehat{c}_{2t-1}) = \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'_{2t-1}(\overline{o}_{2t-L:2t-2}, \overline{a}_{2t-1-L:2t-2})(\overline{s}_{2t-1})\overline{\mathbb{O}}_{2t-1}(\overline{o}_{2t-1}|\overline{s}_{2t-1})\Psi^1_{2t-1}(\overline{p}_{2t-1}, \widehat{c}_{2t-1}), \mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{M},c}_{2t}(\overline{s}_{2t}, \overline{p}_{2t}|\widehat{c}_{2t}) = \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'_{2t-1}(\overline{o}_{2t-L:2t-2}, \overline{a}_{2t-1-L:2t-2}, \overline{o}_{N,2t-1})(\overline{s}_{2t-1})\mathbb{P}_{2t-1}(\overline{o}_{-N,2t-1}|\overline{s}_{2t-1}, \overline{o}_{N,2t-1})\Psi^1_{2t}(\overline{p}_{2t}, \widehat{c}_{2t})$. Note that here we use the belief at timestep $2t-1$ to construct $\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{M},c}_{2t}$ similarly as **Type 1**, and the functions $\{\Psi^1_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$ are defined as: $\forall t \in [H], \overline{p}_{2t-1}, \widehat{c}_{2t-1}, \overline{p}_{2t}$ and $\widehat{c}_{2t}$,

$$\Psi^1_{2t-1}(\overline{p}_{2t-1}, \widehat{c}_{2t-1}) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{the value of } \overline{a}_{2t-1} \text{ in } \overline{p}_{2t-1} \text{ is the same as the value of that in } \widehat{c}_{2t-1} \\ 0 & \text{o.w.} \end{cases}$$

$$\Psi^1_{2t}(\overline{p}_{2t}, \widehat{c}_{2t}) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{for any } i \in [n] \text{ such that the random variable } \overline{a}_{i,2t-2} \in \overline{p}_{2t}, \\ & \text{the value of } \overline{a}_{i,2t-2} \text{ in } \overline{p}_{2t} \text{ is the same as that in } \widehat{c}_{2t} \\ 0 & \text{o.w.} \end{cases}.$$

One can verify that Definition C.7 is satisfied as in **Type 1**. This is because, for any $h \in [\overline{H}]$, compared to **Type 1**, the only difference is that there are only some actions in $\overline{p}_h$, and such actions will also appear in $\widehat{c}_h$. Therefore, if the values of such actions in $\overline{p}_h$ are consistent with those in $\widehat{c}_h$, which is ensured by the functions $\{\Psi^1_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$, then we can leverage the validation in **Type 1**.

**Type 6:** Baseline sharing of $\mathcal{L}$ is **Example 8**. Note that after reformulation, expansion, and refinement, the common information in **Example 8** is the same as that in **Example 2**. The only difference is in the private information: for any $t \in [H-1], \overline{a}_{1,2t} \in \overline{p}_{1,2t+1}$ always holds, and $\overline{a}_{1,2t} \in \overline{p}_{1,2t+2}$ may happen. Meanwhile, $\overline{a}_{1,2t} \in \overline{c}_{2t+1} \subseteq \overline{c}_{2t+2}$ always holds. Therefore, we can use the same expected approximate common-information model as **Type 3**: $\forall h \in [\overline{H}], \widehat{c}_h := \{\overline{o}_{h-2d-L+1:h-2d}, \overline{o}_{1,h-2d+1:h}, \overline{a}_{1,h-2d-L:h-1}, \{\overline{a}_{-1,2t-1}\}_{t=\lfloor\frac{h-2d+1}{2}\rfloor}^{\lfloor\frac{h}{2}\rfloor}, \overline{o}_M\}$, and construct beliefs as:

$$\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{M},c}_h(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h|\widehat{c}_h) = \sum_{\overline{s}_{h-2d}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h|\overline{s}_{h-2d}, f_a, f_o)F^{P_h(\cdot|\cdot,f_a)}(\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}'_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{h-2d-L:h-2d}, \overline{a}_{h-2d-L:h-2d-1}, ); f_o)(\overline{s}_{h-2d})\Psi^2_h(\overline{p}_h, \widehat{c}_h),$$

where the functions $\{\Psi_h^2\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$ are defined as: $\forall t \in [H], \overline{p}_{2t-1}, \widehat{c}_{2t-1}, \overline{p}_{2t}$ and $\widehat{c}_{2t}$

$$\Psi_{2t-1}^2(\overline{p}_{2t-1}, \widehat{c}_{2t-1}) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{the value of } \overline{a}_{1,2t-1} \text{ in } \overline{p}_{2t-1} \text{ is the same as the value of that in } \widehat{c}_{2t-1} \\ 0 & \text{o.w.} \end{cases}$$

$$\Psi_{2t}^2(\overline{p}_{2t}, \widehat{c}_{2t}) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{random variable } \overline{a}_{1,2t-2} \notin \overline{p}_{2t} \text{ or the value of } \overline{a}_{1,2t-2} \text{ in } \overline{p}_{2t} \text{ is the same as that in } \widehat{c}_{2t} \\ 0 & \text{o.w.} \end{cases}.$$

One can verify that Definition C.7 is satisfied as in **Type 3**. This is because, for any $h \in [\overline{H}]$, compared to **Type 3**, the only difference is that there are only some actions of agent 1 in $\overline{p}_h$, but such actions will also appear in $\widehat{c}_h$. Therefore, if the values of such actions in $\overline{p}_h$ are consistent with those in $\widehat{c}_h$, which is ensured by the functions $\{\Psi_h^2\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$, then we can leverage the validation in **Type 3**.

Lastly, we can apply the result of **Part II** and obtain the time complexity as follows, and complete **Part III**:

- **Examples 1, 3, 5, 6:** Since the compressed common information satisfies $\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}|\widehat{\mathcal{C}}_h| = \max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}(|\overline{\mathcal{O}}_h||\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h|)^{C\gamma^{-4}\log(\frac{|\overline{\mathcal{S}}|}{\epsilon})}$, the complexity is $\mathrm{poly}(\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}(|\overline{\mathcal{O}}_h||\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h|)^{C\gamma^{-4}\log(\frac{|\overline{\mathcal{S}}|}{\epsilon})}, |\overline{\mathcal{S}}|, \overline{H}, \frac{1}{\epsilon})$ ;
- **Examples 2, 4, 7, 8:** Since the compressed common information satisfies $\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}|\widehat{\mathcal{C}}_h| = \max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}(|\overline{\mathcal{O}}_h||\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h|)^{C\gamma^{-4}\log(\frac{|\overline{\mathcal{S}}|}{\epsilon})+2d}$, the complexity is $\mathrm{poly}(\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}(|\overline{\mathcal{O}}_h||\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h|)^{C\gamma^{-4}\log(\frac{|\overline{\mathcal{S}}|}{\epsilon})+2d}, |\overline{\mathcal{S}}|, \overline{H}, \frac{1}{\epsilon})$.

Combining **Parts I, II, III**, we complete the proof. □

## C-I Main Results for Learning in QC LTCs

**Theorem C.17** (Full version of Theorem IV.9)**.** Given any QC LTC problem $\mathcal{L}$ satisfying Assumptions III.1, III.4, III.5, and III.7, we can construct a Dec-POMDP problem $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ with SI-CIBs. Moreover, given any compression functions $\{\mathrm{Compress}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$, evolution rules $\{\widehat{\phi}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$ of the compressed common information $\{\widehat{c}_h \in \widehat{\mathcal{C}}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$, $\epsilon \in (0,1), \delta \in (0,1)$, and $\widehat{L}$ as defined in Definition C.11, we can apply Algorithm 2 with a universal constant $C$ as chosen in [14, Theorem 8]. If the $K = 2\overline{H}|\overline{\mathcal{S}}|$ learned expected approximate common-information models $\{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j})\}_{j\in[K]}$ all satisfy Assumption IV.7, then an $\epsilon_0$-team-optimal strategy for $\mathcal{L}$ can be learned with probability $1-\delta$, with time and sample complexities polynomial in the parameters of $\{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j})\}_{j\in[K]}$, where $\epsilon_0$ is defined as

$$\epsilon_0 := \min_{j\in[K]} \; 2\overline{H}\epsilon_r(\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j})) + \overline{H}^2\epsilon_z(\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j})) + \frac{\epsilon}{2}.$$

Specifically, if $\mathcal{L}$ has a baseline sharing protocol as one of the examples in §A, then given any $\epsilon \in (0,1), \delta \in (0,1)$, we can construct compression functions $\{\mathrm{Compress}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$ and evolution rules $\{\widehat{\phi}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$, such that Algorithm 2 can learn an $\epsilon$-team-optimal strategy of $\mathcal{L}$ with probability $1-\delta$, with the following time and sample complexities:

- **Examples 1, 3, 5, 6:** $\mathrm{poly}\Big(\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}(|\overline{\mathcal{O}}_h||\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h|)^{C\gamma^{-4}\log(\frac{|\overline{\mathcal{S}}|}{\epsilon})}, |\overline{\mathcal{S}}|, \overline{H}, \frac{1}{\epsilon}, \log(\frac{1}{\delta})\Big)$;
- **Examples 2, 4, 7, 8:** $\mathrm{poly}\Big(\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}(|\overline{\mathcal{O}}_h||\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h|)^{C\gamma^{-4}\log(\frac{|\overline{\mathcal{S}}|}{\epsilon})+2d}, |\overline{\mathcal{S}}|, \overline{H}, \frac{1}{\epsilon}, \log(\frac{1}{\delta})\Big)$.

*Proof.* We divide the proof into the following three **Parts**.

**Part I:** Given any LTC problem $\mathcal{L}$ satisfying the assumptions in the theorem, we can construct a $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ by conducting the reformulation, strict expansion, and refinement for $\mathcal{L}$. According to Theorem IV.6, we know that $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ has SI-CIBs with respect to the strategy space $\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}$.

**Part II:** Given any LTC problem $\mathcal{L}$, we can apply Algorithm 2 for learning in such a problem. For any $j \in [K]$, let $\overline{g}^{j,*}_{1:\overline{H}}$ be the output of Algorithm 6 (Line 11 in Algorithm 2), we can guarantee that $J_{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{g}^{j,*}_{1:\overline{H}}) \geq \max_{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} J_{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}) - 2\overline{H}\epsilon_r(\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j})) - \overline{H}^2\epsilon_z(\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j}))$ according to the result of **Part II** of the proof of Theorem C.12. Meanwhile, let $\widehat{j}$ be the index of the strategy selected by Algorithm Pos-Dec (Line 13), such that $\overline{g}^{\widehat{j},*}_{1:\overline{H}}$ is the output of Pos-Dec. Then, we can adapt [14, Lemma 21] to the team setting and guarantee that

$$\max_{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} J_{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}) - J_{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{g}^{\widehat{j},*}_{1:\overline{H}}) \leq \min_{j \in [K]} \left( \max_{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} J_{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}) - J_{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{g}^{j,*}_{1:\overline{H}}) \right) + \frac{\epsilon}{2}$$

with probability $1 - \delta_3 \geq 1 - \delta$. Combining these two results, we can guarantee that $\max_{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} J_{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}) - J_{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{g}^{\widehat{j},*}_{1:\overline{H}}) \leq \epsilon_0$ with probability $1 - \delta$. Also, together with Proposition IV.1 and Theorem IV.4, with probability $1 - \delta$, we conclude that the output of Algorithm 2 is an $\epsilon_0$-team-optimal strategy of $\mathcal{L}$.

Meanwhile, we analyze the sample and time complexities of Algorithm 2. For Algorithm BaSeCAMP (Line 8), from [14, Lemma 19], it has time and sample complexities $(\max_{h \in [\overline{H}]} |\overline{\mathcal{O}}_h||\overline{\mathcal{A}_h}|)^{\widehat{L}} \log(\frac{1}{\delta_2})$; for Algorithm LEE (Line 10), it has sample complexity $\overline{H}N_0$ and time complexity $\mathtt{poly}(\max_{h \in [\overline{H}]} |\widehat{\mathcal{C}}_h|, \max_{h \in [\overline{H}]} |\overline{\mathcal{P}}_h|, \max_{h \in [\overline{H}]} |\overline{\mathcal{O}}_h|, \max_{h \in [\overline{H}]} |\Gamma_h|, \max_{h \in [\overline{H}]} |\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_h|, \max_{h \in [\overline{H}]} |\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h|)$; for Algorithm Pos-Dec (Line 13), it has sample and time complexities $KN_2$; for Algorithm 6 (Line 11), as long as the models $\{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j})\}_{j \in [K]}$ satisfy Assumption IV.7, it has time complexity $\max_{h \in [\overline{H}]} |\widehat{\mathcal{C}}_h| \cdot \mathtt{poly}(|\overline{\mathcal{S}}|, \max_{h \in [\overline{H}]} |\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h|, \max_{h \in [\overline{H}]} \|\overline{\mathcal{P}}_h|, \overline{H})$. Therefore, Algorithm 2 has time and sample complexities polynomial in the parameters of $\{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j})\}_{j \in [K]}$.

**Part III:** If the baseline sharing of $\mathcal{L}$ is one of the examples in §A, we can construct the compressed common information with length $L \geq 2C \frac{\log(\overline{H}|\overline{\mathcal{S}}| \max_{h \in [\overline{H}]} |\overline{\mathcal{O}}_h| / (\epsilon_1 \gamma))}{\gamma^4}$ as follows, where $\gamma$ is the constant in Assumption III.1 and $\epsilon_1$ is defined in Algorithm 2.

- **Examples 1, 5, 6:** For any $t \in [H]$, $\widehat{c}_{2t-1} = \{\overline{o}_{2t-L:2t-2}, \overline{a}_{2t-1-L:2t-2}\}, \widehat{c}_{2t} = \{\overline{o}_{2t-L:2t-2}, \overline{a}_{2t-L-1:2t-1}, \overline{o}_{N,2t-1}\}$ with $N \subseteq [n]$. Here $\widehat{L} = L$.
- **Example 3:** For any $t \in [H], \widehat{c}_{2t-1} = \{\overline{o}_{1,2t-L:2t-2}, \overline{a}_{2t-L-1:2t-2}, \overline{o}_{1,2t-1}\}, \widehat{c}_{2t} = \{\overline{o}_{2t-L:2t-2}, \overline{a}_{2t-L-1:2t-1}, \overline{o}_{N,2t-1}\}$ with $N \subseteq [n]$ and $1 \in N$. Here $\widehat{L} = L$.
- **Examples 2, 7, 8:** For any $h \in [\overline{H}], \widehat{c}_h := \{\overline{o}_{h-2d-L+1:h-2d}, \overline{o}_{1,h-2d+1:h}, \overline{a}_{1,h-2d-L:h-1}, \{\overline{a}_{-1,2t-1}\}_{t=\lfloor \frac{h-2d+1}{2} \rfloor}^{\lfloor \frac{h}{2} \rfloor}, \overline{o}_M\}$ with $M \subseteq \{(i,t) | 1 < i \leq n, h-2d+1 \leq t \leq h\}$, and recall that $\overline{o}_M = \{o_{i,t} | (i,t) \in M\}$. Here $\widehat{L} = L + 2d$.
- **Example 4:** For any $h \in [\overline{H}], \widehat{c}_h := \{\overline{o}_{h-L-2d+1:h-2d}, \{\overline{a}_{2t-1}\}_{t=\lfloor \frac{h-2d+1}{2} \rfloor}^{\lfloor \frac{h}{2} \rfloor}, \overline{o}_M\}$ with $M \subseteq \{(i,t) | 1 \leq i \leq n, h-2d+1 \leq t \leq h\}$, and recall that $\overline{o}_M = \{o_{i,t} | (i,t) \in M\}$. Here $\widehat{L} = L + 2d$.

The compression functions $\{\text{Compress}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$ and evolution rules $\{\widehat{\phi}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$ of the compressed common information can be constructed correspondingly.

Meanwhile, we can slightly change Theorem 8 in [14] to obtain that, for any $j\in[K]$, Algorithm LEE (Line 10 in Algorithm 2) can guarantee that the output $\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j})$ has an approximation error as

$$\forall \overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}, |V_0^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\emptyset)-V_0^{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}},\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j})}(\emptyset)|\le \overline{H}\epsilon_r(\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j}))+\frac{1}{2}\overline{H}^2\epsilon_z(\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j}))+\epsilon^j_{apx} \tag{C.21}$$

with probability $1-\delta_1$, with

$$\epsilon^j_{apx}:=\theta_1+2\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}|\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h|\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}|\overline{\mathcal{P}}_h|\frac{\zeta_1}{\zeta_2}+\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}|\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h|\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}|\overline{\mathcal{P}}_h|\theta_2+\frac{\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}|\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h|^{2\widehat{L}}\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}|\overline{\mathcal{O}}_h|^{\widehat{L}}}{\phi}$$
$$+\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}\max_{\overline{g}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}}\mathbb{1}[h>\widehat{L}]\cdot 2\cdot d^{\overline{g},\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\mathcal{S},h-\widehat{L}}(\mathcal{U}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\phi,h-\widehat{L}}(g^{h,j})),$$

where for any $g\in\mathcal{G}_{1:\overline{H}},h\in[\overline{H}]$, we define $d^{g,\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\mathcal{S},h}(\overline{s}):=\mathbb{P}^{g,\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_h(\overline{s}_h=\overline{s})$, and for any set $X\subseteq\overline{\mathcal{S}}, d^{g,\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\mathcal{S},h}(X)=\sum_{\overline{s}\in X}d^{g,\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\mathcal{S},h}(\overline{s}), \mathcal{U}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\phi,h}(g):=\{\overline{s}\in\overline{\mathcal{S}}\,|\,d^{g,\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\mathcal{S},h}(\overline{s})<\phi\}$. Note that $\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}$ here is the expected approximate common-information model with components $\{\widehat{c}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]},\{\widehat{\phi}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]},\Gamma$, and $\forall j\in[K],\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j})$ are as defined in Definition C.10. Under the parameters specified in Line 6 in Algorithm 2, we have

$$\epsilon^j_{apx}\le 4\epsilon_1+\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}\max_{\overline{g}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}}\mathbb{1}[h>\widehat{L}]\cdot 2\cdot d^{\overline{g},\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\mathcal{S},h-\widehat{L}}(\mathcal{U}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\phi,h-\widehat{L}}(g^{h,j})).$$

Also, we can prove the following lemma.

**Lemma C.18.** Given any $\widehat{L}>0$ and parameters $K,\alpha,\beta,\epsilon_1,N_0,N_1,O,S$ specified in Algorithm 2, and let $\{g^{1:\overline{H},j}\}_{j\in[K]}$ be the output of the algorithm BaSeCAMP$(\widehat{L},N_0,N_1,\alpha,\beta,K)$ (Line 8 in Algorithm 2). As long as $\widehat{L}\ge C\frac{\log(\overline{H}SO/(\epsilon_1\gamma))}{\gamma^4}$, where $C$ is a large enough constant as chosen in [14, Theorem 8], then with probability at least $1-\delta_2$, there exists at least one $j^*\in[K]$ such that for any strategy $\overline{g}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}},g\in\mathcal{G}_{1:\overline{H}},h\in[\overline{H}],N\subseteq[n]$

$$\mathbb{E}_{\overline{g}}\|\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_h(\overline{o}_{1:h},\overline{a}_{1:h-1})-\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}^g_h(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h},\overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-1})\|_1\le\epsilon_1+\mathbb{1}[h>\widehat{L}]\cdot 6\cdot d^{\overline{g},\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\mathcal{S},h-\widehat{L}}(\mathcal{U}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\phi,h-\widehat{L}}(g))$$
$$\mathbb{E}_{\overline{g}}\|\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_h(\overline{o}_{1:h-1},\overline{a}_{1:h-1})-\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}^g_h(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h-1},\overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-1})\|_1\le\epsilon_1+\mathbb{1}[h>\widehat{L}]\cdot 6\cdot d^{\overline{g},\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\mathcal{S},h-\widehat{L}}(\mathcal{U}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\phi,h-\widehat{L}}(g))$$
$$\mathbb{E}_{\overline{g}}\|\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_h(\overline{o}_{1:h-1},\overline{a}_{1:h-1},\overline{o}_{N,h})-\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}^g_h(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h-1},\overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-1},\overline{o}_{N,h})\|_1\le\epsilon_1+\mathbb{1}[h>\widehat{L}]\cdot 6\cdot d^{\overline{g},\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\mathcal{S},h-\widehat{L}}(\mathcal{U}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\phi,h-\widehat{L}}(g)),$$
$$d^{\overline{g},\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\mathcal{S},h-\widehat{L}}(\mathcal{U}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\phi,h-\widehat{L}}(g^{h,j^*}))<\epsilon_1,$$

where $\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}^g_h(\cdot):=\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}^{apx,\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_h(\cdot,d^{g,\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\mathcal{S},h-\widehat{L}})$, and $\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}^{apx,\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_h$ is defined as follows: $\forall D\in\Delta(\overline{\mathcal{S}}),N\subseteq[n]$

$$\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}^{apx,\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_h(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h-1},\overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-1},D)=\mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_h=\cdot\,|\,\overline{s}_{h-\widehat{L}}\sim D,\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h-1},\overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-1})$$
$$\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}^{apx,\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_h(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h},\overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-1},D)=\mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_h=\cdot\,|\,\overline{s}_{h-\widehat{L}}\sim D,\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h},\overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-1})$$
$$\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}^{apx,\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_h(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h-1},\overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-1},\overline{o}_{N,h},D)=\mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_h=\cdot\,|\,\overline{s}_{h-\widehat{L}}\sim D,\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h-1},\overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-1},\overline{o}_{N,h}).$$

*Proof.* We can adapt Lemma 18 and Lemma 19 in [14] to our setting. Note that $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ only has

$\gamma$-observability at odd timesteps $h = 2t-1, t \in [H]$. Therefore, it holds that $\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h+1}(\overline{o}_{1:h+1}, \overline{a}_{1:h}) = \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_h(\overline{o}_{1:h}, \overline{a}_{1:h-1})$ and $\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}^g_{h+1}(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h+1}, \overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h}) = \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}^g_h(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h}, \overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-1})$, since the communication action at timestep $h = 2t-1$ (i.e., $\overline{a}_h = m_t$) does not affect the state, and $\overline{s}_{h+1} = \overline{s}_h, \overline{o}_{h+1} = \emptyset$. A similar relationship of the beliefs also holds for the other two types of beliefs. We can thus apply the corollary. □

Therefore, based on Lemma C.18, we have $\max_{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} J_{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}) - J_{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{g}^{j^*,*}_{1:\overline{H}}) \le 2\Big(\overline{H}\epsilon_r(\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*})) + \frac{1}{2}\overline{H}^2\epsilon_z(\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*})) + \frac{6\epsilon}{200(\overline{H}+1)^2}\Big)$, where $j^*$ is the $j$ selected in Lemma C.18, and $\overline{g}^{j^*,*}_{1:\overline{H}}$ is the strategy computed in the $j^*$-th iteration of Line 11 in Algorithm 2.

Now, we validate for each example in §A that, under the compressed common information, $\epsilon_r(\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*}))$ and $\epsilon_z(\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*}))$ in Equation (C.21) can be made small. Note that after reformulation, expansion, and refinement, **Examples 1** and **5** are the same, and **Examples 2** and **7** are the same. Therefore, all the examples in §A can be classified into the following 6 **Types**. Finally, from Lemma C.15, for any $h \in [\overline{H}]$, we have

$$|\mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}[\mathcal{R}_h(\overline{s}_h, \overline{a}_h, \overline{p}_h)|\overline{c}_h, \gamma_h] - \widehat{\mathcal{R}}^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*})}_h(\widehat{c}_h, \gamma_h)| \le \|\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_h(\cdot,\cdot|\overline{c}_h) - \mathbb{P}^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*}),c}_h(\cdot,\cdot|\widehat{c}_h)\|_1 \tag{C.22}$$

$$\|\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_h(\cdot|\overline{c}_h, \gamma_h) - \mathbb{P}^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*}),z}_h(\cdot|\widehat{c}_h, \gamma_h)\|_1 \le \|\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_h(\cdot,\cdot|\overline{c}_h) - \mathbb{P}^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*}),c}_h(\cdot,\cdot|\widehat{c}_h)\|_1. \tag{C.23}$$

**Type 1:** The baseline sharing is either **Example 1** or **Example 5**. Consider any $h \in [\overline{H}]$. If $h = 2t-1, t \in [H]$, it holds that

$$\mathbb{P}^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*}),c}_h(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h|\widehat{c}_h) = \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}^{g^{h,j^*}}_h(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h-1}, \overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-1})(\overline{s}_h)\overline{\mathbb{O}}_h(\overline{o}_h|\overline{s}_h),$$
$$\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_h(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h|\overline{c}_h) = \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_h(\overline{o}_{1:h-1}, \overline{a}_{1:h-1})(\overline{s}_h)\overline{\mathbb{O}}_h(\overline{o}_h|\overline{s}_h).$$

Then, from Lemma C.18 and Equation (C.22), we have

$$\max_{\overline{g}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h},\overline{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}} |\mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}[\mathcal{R}_h(\overline{s}_h, \overline{a}_h, \overline{p}_h)|\overline{c}_h, \gamma_h] - \widehat{\mathcal{R}}^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*})}_h(\widehat{c}_h, \gamma_h)|$$
$$\le \max_{\overline{g}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h-1},\overline{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}} \|\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_h(\overline{o}_{1:h-1}, \overline{a}_{1:h-1}) - \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}^{g^{h,j^*}}_h(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h-1}, \overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-1})\|_1 \le 7\epsilon_1.$$

Similarly, $\max_{\overline{g}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h},\overline{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}} \|\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_h(\cdot|\overline{c}_h, \gamma_h) - \mathbb{P}^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*}),z}_h(\cdot|\widehat{c}_h, \gamma_h)\|_1 \le 7\epsilon_1$.

If $h = 2t, t \in [H]$, then it holds that

$$\mathbb{P}^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*}),c}_h(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h|\widehat{c}_h) = \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}^{g^{h,j^*}}_{h-1}(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h-2}, \overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-2}, \overline{o}_{N,h-1})(\overline{s}_h)\mathbb{P}_{h-1}(\overline{o}_{-N,h-1}|\overline{s}_{h-1}, \overline{o}_{N,h-1})$$
$$\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_h(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h|\overline{c}_h) = \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-1}(\overline{o}_{1:h-2}, \overline{a}_{1:h-2}, \overline{o}_{N,h-1})(\overline{s}_h)\mathbb{P}_{h-1}(\overline{o}_{-N,h-1}|\overline{s}_{h-1}, \overline{o}_{N,h-1}).$$

Note that we use the belief at timestep $h-1$ since $\overline{s}_h = \overline{s}_h$, and it holds that $\overline{p}_h = \overline{o}_{N,h}$, where $N \subseteq [n]$ can be inferred by $\overline{a}_{h-1}$, which lies in $\widehat{c}_h$ and $\overline{c}_h$. Then, from Lemma C.18 and Equation (C.22), we have

$$\max_{\overline{g}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h},\overline{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}} |\mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}[\mathcal{R}_h(\overline{s}_h, \overline{a}_h, \overline{p}_h)|\overline{c}_h, \gamma_h] - \widehat{\mathcal{R}}^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*})}_h(\widehat{c}_h, \gamma_h)|$$
$$\le \max_{\overline{g}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h-1},\overline{a}_{1:h-2}\sim\overline{g}} \|\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-1}(\overline{o}_{1:h-2}, \overline{a}_{1:h-2}, \overline{o}_{N,h-1}) - \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}^{g^{h,j^*}}_{h-1}(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h-2}, \overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-2}, \overline{o}_{N,h-1})\|_1 \le 7\epsilon_1.$$

Similarly, $\max_{\overline{g}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h},\overline{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}} \|\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\cdot|\overline{c}_h,\gamma_h) - \mathbb{P}_h^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*}),z}(\cdot|\widehat{c}_h,\gamma_h)\|_1 \le 7\epsilon_1$.

**Type 2:** The baseline sharing is **Example 3**. For any $h\in[\overline{H}]$, if $h=2t-1$ with $t\in[H]$,

$$\mathbb{P}_h^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*}),c}(\overline{s}_h,\overline{p}_h|\widehat{c}_h) = \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_h^{g^{h,j^*}}(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h-1},\overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-1},\overline{o}_{1,h})(\overline{s}_h)\mathbb{P}_{2t-1}(\overline{o}_{-1,2t}|\overline{s}_{2t-1},\overline{o}_{1,2t-1})$$
$$\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h,\overline{p}_h|\overline{c}_h) = \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_h(\overline{o}_{1:h-1},\overline{a}_{1:h-1},\overline{o}_{1,h})(\overline{s}_h)\mathbb{P}_{2t-1}(\overline{o}_{-1,2t}|\overline{s}_{2t-1},\overline{o}_{1,2t-1}).$$

Then, from Lemma C.18 and Equation (C.22), we have

$$\max_{\overline{g}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h},\overline{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}} |\mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}[\mathcal{R}_h(\overline{s}_h,\overline{a}_h,\overline{p}_h)|\overline{c}_h,\gamma_h] - \widehat{\mathcal{R}}_h^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*})}(\widehat{c}_h,\gamma_h)|$$
$$\le \max_{\overline{g}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h},\overline{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}} \|\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_h(\overline{o}_{1:h-1},\overline{a}_{1:h-1},\overline{o}_{1,h}) - \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_h^{g^{h,j^*}}(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h-1},\overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-1},,\overline{o}_{1,h})\|_1 \le 7\epsilon_1.$$

Similarly, $\max_{\overline{g}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h},\overline{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}} \|\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\cdot|\overline{c}_h,\gamma_h) - \mathbb{P}_h^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*}),z}(\cdot|\widehat{c}_h,\gamma_h)\|_1 \le 7\epsilon_1$.

If $h=2t$ with $t\in[H]$, then it holds that

$$\mathbb{P}_h^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*}),c}(\overline{s}_h,\overline{p}_h|\widehat{c}_h) = \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-1}^{g^{h,j^*}}(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h-2},\overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-2},\overline{o}_{N,h-1})(\overline{s}_h)\mathbb{P}_{h-1}(\overline{o}_{-N,h-1}|\overline{s}_{h-1},\overline{o}_{N,h-1})$$
$$\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h,\overline{p}_h|\overline{c}_h) = \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-1}(\overline{o}_{1:h-2},\overline{a}_{1:h-2},\overline{o}_{N,h-1})(\overline{s}_h)\mathbb{P}_{h-1}(\overline{o}_{-N,h-1}|\overline{s}_{h-1},\overline{o}_{N,h-1}).$$

Note that we use the belief at timestep $h-1$ since $\overline{s}_h=\overline{s}_h$, and it holds that $1\in N$, and $N$ can be inferred by $\overline{a}_{h-1}$, which lies in $\widehat{c}_h$ and $\overline{c}_h$. Then, from Lemma C.18 and Equation (C.22), we have

$$\max_{\overline{g}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h},\overline{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}} |\mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}[\mathcal{R}_h(\overline{s}_h,\overline{a}_h,\overline{p}_h)|\overline{c}_h,\gamma_h] - \widehat{\mathcal{R}}_h^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*})}(\widehat{c}_h,\gamma_h)|$$
$$\le \max_{\overline{g}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h-1},\overline{a}_{1:h-2}\sim\overline{g}} \|\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-1}(\overline{o}_{1:h-2},\overline{a}_{1:h-2},\overline{o}_{N,h-1}) - \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-1}^{g^{h,j^*}}(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h-2},\overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-2},\overline{o}_{N,h-1})\|_1 \le 7\epsilon_1.$$

Similarly, $\max_{\overline{g}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h},\overline{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}} \|\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\cdot|\overline{c}_h,\gamma_h) - \mathbb{P}_h^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*}),z}(\cdot|\widehat{c}_h,\gamma_h)\|_1 \le 7\epsilon_1$.

**Type 3:** The baseline sharing is either **Example 2** or **Example 7**. For any $h\in[\overline{H}]$,

$$\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h,\overline{p}_h|\overline{c}_h) = \sum_{\overline{s}_{h-2d}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h,\overline{p}_h|\overline{s}_{h-2d},f_a,f_o) F^{P_h(\cdot|\cdot,f_a)}(\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{1:h-2d},\overline{a}_{1:h-2d-1});f_o)(\overline{s}_{h-2d}),$$
$$\mathbb{P}_h^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*}),c}(\overline{s}_h,\overline{p}_h|\widehat{c}_h) = \sum_{\overline{s}_{h-2d}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h,\overline{p}_h|\overline{s}_{h-2d},f_a,f_o) F^{P_h(\cdot|\cdot,f_a)}(\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-2d}^{g^{h,j^*}}(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h-2d},\overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-2d-1});f_o)(\overline{s}_{h-2d}),$$

where $f_{\tau,h-2d} = \{\overline{o}_{1:h-2d},\overline{a}_{1,1:h-2d-1},\{\overline{a}_{-1,2t-1}\}_{t=1}^{\lfloor\frac{h-2d}{2}\rfloor}\}, f_a = \{\overline{a}_{1,h-2d:h-1},\{\overline{a}_{-1,2t-1}\}_{t=1\lfloor\frac{h-2d+1}{2}\rfloor}^{\frac{h}{2}}\}, f_o = \{\overline{o}_{1,h-2d+1:h},\overline{o}_M\}, F^{P_h(\cdot|\cdot,f_a)}(\cdot;f_o) : \Delta(\mathcal{S}) \to \Delta(\mathcal{S})$ is the posterior belief update function (as introduced in **Type 3** in the proof of Theorem C.12). Then, from Lemma C.18 and Equation (C.22), we

have

$$\begin{aligned}
&\max_{\overline{g}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h},\overline{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}} |\mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}[\mathcal{R}_h(\overline{s}_h,\overline{a}_h,\overline{p}_h)|\overline{c}_h,\gamma_h] - \widehat{\mathcal{R}}_h^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*})}(\widehat{c}_h,\gamma_h)| \\
&\quad\le \max_{\overline{g}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h},\overline{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}} \Big\| \sum_{\overline{s}_{h-2d}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h,\overline{p}_h|\overline{s}_{h-2d},f_a,f_o) F^{P_h(\cdot|\cdot,f_a)}(\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{1:h-2d},\overline{a}_{1:h-2d-1});f_o) \\
&\qquad - \sum_{\overline{s}_{h-2d}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h,\overline{p}_h|\overline{s}_{h-2d},f_a,f_o) F^{P_h(\cdot|\cdot,f_a)}(\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}^{g^{h,j^*}}_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-2d},\overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-2d-1});f_o)(\overline{s}_{h-2d}) \Big\|_1 \\
&\quad\le \max_{\overline{g}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h},\overline{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}} \|\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{1:h-2d},\overline{a}_{1:h-1-2d}) - \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}^{g^{h,j^*}}_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h-2d},\overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-2d-1})\|_1 \le 7\epsilon_1.
\end{aligned}$$

Similarly, $\max_{\overline{g}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h},\overline{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}} \|\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\cdot|\overline{c}_h,\gamma_h) - \mathbb{P}_h^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*}),z}(\cdot|\widehat{c}_h,\gamma_h)\|_1 \le 7\epsilon_1$.

**Type 4:** The baseline sharing is **Example 4**. For any $h\in[\overline{H}]$,

$$\begin{aligned}
&\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h,\overline{p}_h|\overline{c}_h) = \sum_{\overline{s}_{h-2d}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h,\overline{p}_h|\overline{s}_{h-2d},f_o) F^{P_h(\cdot|\cdot)}(\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{1:h-2d},\overline{a}_{1:h-2d-1});f_o)(\overline{s}_{h-2d}), \\
&\mathbb{P}_h^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*}),c}(\overline{s}_h,\overline{p}_h|\widehat{c}_h) = \sum_{\overline{s}_{h-2d}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h,\overline{p}_h|\overline{s}_{h-2d},f_o) F^{P_h(\cdot|\cdot)}(\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}^{g^{h,j^*}}_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h-2d},\overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-2d-1});f_o)(\overline{s}_{h-2d}),
\end{aligned}$$

where $f_{\tau,h-2d} = \{\overline{o}_{1:h-2d},\{\overline{a}_{2t-1}\}_{t=1}^{\lfloor\frac{h}{2}\rfloor}\}$, $f_o = \{\overline{o}_M\}$, $F^{P_h(\cdot|\cdot)}(\cdot;f_o):\Delta(\mathcal{S})\to\Delta(\mathcal{S})$ is the posterior belief update function (as introduced in **Type 4** in the proof of Theorem C.12)). Recall that $M\subseteq\{(i,t)|i\in[n],h-2d+1\le t\le h\}$. Then, from Lemma C.18 and Equation (C.22), we have

$$\begin{aligned}
&\max_{\overline{g}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h},\overline{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}} |\mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}[\mathcal{R}_h(\overline{s}_h,\overline{a}_h,\overline{p}_h)|\overline{c}_h,\gamma_h] - \widehat{\mathcal{R}}_h^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*})}(\widehat{c}_h,\gamma_h)| \\
&\quad\le \max_{\overline{g}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h},\overline{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}} \Big\| \sum_{\overline{s}_{h-2d}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h,\overline{p}_h|\overline{s}_{h-2d},f_a,f_o) F^{P_h(\cdot|\cdot)}(\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{1:h-2d},\overline{a}_{1:h-2d-1});f_o) \\
&\qquad - \sum_{\overline{s}_{h-2d}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h,\overline{p}_h|\overline{s}_{h-2d},f_a,f_o) F^{P_h(\cdot|\cdot)}(\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}^{g^{h,j^*}}_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h-2d},\overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-2d-1});f_o)(\overline{s}_{h-2d}) \Big\|_1 \\
&\quad\le \max_{\overline{g}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h},\overline{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}} \|\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{1:h-2d},\overline{a}_{1:h-1-2d}) - \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}^{g^{h,j^*}}_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h-2d},\overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-2d-1})\|_1 \le 7\epsilon_1.
\end{aligned}$$

Similarly, $\max_{\overline{g}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h},\overline{a}_{1:h-1}\sim\overline{g}} \|\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\cdot|\overline{c}_h,\gamma_h) - \mathbb{P}_h^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*}),z}(\cdot|\widehat{c}_h,\gamma_h)\|_1 \le 7\epsilon_1$.

**Type 5:** The baseline sharing is **Example 6**. Consider any $h\in[\overline{H}]$. If $h=2t-1, t\in[H]$, it holds that

$$\begin{aligned}
&\mathbb{P}_h^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*}),c}(\overline{s}_h,\overline{p}_h|\widehat{c}_h) = \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_h^{g^{h,j^*}}(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h-1},\overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-1})(\overline{s}_h)\overline{\mathbb{O}}_h(\overline{o}_h|\overline{s_h})\Psi_h^1(\overline{p}_h,\widehat{c_h}), \\
&\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h,\overline{p}_h|\overline{c}_h) = \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_h(\overline{o}_{1:h-1},\overline{a}_{1:h-1})(\overline{s}_h)\overline{\mathbb{O}}_h(\overline{o}_h|\overline{s_h})\Psi_h^1(\overline{p}_h,\overline{c}_h);
\end{aligned}$$

if $h = 2t, t \in [H]$, then it holds that for any $t \in [H]$,

$$\mathbb{P}_h^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*}),c}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \widehat{c}_h) = \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-1}^{g^{h,j^*}}(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h-2}, \overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-2}, \overline{o}_{N,h-1})(\overline{s}_h)\mathbb{P}_{h-1}(\overline{o}_{-N,h-1} | \overline{s}_{h-1}, \overline{o}_{N,h-1})\Psi_h^1(\overline{p}_h, \widehat{c}_h)$$
$$\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_h) = \overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-1}(\overline{o}_{1:h-2}, \overline{a}_{1:h-2}, \overline{o}_{N,h-1})(\overline{s}_h)\mathbb{P}_{h-1}(\overline{o}_{-N,h-1} | \overline{s}_{h-1}, \overline{o}_{N,h-1})\Psi_h^1(\overline{p}_h, \overline{c}_h),$$

where we extend the definition of $\Psi_h^1$ in **Type 5** in the proof of Theorem C.12, by replacing the input $\widehat{c}_h$ therein by $\overline{c}_h, \forall h \in [\overline{H}]$. Then, similar to **Type 1**, we can verify that for any $h \in [\overline{H}]$

$$\max_{\overline{g} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h}, \overline{a}_{1:h-1} \sim \overline{g}} |\mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}[\mathcal{R}_h(\overline{s}_h, \overline{a}_h, \overline{p}_h) | \overline{c}_h, \gamma_h] - \widehat{\mathcal{R}}_h^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*})}(\widehat{c}_h, \gamma_h)| \le 7\epsilon_1$$
$$\max_{\overline{g} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h}, \overline{a}_{1:h-1} \sim \overline{g}} \|\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\cdot | \overline{c}_h, \gamma_h) - \mathbb{P}_h^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*}),z}(\cdot | \widehat{c}_h, \gamma_h)\|_1 \le 7\epsilon_1.$$

**Type 6:** The baseline sharing is **Example 8**. For any $h \in [\overline{H}]$,

$$\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | f_{\tau,h-2d}, f_a, f_o) = \sum_{\overline{s}_{h-2d}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{s}_{h-2d}, f_a, f_o) F^{P_h(\cdot|\cdot,f_a)}(\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-2d}(\overline{o}_{1:h-2d}, \overline{a}_{1:h-2d-1}); f_o)(\overline{s}_{h-2d})\Psi_h^2(\overline{p}_h, \overline{c}_h),$$

$$\mathbb{P}_h^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*}),c}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | f_{\tau,h-2d}, f_a, f_o)$$
$$= \sum_{\overline{s}_{h-2d}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{s}_{h-2d}, f_a, f_o) F^{P_h(\cdot|\cdot,f_a)}(\overline{\boldsymbol{b}}_{h-2d}^{g^{h,j^*}}(\overline{o}_{h-\widehat{L}+1:h-2d}, \overline{a}_{h-\widehat{L}:h-2d-1}); f_o)(\overline{s}_{h-2d})\Psi_h^2(\overline{p}_h, \widehat{c}_h),$$

where $f_a, f_o, f_{\tau,h-2d}, F^{P_h(\cdot|\cdot,f_a)}$ are defined in **Type 3**, and we extend the definition of $\Psi_h^2$ in **Type 6** of the proof of Theorem C.12, by replacing $\widehat{c}_h$ by $\overline{c}_h$ as input, $\forall h \in [\overline{H}]$. Then, similar to **Type 3**, we can verify that for any $h \in [\overline{H}]$

$$\max_{\overline{g} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h}, \overline{a}_{1:h-1} \sim \overline{g}} |\mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}[\mathcal{R}_h(\overline{s}_h, \overline{a}_h, \overline{p}_h) | \overline{c}_h, \gamma_h] - \widehat{\mathcal{R}}_h^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*})}(\widehat{c}_h, \gamma_h)| \le 7\epsilon_1$$
$$\max_{\overline{g} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}_{\overline{o}_{1:h}, \overline{a}_{1:h-1} \sim \overline{g}} \|\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\cdot | \overline{c}_h, \gamma_h) - \mathbb{P}_h^{\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*}),z}(\cdot | \widehat{c}_h, \gamma_h)\|_1 \le 7\epsilon_1.$$

Therefore, for any example in §A, with probability $1 - \delta_2$, we know that there exists some $j^* \in [K]$ such that

$$\epsilon_r(\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*})) \le 7\epsilon_1, \ \ \epsilon_z(\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j^*})) \le 7\epsilon_1, \ \ \epsilon_{apx}^{j^*} \le 4\epsilon_1 + \max_{h \in [\overline{H}]} \max_{\overline{g} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} \mathbb{1}[h > \widehat{L}] \cdot 2 \cdot d_{\mathcal{S},h-\widehat{L}}^{\overline{g},\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\mathcal{U}_{\phi,h-\widehat{L}}^{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(g^{h,j^*})) \le 6\epsilon_1.$$

Then, combined with the result in **Part II**, we have that with probability $1 - \delta_1 - \delta_2$, $\max_{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} J_{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}) - J_{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}^{j^*,*}) \le 2(\frac{7}{2}\overline{H}^2 + \overline{H} + 6)\epsilon_1$, which further leads to

$$\max_{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} J_{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}) - J_{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}^{\widehat{j},*}) \le \min_{j \in [K]} \left( \max_{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} J_{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}) - J_{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}^{j,*}) \right) + \frac{\epsilon}{2}$$
$$\le \max_{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} J_{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}) - J_{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}^{j^*,*}) + \frac{\epsilon}{2} \le \epsilon,$$

with probability $1 - \delta_1 - \delta_2 - \delta_3 \ge 1 - \delta$, with the choice of $\epsilon_1$ in Algorithm 2.

Finally, to apply the results in **Part II** above, it remains to examine the satisfaction of Assumption

IV.7 for the learned models $\{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j})\}_{j\in[K]}$. To this end, we will instantiate [14, Algorithm 5] (Line 10 in Algorithm 2) as follows:

- If $\mathcal{L}$ has a baseline sharing protocol as one of **Examples 1, 5, 6** with the additional condition 2) in §A, then we replace the Equation (B.1) of [14, Algorithm 5] by: for any $i \in [n]$

$$\begin{aligned}
&\text{if } h = 2t-1,\ \mathbb{P}_h^{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H}}),z}(\overline{z}_{i,h+1}\,|\widehat{c}_{i,h},\gamma_{i,h}) \leftarrow \sum_{\overline{p}_{i,h}} \mathbb{1}[\overline{z}_{i,h+1} = \overline{\chi}_{i,h+1}(\overline{p}_{i,h},\overline{\gamma}_{i,h},\overline{o}_{i,h+1} = \emptyset)]\mathbb{P}_h^{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H}})}(\overline{p}_{i,h}|\widehat{c}_{i,h}),\\
&\text{if } h = 2t,\ \mathbb{P}_h^{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H}}),z}(\overline{z}_{i,h+1}\,|\widehat{c}_{i,h},\gamma_{i,h}) \leftarrow \sum_{\overline{p}_{i,h},\overline{a}_{i,h},\overline{o}_{i,h+1}} \mathbb{1}[\overline{z}_{i,h+1} = \overline{\chi}_{i,h+1}(\overline{p}_{i,h},\overline{a}_{i,h},\overline{o}_{i,h+1})]\mathbb{P}_h^{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H}})}(\overline{p}_{i,h}|\widehat{c}_{i,h})\\
&\qquad\qquad \gamma_{i,h}(\overline{a}_{i,h}|\overline{p}_{i,h})\mathbb{P}_h^{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H}})}(\overline{o}_{i,h+1}\,|\widehat{c}_{i,h},\overline{p}_{i,h},\overline{a}_{i,h}),
\end{aligned} \tag{C.24}$$

  and replace Equation (B.2) of [14, Algorithm 5] by: for any $i \in [n]$

$$\begin{aligned}
&\text{if } h = 2t-1,\ \widehat{\mathcal{R}}_{i,h}^{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H}})}(\widehat{c}_{i,h},\gamma_{i,h}) \leftarrow \sum_{\overline{p}_{i,h}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H}})}(\overline{p}_{i,h}|\widehat{c}_{i,h})\widehat{\mathcal{R}}_{i,h}^{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H}})}(\widehat{c}_{i,h},\overline{p}_{i,h},\gamma_{i,h}),\\
&\text{if } h = 2t,\ \widehat{\mathcal{R}}_{i,h}^{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H}})}(\widehat{c}_{i,h},\gamma_{i,h}) \leftarrow \sum_{\overline{p}_{i,h},\overline{a}_{i,h}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H}})}(\overline{p}_{i,h}|\widehat{c}_{i,h})\widehat{\mathcal{R}}_{i,h}^{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H}})}(\widehat{c}_{i,h},\overline{p}_{i,h},\overline{a}_{i,h})\gamma_{i,h}(\overline{a}_{i,h}|\overline{p}_{i,h}),
\end{aligned} \tag{C.25}$$

  where $\{\overline{\chi}_{i,h}\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$ can be constructed based on $\{\chi_{i,t}\}_{t\in[H]}$ and $\{\phi_{i,t}\}_{t\in[H]}$ similarly as the proof of Theorem IV.6 as follows:

  $\forall \overline{p}_{i,h-1} \in \overline{\mathcal{P}}_{i,h-1}, \overline{a}_{i,h-1} \in \overline{\mathcal{A}}_{i,h-1}, \overline{o}_{i,h} \in \overline{\mathcal{O}}_{i,h}$, if $h$ is even, then $\overline{\chi}_{i,h}(\overline{p}_{i,h-1},\overline{a}_{i,h-1},\overline{o}_{i,h}) = \phi_{i,\frac{h}{2}}(\overline{p}_{i,h-1},\overline{a}_{i,h-1})$
  if $h$ is odd, then $\overline{\chi}_{i,h}(\overline{p}_{i,h-1},\overline{a}_{i,h-1},\overline{o}_{i,h}) = \chi_{i,\frac{h+1}{2}}(\overline{p}_{i,h-1},\overline{a}_{i,h-1},\overline{o}_{i,h}) \cup \varrho_{i,h}^1 \backslash \varrho_{i,h}^2$, where
  $\varrho_{i,h}^1 := \{\widetilde{a}_{i,h-1} \,|\, \forall \sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i,h-1}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{c}_h), \widetilde{a}_{i,h-1} \text{ influences } \widetilde{s}_h\} \backslash \chi_{i,\frac{h+1}{2}}(\overline{p}_{i,h-1},\overline{a}_{i,h-1},\overline{o}_{i,h})$ if $h > 1$, otherwise $\emptyset$.
  $\varrho_{i,h}^2 := \{\widetilde{a}_{i,h_0} \,|\, \forall h_0 < h-1, \sigma(\widetilde{a}_{i,h_0}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{c}_{h-1}), \widetilde{a}_{i,h_0} \text{ influences } \widetilde{s}_{h_0+1}\} \cap \chi_{i,\frac{h+1}{2}}(\overline{p}_{i,h-1},\overline{a}_{i,h-1},\overline{o}_{i,h})$.

- If $\mathcal{L}$ has a baseline sharing protocol as one of **Examples 2, 4, 7, 8**, or one of **Examples 1, 5, 6** with additional condition 1) in §A, then we replace Equation (B.1) of [14, Algorithm 5] by:

$$\begin{aligned}
&\text{if } h = 2t-1, \text{ we do not make any change,}\\
&\text{if } h = 2t,\ \mathbb{P}_h^{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H}}),z}(\overline{z}_{h+1}\,|\widehat{c}_h,\gamma_{ct(h),h}) \leftarrow \sum_{\overline{p}_h,\overline{a}_{ct(h),h},\overline{o}_{h+1}} \mathbb{1}[\overline{z}_{h+1} = \overline{\chi}_{h+1}(\overline{p}_{i,h},\overline{a}_{ct(h),h},\overline{o}_{h+1})]\mathbb{P}_h^{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H}})}(\overline{p}_h|\widehat{c}_h)\\
&\qquad\qquad \gamma_{ct(h),h}(\overline{a}_{ct(h),h}|\overline{p}_h)\mathbb{P}_h^{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H}})}(\overline{o}_{h+1}\,|\widehat{c}_h,\overline{p}_h,\overline{a}_{ct(h),h}),
\end{aligned} \tag{C.26}$$

  and replace Equation (B.2) of [14, Algorithm 5] by:

$$\begin{aligned}
&\text{if } h = 2t-1, \text{ we do not make any change,}\\
&\text{if } h = 2t,\ \widehat{\mathcal{R}}_{i,h}^{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H}})}(\widehat{c}_h,\gamma_{i,h}) \leftarrow \sum_{\overline{p}_h,\overline{a}_{i,h}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H}})}(\overline{p}_h|\widehat{c}_h)\widehat{\mathcal{R}}_{i,h}^{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H}})}(\widehat{c}_h,\overline{p}_h,\overline{a}_{i,h})\gamma_{i,h}(\overline{a}_{i,h}|\overline{p}_{i,h}).
\end{aligned} \tag{C.27}$$

- If $\mathcal{L}$ has a baseline sharing protocol as **Example 3** or one of **Examples 1** and **5** with additional condition 3) in §A, then we do not make any change.

Then, the $\widehat{\mathcal{M}} = \{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j})\}_{j=1}^{K}$ learned in Line 10 in Algorithm 2 satisfies that: for any $j \in [K]$, $\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j})$ satisfies the **Factorized structures** condition in §G-B if the baseline sharing protocol of $\mathcal{L}$ is one of **Examples 1, 5, 6** with additional condition 2); $\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j})$ satisfies the **Turn-based structures** condition in §G-B, if the baseline sharing protocol of $\mathcal{L}$ is one of **Examples 2, 4, 7, 8** or **Examples 1, 5, 6** with additional condition 1); $\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j})$ satisfies the **Nested private information** condition in §G-B, if the baseline sharing protocol of $\mathcal{L}$ is **Example 3** or **Examples 1, 5** with additional condition 3). From Lemma G.2, we can conclude that Assumption IV.7 holds, by noticing that in these examples, $\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}|\overline{\mathcal{P}}_h|$ depends polynomially on the parameters of the original LTC problem $\mathcal{L}$. Hence, Algorithm 2 has the following sample and time complexities

- **Examples 1, 3, 5, 6:** $\mathtt{poly}\left(\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}(|\overline{\mathcal{O}}_h||\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h|)^{C\gamma^{-4}\log(\frac{|\overline{\mathcal{S}}|}{\epsilon})}, |\overline{\mathcal{S}}|, \overline{H}, \frac{1}{\epsilon}, \log(\frac{1}{\delta})\right)$;
- **Examples 2, 4, 7, 8:** $\mathtt{poly}\left(\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]}(|\overline{\mathcal{O}}_h||\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h|)^{C\gamma^{-4}\log(\frac{|\overline{\mathcal{S}}|}{\epsilon})+2d}, |\overline{\mathcal{S}}|, \overline{H}, \frac{1}{\epsilon}, \log(\frac{1}{\delta})\right)$,

to achieve $\max_{\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}\in\overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}} J_{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}) - J_{\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}}(\widehat{\overline{g}^{j,*}_{1:\overline{H}}}) \le \epsilon$ with probability at least $1-\delta$, which completes the proof of **Part III**. Combining **Parts I, II, III**, we complete the proof. □

# D. Deferred Details of §V

We first introduce the notion of *perfect recall* [26]:

**Definition D.1** (Perfect recall)**.** We say that agent $i$ has perfect recall if $\forall h = 2,\cdots,\overline{H}$, it holds that $\overline{\tau}_{i,h-1} \cup \{\overline{a}_{i,h-1}\} \subseteq \overline{\tau}_{i,h}$. If for any $i \in [n]$, agent $i$ has perfect recall, we call that the Dec-POMDP has a perfect recall property.

## D-A Proof of Theorem V.1

*Proof.* sQC ⇒ SI-CIB:
Let $\mathcal{D}$ be a Dec-POMDP with an sQC information structure that satisfies Assumptions II.1 (e), II.2, III.5, and III.7. To prove that $\mathcal{D}$ has SI-CIBs, it is sufficient to prove that for any $h = 2,\cdots,\overline{H}$, fix any $h_1 \in [h-1], i_1 \in [n]$, and for any $\overline{g}_{1:h-1} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:h-1}, \overline{g}'_{i_1,h_1} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{i_1,h_1}$, let $\overline{g}'_{h_1} := (\overline{g}_{1,h_1},\cdots,\overline{g}'_{i_1,h_1},\cdots,\overline{g}_{n,h_1})$ and $\overline{g}'_{1:h-1} := (\overline{g}_1,\cdots,\overline{g}'_{h_1},\cdots,\overline{g}_{h-1})$, for any $\overline{c}_h \in \overline{\mathcal{C}}_h$ reachable under both $\overline{g}_{1:h-1}, \overline{g}'_{1:h-1}$, the following holds:

$$\mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}_{1:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}'_{1:h-1}), \tag{D.1}$$

where, for notational simplicity, we omit both the superscript $\mathcal{D}$ and the subscript $h$ for the beliefs throughout this proof, as they are clear from the context. We prove this case by case as follows:

- If there exists some $i_2 \neq i_1$ such that $\sigma(\overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \cup \sigma(\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h})$, then from Assumption II.2, we know that $\sigma(\overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \cup \sigma(\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\overline{c}_h)$. Therefore, there exist deterministic measurable functions $\beta_1, \beta_2$ such that $\overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} = \beta_1(\overline{c}_h), \overline{a}_{i_1,h_1} = \beta_2(\overline{c}_h)$, and it holds that

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}_{1:h-1}) &= \mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \beta_1(\overline{c}_h), \beta_2(\overline{c}_h), \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}_{1:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}, \overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}, \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}'_{1:h-1}) \\ &= \mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}'_{1:h-1}).\end{aligned}$$

  The last equality is because the input and output of $\overline{g}_{i_1,h_1}$ (and $\overline{g}'_{i_1,h_1}$) are $\overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}$ and $\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}$, respectively, and they are both conditioned on.

- If for all $i_2 \neq i_1$, either $\sigma(\overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \nsubseteq \sigma(\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h})$ or $\sigma(\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \nsubseteq \sigma(\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h})$, then agent $(i_1,h_1)$ does not influence agent $(i_2,h)$ for any $i_2 \neq i_1$, since $\mathcal{D}$ is sQC.

  Firstly, we claim that agent $(i_1,h_1)$ does not influence $\overline{s}_{h_1+1}$: if it influences, from Assumption III.7, there exists some $i_3 \neq i_1$ such that agent $(i_1,h_1)$ influences $\overline{o}_{i_3,h_1+1}$; however, from Assumption II.1 (e), we know that $\overline{o}_{i_3,h_1+1} \in \overline{\tau}_{i_3,h_1+1} \subseteq \overline{\tau}_{i_3,h}$; therefore, agent $(i_1,h_1)$ influences agent $(i_3,h)$, contradicting the premise above. Similarly, we have that agent $(i_1,h_1)$ does not influence $\overline{s}_{h_2}$ for any $h_2 > h_1$.

  Secondly, we claim that agent $(i_1,h_1)$ does not influence $\overline{\tau}_{i_3,h_2}$, for any $i_3 \in [n]$ and $h_2 > h_1$. Since agent $(i_1,h_1)$ does not influence $\overline{s}_{h_1+1}$, then by Assumption III.5, for any $h_2 > h_1$, $\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1} \notin \overline{\tau}_{h_2}$ and agent $(i_1,h_1)$ does not influence $\overline{o}_{i_3,h_1+1}$ for any $i_3 \in [n]$, which implies that agent $(i_1,h_1)$ does not influence any element in $\overline{\tau}_{i_3,h_1+1}$ for any $i_3 \in [n]$, either directly or indirectly. Since $\overline{\tau}_{i_3,h_1+1}$ is the input of agent $i_3$'s strategy at timestep $h_1+1$ to decide $\overline{a}_{i_3,h_1+1}$, agent $(i_1,h_1)$ thus does not influence $\overline{a}_{i_3,h_1+1}$ for any $i_3 \in [n]$, either, which, together with the fact that it does not influence $\overline{s}_{h_1+2}$ and thus not $\overline{o}_{i_3,h_1+2}$ for any $i_3 \in [n]$, further implies that it does not influence any element in $\overline{\tau}_{i_3,h_1+2}$ for any $i_3 \in [n]$. By recursion, agent $(i_1,h_1)$ does not influence $\overline{\tau}_{i_3,h_2}$ for any $i_3 \in [n]$ and $h_2 > h_1$.

  Therefore, agent $(i_1,h_1)$ does not influence $\overline{c}_h = \cap_{i_3=1}^n \overline{\tau}_{i_3,h}$ (due to Assumption II.1) nor $\overline{p}_h = \overline{\tau}_h \backslash \overline{c}_h$, and it does not influence $\overline{s}_h$, either, which means that

$$\mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}_{1:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}'_{1:h-1}).$$

SI-CIB $\Rightarrow$ sQC:
Since $\mathcal{D}$ has perfect recall and has SI-CIBs, we know that $\forall i \in [n], h \in [\overline{H}], \forall \overline{g}_{1:h-1}, \overline{g}'_{1:h-1} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:h-1}, \overline{c}_h \in \overline{\mathcal{C}}_h, \overline{s}_h \in \overline{\mathcal{S}}, \overline{p}_h \in \overline{\mathcal{P}}_h$, if $\overline{c}_h$ is reachable under both $\overline{g}_{1:h-1}, \overline{g}'_{1:h-1}$, then the following holds:

$$\mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}_{1:h-1}) = \mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h | \overline{c}_h, \overline{g}'_{1:h-1}).$$

Our goal is to prove that if agent $(i_1,h_1)$ influences agent $(i_2,h_2)$ in the intrinsic model of the Dec-POMDP $\mathcal{D}$, then under any strategy $\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:\overline{H}}$, $\sigma(\overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \cup \sigma(\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$ holds. Note that throughout the proof, when it comes to $\sigma$-algebra inclusion, we meant it up to the null sets generated by $\overline{g}_{1:\overline{H}}$. We prove this by contradiction. If this is not true, then there exist $i_1, i_2 \in [n], h_1, h_2 \in [\overline{H}]$, such that agent $(i_1,h_1)$ influences agent $(i_2,h_2)$, but either $\sigma(\overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \nsubseteq \sigma(\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$ or $\sigma(\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \nsubseteq \sigma(\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$. First, we know that $i_2 \neq i_1$, since otherwise it always holds that $\overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} \subseteq \overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_2}$ and $\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1} \in \overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_2}$, due to the perfect recall assumption. Then, we discuss the following different cases.

- If $\sigma(\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \nsubseteq \sigma(\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$, then it implies that $\sigma(\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \nsubseteq \sigma(\overline{c}_{h_2})$ and $\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1} \notin \overline{c}_{h_2}$, since $\overline{c}_{h_2} \subseteq \overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}$. This further implies that there must exist a strategy $\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}$ and some realizations $\overline{c}_{h_2} \in \overline{\mathcal{C}}_{h_2}, \overline{a}_{i_1,h_1} \neq \overline{a}'_{i_1,h_1} \in \overline{\mathcal{A}}_{i_1,h_1}$ such that $\mathbb{P}(\overline{c}_{h_2} | \overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}) > 0, \mathbb{P}(\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1} | \overline{c}_{h_2}, \overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}) > 0$, and $\mathbb{P}(\overline{a}'_{i_1,h_1} | \overline{c}_{h_2}, \overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}) > 0$. Hence, due to perfect recall, there must exist some realizations $\overline{p}_{h_2} \in \overline{\mathcal{P}}_{h_2}, \overline{s}_{h_2} \in \overline{\mathcal{S}}$ such that $\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1} \in \overline{p}_{h_2}$, and $\mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_{h_2}, \overline{p}_{h_2} | \overline{c}_{h_2}, \overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}) > 0$. Then, we define another strategy $\overline{g}'_{i_1,h_1}$ as:

$$\forall \overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} \in \overline{\mathcal{T}}_{i_1,h_1}, \quad \overline{g}'_{i_1,h_1}(\overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) = \overline{a}'_{i_1,h_1}, \tag{D.2}$$

  and we let $\overline{g}'_{h_1} := (\overline{g}_{1,h_1}, \cdots, \overline{g}'_{i_1,h_1}, \cdots, \overline{g}_{n,h_1})$ and $\overline{g}'_{1:h_2-1} := (\overline{g}_1, \cdots, \overline{g}'_{h_1}, \cdots, \overline{g}_{h_2-1})$. Now we claim that $\overline{c}_{h_2}$ has non-zero probability under $\overline{g}'_{1:h_2-1}$, i.e., $\overline{c}_{h_2}$ is reachable under $\overline{g}'_{1:h_2-1}$. Since $\overline{c}_{h_2}$ is reachable under $\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}$ and $\mathbb{P}(\overline{a}'_{i_1,h_1} | \overline{c}_{h_2}, \overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}) > 0$, we know that $\mathbb{P}(\overline{a}'_{i_1,h_1}, \overline{c}_{h_2} | \overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}) > 0$.

Since $\overline{g}'_{1:h_2-1}$ only differs from $\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}$ in the strategy of agent $(i_1,h_1)$, and $\overline{g}'_{i_1,h_1}$ always chooses $\overline{a}'_{i_1,h_1}$, then it holds that $\mathbb{P}(\overline{a}'_{i_1,h_1},\overline{c}_{h_2}|\overline{g}'_{1:h_2-1}) \geq \mathbb{P}(\overline{a}'_{i_1,h_1},\overline{c}_{h_2}|\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}) > 0$, and thus $\mathbb{P}(\overline{c}_{h_2}|\overline{g}'_{1:h_2-1}) > 0$. Meanwhile, due to Equation (D.2), we have $\mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_{h_2},\overline{p}_{h_2}|\overline{c}_{h_2},\overline{g}'_{1:h_2-1}) = 0 \neq \mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_{h_2},\overline{p}_{h_2}|\overline{c}_{h_2},\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1})$, which leads to a contradiction to the fact that $\mathcal{D}$ has SI-CIBs.

- If $\sigma(\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$, then we know that $\sigma(\overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \nsubseteq \sigma(\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$. This further implies that there must exist a strategy $\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}$ and some realizations $\overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} \neq \overline{\tau}'_{i_1,h_1} \in \overline{\mathcal{T}}_{i_1,h_1}, \overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2} \in \overline{\mathcal{T}}_{i_2,h_2}$ such that $\mathbb{P}(\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}|\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}) > 0, \mathbb{P}(\overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}|\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2},\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}) > 0$, and $\mathbb{P}(\overline{\tau}'_{i_1,h_1}|\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2},\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}) > 0$. Then, due to perfect recall, there exist some realizations $\overline{s}_{h_2} \in \overline{\mathcal{S}}, \overline{\tau}_{h_2} \in \overline{\mathcal{T}}_{h_2}$ such that $\overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} \subseteq \overline{\tau}_{h_2}, \overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2} \subseteq \overline{\tau}_{h_2}$ and $\mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_{h_2},\overline{\tau}_{h_2}|\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}) > 0$. Let $\overline{c}_{h_2} \in \overline{\mathcal{C}}_{h_2}, \overline{p}_{h_2} \in \overline{\mathcal{P}}_{h_2}$ be the realizations such that $\overline{c}_{h_2} \subseteq \overline{\tau}_{h_2}$ and $\overline{p}_{h_2} \subseteq \overline{\tau}_{h_2}$, then it holds that $\mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_{h_2},\overline{p}_{h_2},\overline{c}_{h_2}|\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}) = \mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_{h_2},\overline{\tau}_{h_2}|\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}) > 0$. Thus, we know that $\mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_{h_2},\overline{p}_{h_2}|\overline{c}_{h_2},\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}) > 0$, and that $\overline{c}_{h_2}$ is reachable under $\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}$, i.e., $\mathbb{P}(\overline{c}_{h_2}|\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}) > 0$. Meanwhile, since $\sigma(\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2})$, we know that there exists a realization $\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1} \in \overline{\mathcal{A}}_{i_1,h_1}$ such that $\mathbb{P}(\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}|\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2},\overline{g}^{\circ}_{1:h_2-1}) = 1$ holds for any strategy $\overline{g}^{\circ}_{1:h_2-1} \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{1:h_2-1}$. By applying $\overline{g}^{\circ}_{1:h_2-1} = \overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}$, we obtain $\mathbb{P}(\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}|\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2},\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}) = 1$. Consider another different action realization $\overline{a}'_{i_1,h_1} \neq \overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}$, and define a new strategy $\overline{g}'_{i_1,h_1}$ as

$$\overline{g}'_{i_1,h_1}(\overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) = \overline{a}'_{i_1,h_1}, \quad \overline{g}'_{i_1,h_1}(\overline{\tau}'_{i_1,h_1}) = \overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}, \tag{D.3}$$

and keep $g'_{i_1,h_1}(\overline{\tau}''_{i_1,h_1})$ the same as $g_{i_1,h_1}(\overline{\tau}''_{i_1,h_1})$ for any other realizations $\overline{\tau}''_{i_1,h_1} \in \overline{\mathcal{T}}_{i_1,h_1}$. We denote $\overline{g}'_{h_1} := (\overline{g}_{1,h_1},\cdots,\overline{g}'_{i_1,h_1},\cdots,\overline{g}_{n,h_1})$ and $\overline{g}'_{1:h_2-1} := (\overline{g}_1,\cdots,\overline{g}'_{h_1},\cdots,\overline{g}_{h_2-1})$. Since $\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}$ has non-zero probability under $\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}$, and $\mathbb{P}(\overline{\tau}'_{i_1,h_1}|\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2},\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}) > 0$, it holds that $\mathbb{P}(\overline{\tau}'_{i_1,h_1},\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}|\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}) > 0$. Together with the fact that $\mathbb{P}(\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}|\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2},\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}) = 1$, we can obtain that $\mathbb{P}(\overline{\tau}'_{i_1,h_1},\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1},\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}|\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}) > 0$. Since $\overline{g}'_{1:h_2-1}$ only differs from $\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}$ in the strategy of agent $(i_1,h_1)$, and $\overline{g}'_{i_1,h_1}$ always chooses $\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}$ when inputting $\overline{\tau}'_{i_1,h_1}$, then it holds that $\mathbb{P}(\overline{c}_{h_2}|\overline{g}'_{1:h_2-1}) \geq \mathbb{P}(\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}|\overline{g}'_{1:h_2-1}) \geq \mathbb{P}(\overline{\tau}'_{i_1,h_1},\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1},\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}|\overline{g}'_{1:h_2-1}) \geq \mathbb{P}(\overline{\tau}'_{i_1,h_1},\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1},\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}|\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}) > 0$, which means $\overline{c}_{h_2}$ is reachable under $\overline{g}'_{1:h_2-1}$. Meanwhile, it holds that

$$\mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_{h_2},\overline{p}_{h_2}|\overline{c}_{h_2},\overline{g}'_{1:h_2-1}) = \frac{\mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_{h_2},\overline{p}_{h_2},\overline{c}_{h_2}|\overline{g}'_{1:h_2-1})}{\mathbb{P}(\overline{c}_{h_2}|\overline{g}'_{1:h_2-1})} = \frac{\mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_{h_2},\overline{\tau}_{h_2}|\overline{g}'_{1:h_2-1})}{\mathbb{P}(\overline{c}_{h_2}|\overline{g}'_{1:h_2-1})} = 0 \neq \mathbb{P}(\overline{s}_{h_2},\overline{p}_{h_2}|\overline{c}_{h_2},\overline{g}_{1:h_2-1}), \tag{D.4}$$

where the third equality is because 1) $\overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1} \subseteq \overline{\tau}_{h_2}$, $\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1} \in \overline{\tau}_{h_2}$ since $\mathbb{P}(\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1}|\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}) = 1$, $\overline{\tau}_{i_2,h_2} \subseteq \overline{\tau}_{h_2}$, and perfect recall; 2) $\overline{a}_{i_1,h_1},\overline{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}$ can never be realized simultaneously under $\overline{g}'_{1:h_2-1}$ due to Equation (D.3). Therefore, Equation (D.4) leads to a contradiction to the fact that $\mathcal{D}$ has SI-CIBs.

This completes the proof. □

# E. Collection of Algorithm Pseudocodes

Here we collect both our planning and learning algorithms as pseudocodes below.

**Algorithm 1** Planning in QC LTC Problems

**Require:** LTC problem $\mathcal{L}$

Reformulate $\mathcal{L}$ as $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ based on §IV-A
Expand $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ to $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$ based on Equation (IV.1)
Refine $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$ as $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ based on $\mathcal{L}$ and §IV-C
Construct an expected approximate common-information model $\mathcal{M}$ from $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ (see examples of such constructions in the proof of Theorem IV.8)
$\widehat{g}^{*}_{1:\widetilde{H}} \leftarrow$ Algorithm 6($\mathcal{M}$)
$\widetilde{g}^{*}_{1:\widetilde{H}} \leftarrow \varphi(\widehat{g}^{*}_{1:\widetilde{H}}, \mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}})$
$g^{m,*}_{1:H} \leftarrow \{\widetilde{g}^{*}_{1}, \widetilde{g}^{*}_{3}, \cdots, \widetilde{g}^{*}_{2H-1}\}$
$g^{a,*}_{1:H} \leftarrow \{\widetilde{g}^{*}_{2}, \widetilde{g}^{*}_{4}, \cdots, \widetilde{g}^{*}_{2H}\}$
**return** $(g^{a,*}_{1:H}, g^{m,*}_{1:H})$

**Algorithm 2** Learning in QC LTC Problems

**Require:** LTC problem $\mathcal{L}$, compression functions $\{\text{Compress}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$ and rules $\{\widehat{\phi}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$, length $\widehat{L}$, accuracy level $\epsilon$, probability $\delta$, constant $C$

Reformulate $\mathcal{L}$ as $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ based on §IV-A
Expand $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ to $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$ based on Equation (IV.1)
Refine $\mathcal{D}^{\dagger}_{\mathcal{L}}$ as $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ based on $\mathcal{L}$ and §IV-C
Construct $\{\widehat{\mathcal{C}}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$ as $\forall h \in [\overline{H}], \widehat{\mathcal{C}}_h = \{\text{Compress}_h(\overline{c}_h) \,|\, \overline{c}_h \in \overline{\mathcal{C}}_h\}$
Denote $S = |\overline{\mathcal{S}}|, A = \max_{h\in[\overline{H}]} |\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h|, O = \max_{h\in[\overline{H}]} |\overline{\mathcal{O}}_h|, P = \max_{h\in[\overline{H}]} |\overline{\mathcal{P}}_h|, \widehat{C} = \max_{h\in[\overline{H}]} |\widehat{\mathcal{C}}_h|$, and recall $\gamma$ is the parameter in Assumption III.1
Define $K = 2\overline{H}S, \alpha = \frac{C\overline{H}^2\epsilon}{200(\overline{H}+1)^2}, \epsilon_1 = \frac{\epsilon}{200(\overline{H}+1)^2}, \theta_1 = \frac{\epsilon}{200(\overline{H}+1)^2 O}, \theta_2 = \frac{\epsilon}{200(\overline{H}+1)^2 AP}, \phi = \frac{\epsilon_1\gamma^2}{C^2\overline{H}^8 S^5 O^4}, \zeta_1 = \min\left\{\frac{\epsilon\phi}{200(\overline{H}+1)^2 A^{2\widehat{L}} O^{\widehat{L}}}, \frac{\epsilon}{400(\overline{H}+1)^2 AP}\right\}, \zeta_2 = \zeta_1^2, \beta = \frac{\delta}{3}, N_0 = \lceil \max\left\{\frac{C(P+\log\frac{4\overline{H}\widehat{C}}{\beta}}{\zeta_1\theta_1^2}, \frac{CA(O+\log\frac{4\overline{H}\widehat{C}PA}{\beta})}{\zeta_2\theta_2^2}\right\}\rceil, N_1 = \lceil (AO)^{\widehat{L}} \log(\frac{1}{\beta})\rceil, N_2 = \lceil 16C\frac{\overline{H}^2 \log\frac{K^2 n}{\beta}}{\epsilon^2}\rceil$
Define $\widehat{\mathcal{M}} := \{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j})\}_{j=1}^{K}$
$\{g^{1:\overline{H},j}\}_{j=1}^{K} \leftarrow$ BaSeCAMP($\widehat{L}, N_0, N_1, \alpha, \beta, K$) by calling Algorithm 3 of [35] under $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$
**for** $j = 1$ to $K$ **do**
    $\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j}) \leftarrow$ LEE($g^{1:\overline{H},j}, \{\widehat{\mathcal{C}}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}, \{\widehat{\phi}_h\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}, \Gamma, \zeta_1, \zeta_2, \theta_1, \theta_2, \beta$) by calling Algorithm 5 of [14] under $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$
    $\overline{g}^{j,*}_{1:\overline{H}} \leftarrow$ Algorithm 6($\widehat{\mathcal{M}}(g^{1:\overline{H},j})$)
**end for**
$\overline{g}^{*}_{1:\overline{H}} \leftarrow$ Pos-Dec($\{\overline{g}^{j,*}_{1:\overline{H}}\}_{j=1}^{K}, N_2$) by calling Algorithm 8 of [14] under $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$
$\widetilde{g}^{*}_{1:\widetilde{H}} \leftarrow \varphi(\overline{g}^{*}_{1:\overline{H}}, \mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}})$
$g^{m,*}_{1:H} \leftarrow \{\widetilde{g}^{*}_{1}, \widetilde{g}^{*}_{3}, \cdots, \widetilde{g}^{*}_{2H-1}\}$
$g^{a,*}_{1:H} \leftarrow \{\widetilde{g}^{*}_{2}, \widetilde{g}^{*}_{4}, \cdots, \widetilde{g}^{*}_{2H}\}$
**return** $(g^{a,*}_{1:H}, g^{m,*}_{1:H})$

**Algorithm 3** Vanilla Realization of $\varphi(\breve{g}_{1:\breve{H}}, \mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}})$

**Require:** Strategy $\breve{g}_{1:\breve{H}}$, QC Dec-POMDP $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$

$\widetilde{g}_{1:\breve{H}} \leftarrow \emptyset$
**for** $h_2 = 1$ to $\breve{H}$, $i_2 = 1$ to $n$, $\widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,h_2} \in \widetilde{\mathcal{T}}_{i_2,h_2}$ **do**
  $\breve{\tau}'_{i_2,h_2} \leftarrow \widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}$
  **for** $h_1 = 1$ to $h_2 - 1$, $i_1 = 1$ to $n$ **do**
    **if** $\sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{c}_{h_2})$[3] in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ and $\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1}$ influences $\widetilde{s}_{h_1+1}$ **then**
      Obtain the value of $\widetilde{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}$ from that of $\widetilde{c}_{h_2}$ (based on $\widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}$)
      $\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1} \leftarrow \widetilde{g}_{i_1,h_1}(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_1,h_1})$
      $\breve{\tau}'_{i_2,h_2} \leftarrow \breve{\tau}'_{i_2,h_2} \cup \{\widetilde{a}_{i_1,h_1}\}$
    **end if**
  **end for**
  $\widetilde{g}_{i_2,h_2}(\widetilde{\tau}_{i_2,h_2}) \leftarrow \breve{g}_{i_2,h_2}(\breve{\tau}'_{i_2,h_2})$
**end for**
**return** $\widetilde{g}_{1:\widetilde{H}}$

**Algorithm 4** Efficient Implementation of $\varphi(\breve{g}_{1:\breve{H}}, \mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}})$

**Require:** Strategy $\breve{g}_{1:\breve{H}}$, QC Dec-POMDP $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$

**for** $h = 1$ to $\breve{H}$ **do**
  **for** $i = 1$ to $n$ **do**
    Agent $i$ receives $\widetilde{\tau}_{i,h}$
    $\breve{\tau}_{i,h} \leftarrow$ Recover$(\widetilde{\tau}_{i,h}, \breve{g}_{1:h-1}, \mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}})$ \\ Recursion of Algorithm 5
    Agent $i$ takes action $\widetilde{a}_{i,h} \leftarrow \breve{g}_{i,h}(\breve{\tau}_{i,h})$
  **end for**
**end for**

**Algorithm 5** Recover$(\widetilde{\tau}_{i,h}, \breve{g}_{1:h-1}, \mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}})$

**Require:** Information $\widetilde{\tau}_{i,h}$, Strategy $\breve{g}_{1:h-1}$, QC Dec-POMDP $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$

$\breve{\tau}_{i,h} \leftarrow \widetilde{\tau}_{i,h}$
**for** $j = 1$ to $n$, $h' = 1$ to $h - 1$ **do**
  **if** $\sigma(\widetilde{\tau}_{j,h'}) \subseteq \sigma(\widetilde{c}_h)$ in $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$ and $\widetilde{a}_{j,h'} \notin \widetilde{\tau}_{i,h}$ **then**
    Obtain the value of $\widetilde{\tau}_{j,h'}$ from that of $\widetilde{c}_h$ (based on $\widetilde{\tau}_{i,h}$)
    $\breve{\tau}_{j,h'} \leftarrow$ Recover$(\widetilde{\tau}_{j,h'}, \breve{g}_{1:h'-1}, \mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}})$
    $\widetilde{a}_{j,h'} \leftarrow \breve{g}_{j,h'}(\breve{\tau}_{j,h'})$
    $\breve{\tau}_{i,h} \leftarrow \breve{\tau}_{i,h} \cup \{\widetilde{a}_{j,h'}\}$
  **end if**
**end for**
**return** $\breve{\tau}_{i,h}$

[3] Note that the inclusion of $\sigma$-algebras here does not rely on the realized values of $\widetilde{\tau}_{i_1,h_1}, \widetilde{c}_{h_2}$, but relies on the information structure of $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{L}}$.

**Algorithm 6** Planning in Dec-POMDPs with Expected Approximate Common-information Model

**Require:** Expected approximate common-information model $\mathcal{M}$

**for** $\widehat{c}_{\overline{H}+1} \in \widehat{\mathcal{C}}_{\overline{H}+1}$ **do**
  $V^{*,\mathcal{M}}_{\overline{H}+1}(\widehat{c}_{\overline{H}+1}) \leftarrow 0$
**end for**
**for** $h = \overline{H}$ to 1 **do**
  **for** $\widehat{c}_h \in \widehat{\mathcal{C}}_h$ **do**
    Define $Q^{*,\mathcal{M}}_h(\widehat{c}_h, \gamma_{1,h}, \cdots, \gamma_{n,h}) := \widehat{\mathcal{R}}^{\mathcal{M}}_h(\widehat{c}_h, \gamma_h) + \mathbb{E}^{\mathcal{M}}\left[V^{*,\mathcal{M}}_{h+1}(\widehat{c}_{h+1}) | \widehat{c}_h, \gamma_h\right]$

$$\left(\widehat{g}^*_{1,h}(\cdot|\widehat{c}_h, \cdot), \cdots, \widehat{g}^*_{n,h}(\cdot|\widehat{c}_h, \cdot)\right) \leftarrow \operatorname*{argmax}_{\gamma_{1:n,h} \in \Gamma_h} Q^{*,\mathcal{M}}_h(\widehat{c}_h, \gamma_{1,h}, \cdots, \gamma_{n,h}) \tag{E.1}$$

    $V^{*,\mathcal{M}}_h(\widehat{c}_h) \leftarrow \max_{\gamma_{1:n,h} \in \Gamma_h} Q^{*,\mathcal{M}}_h(\widehat{c}_h, \gamma_{1,h}, \cdots, \gamma_{n,h})$
  **end for**
**end for**
**return** $\widehat{g}^*_{1:\overline{H}}$

# F. Decentralized POMDPs (with Information Sharing)

A Dec-POMDP with $n$ agents and potential information sharing can be characterized by a tuple

$$\mathcal{D} = \langle H, \mathcal{S}, \{\mathcal{A}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n],h\in[H]}, \{\mathcal{O}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n],h\in[H]}, \{\mathbb{T}_h\}_{h\in[H]}, \{\mathbb{O}_h\}_{h\in[H]}, \mu_1, \{\mathcal{R}_h\}_{h\in[H]}\rangle,$$

where $H$ denotes the length of each episode, $\mathcal{S}$ denotes the state space, and $\mathcal{A}_{i,h}$ denotes the *control action* space of agent $i$ at timestep $h$. We denote by $s_h \in \mathcal{S}$ the state and by $a_{i,h}$ the control action of agent $i$ at timestep $h$. We use $a_h := (a_{1,h}, \cdots, a_{n,h}) \in \mathcal{A}_h := \mathcal{A}_{1,h} \times \mathcal{A}_{2,h} \times \cdots \mathcal{A}_{n,h}$ to denote the joint control action for all the $n$ agents at timestep $h$, with $\mathcal{A}_h$ denoting the joint control action space at timestep $h$. We denote $\mathbb{T} = \{\mathbb{T}_h\}_{h\in[H]}$ the collection of transition functions, where $\mathbb{T}_h(\cdot|s_h, a_h) \in \Delta(\mathcal{S})$ gives the transition probability to the next state $s_{h+1}$ when taking the joint control action $a_h$ at state $s_h$. We use $\mu_1 \in \Delta(\mathcal{S})$ to denote the distribution of the initial state $s_1$. We denote by $\mathcal{O}_{i,h}$ the observation space and by $o_{i,h} \in \mathcal{O}_{i,h}$ the observation of agent $i$ at timestep $h$. We use $o_h := (o_{1,h}, o_{2,h}, \cdots, o_{n,h}) \in \mathcal{O}_h := \mathcal{O}_{1,h} \times \mathcal{O}_{2,h} \times \cdots \mathcal{O}_{n,h}$ to denote the joint observation of all the $n$ agents at timestep $h$, with $\mathcal{O}_h$ denoting the joint observation space at timestep $h$. We use $\{\mathbb{O}_h\}_{h\in[H]}$ to denote the collection of emission matrices, where $o_h \sim \mathbb{O}_h(\cdot|s_h) \in \Delta(\mathcal{O}_h)$ at timestep $h$ under state $s_h \in \mathcal{S}$. For notational convenience, we adopt the matrix convention, where $\mathbb{O}_h$ is a matrix with each row $\mathbb{O}_h(\cdot|s_h)$ for all $s_h \in \mathcal{S}$. Also, we denote by $\mathbb{O}_{i,h}$ the marginalized emission for agent $i$ at timestep $h$. Finally, $\{\mathcal{R}_h\}_{h\in[H]}$ is a collection of reward functions among all the agents, where $\mathcal{R}_h : \mathcal{S} \times \mathcal{A}_h \to [0, 1]$.

At timestep $h$, each agent $i$ in the Dec-POMDP has access to some information $\tau_{i,h}$, a subset of historical joint observations and actions, namely, $\tau_{i,h} \subseteq \{o_1, a_1, o_2, \cdots, a_{h-1}, o_h\}$, and the collection of all possible such available information is denoted by $\mathcal{T}_{i,h}$. We use $\tau_h$ to denote the *joint* available information at timestep $h$. Meanwhile, agents may *share* part of the history with each other. The *common information* $c_h = \cup_{t=1}^h z_t$ at timestep $h$ is thus a subset of the joint history $\tau_h$, where $z_h$ is the information shared at timestep $h$. We use $\mathcal{C}_h$ to denote the collection of all possible $c_h$ at timestep $h$, and use $\mathcal{T}_{i,h}$ to denote the collection of all possible $\tau_{i,h}$ of agent $i$ at timestep $h$. Besides the common information $c_h$, each agent also has her *private information* $p_{i,h} = \tau_{i,h} \backslash c_h$, where the collection of $p_{i,h}$ is denoted by $\mathcal{P}_{i,h}$. We also denote by $p_h$ the *joint* private information, and by $\mathcal{P}_h$ the collection of

all possible $p_h$ at timestep $h$. We refer to the above the *state-space model* of the Dec-POMDP (with information sharing), which follows the models in [15, 16].

Each agent $i$ at timestep $h$ chooses the control action $a_{i,h}$ based on some strategy $g_{i,h} : \mathcal{T}_{i,h} \to \mathcal{A}_{i,h}$. We denote by $g_h := (g_{1,h}, g_{2,h}, \cdots, g_{n,h})$ the joint control strategy of all the agents, and by $g_{1:h} := (g_1, g_2, \cdots, g_h), \forall h \in [H]$ the sequence of joint strategies from timestep 1 to $h$. We use $\mathcal{G}_{i,h}$ to denote the strategy space of $g_{i,h}$, and use $\mathcal{G}_h, \mathcal{G}_{1:h}$ to denote joint strategy spaces, correspondingly. Next, we introduce some background on the intrinsic model and information structure of Dec-POMDPs.

## F-A Intrinsic Model

In an intrinsic model [27], we regard the agent $i$ at different timesteps as *different agents*, and each agent only acts *once* throughout. Any Dec-POMDP $\mathcal{D}$ with $n$ agents can be formulated within the intrinsic-model framework, and can be characterized by a tuple $\langle (\Omega, \mathscr{F}), N, \{(\mathbb{U}_l, \mathscr{U}_l)\}_{l=1}^N, \{(\mathbb{I}_l, \mathscr{I}_l)\}_{l=1}^N \rangle$ [11], where $(\Omega, \mathcal{F})$ is a measurable space of the environment, $N = n \times H$ is the number of agents in the intrinsic model. By a slight abuse of notation, we write $[N] := [n] \times [H]$, and write $l := (i,h) \in [N]$ for notational convenience. This way, any agent $l \in [N]$ corresponds to an agent $i \in [n]$ at timestep $h \in [H]$ in the state-space model. We denote by $\mathbb{U}_l$ the measurable action space of agent $l$ and by $\mathscr{U}_l$ the $\sigma$-algebra over $\mathbb{U}_l$. For $A \subseteq [N]$, let $\mathbb{H}_A := \Omega \times \prod_{l \in A} \mathbb{U}_l$ and $\mathbb{H} := \mathbb{H}_{[N]}$. For any $\sigma$-algebra $\mathscr{C}$ over $\mathbb{H}_A$, let $\langle \mathscr{C} \rangle$ denote the cylindrical extension of $\mathscr{C}$ on $\mathbb{H}$. Let $\mathscr{H}_A := \langle \mathscr{F} \otimes (\otimes_{l \in A} \mathscr{U}_l) \rangle$ and $\mathscr{H} = \mathscr{H}_{[N]}$. We denote by $\mathbb{I}_l$ the space of *information available* to agent $l$, and by $\mathscr{I}_l$ the $\sigma$-algebra over $\mathbb{H}$. For $l \in [N]$, we denote by $I_l$ the information of agent $l$, and $U_l$ the action of agent $l$. The spaces and random variables of agent $l = (i,h)$ in the intrinsic model are related to those in the state-space model as follows: $\forall l = (i,h) \in [N], \mathbb{U}_l = \mathcal{A}_{i,h}, \mathbb{I}_l = \mathcal{T}_{i,h}, U_l = a_{i,h}, I_l = \tau_{i,h}$.

## F-B Information Structures of Dec-POMDPs

An important class of IS is the *quasi-classical* one, which is defined as follows [27, 11, 12].

**Definition F.1** (Quasi-classical Dec-POMDPs)**.** We call a Dec-POMDP problem *QC* if each agent in the intrinsic model knows the information available to the agents who influence her, directly or indirectly, i.e., $\forall l_1, l_2 \in [N], l_1 = (i_1, h_1), l_2 = (i_2, h_2), i_1, i_2 \in [n], h_1, h_2 \in [H]$, if agent $l_1$ influences agent $l_2$, Then, $\mathscr{I}_{l_1} \subseteq \mathscr{I}_{l_2}$.

Furthermore, *strictly* quasi-classical IS [27, 28], as a subclass of QC IS, is defined as follows.

**Definition F.2** (Strictly quasi-classical Dec-POMDPs)**.** We call a Dec-POMDP problem *sQC* if each agent in the intrinsic model knows the information *and* actions available to the agents who influence her, directly or indirectly. That is, $\forall l_1, l_2 \in [N], l_1 = (i_1, h_1), l_2 = (i_2, h_2), i_1, i_2 \in [n], h_1, h_2 \in [H]$, if agent $l_1$ influences agent $l_2$, Then, $\mathscr{I}_{l_1} \cup \langle \mathscr{U}_{l_1} \rangle \subseteq \mathscr{I}_{l_2}$.

## F-C Intrinsic Model of LTC Problems

Given any LTC $\mathcal{L}$ of the state-space-model form defined in §II-A, we define the intrinsic model of $\mathcal{L}$ as a tuple $\langle (\Omega, \mathscr{F}), N, \{(\mathbb{U}_l, \mathscr{U}_l)\}_{l=1}^N, \{(\mathbb{M}_l, \mathscr{M}_l)\}_{l=1}^N, \{(\mathbb{I}_{l^-}, \mathscr{I}_{l^-})\}_{l=1}^N, \{(\mathbb{I}_{l^+}, \mathscr{I}_{l^+})\}_{l=1}^N \rangle$, where $(\Omega, \mathscr{F})$ is the measure space representing all the uncertainty in the system; $N = n \times H$ is the number of agents in the intrinsic model. By a slight abuse of notation, we write $[N] := [n] \times [H]$, and write $l := (i,h) \in [N]$ for convenience. This way, any agent $l \in [N]$ corresponds to an agent $i \in [n]$ at timestep $h \in [H]$ in the state-space model, and we thus define $l^- := (i, h^-)$ and $l^+ := (i, h^+)$ accordingly. We denote

by $\mathbb{U}_l$ and $\mathbb{M}_l$ the measurable control and communication action spaces of agent $l$, and by $\mathscr{U}_l$ and $\mathscr{M}_l$ the $\sigma$-algebra over $\mathbb{U}_l$ and $\mathbb{M}_l$, respectively. For any $A \subseteq [N]$, let $\mathbb{H}_A := \Omega \times \prod_{l\in A}(\mathbb{U}_l \times \mathbb{M}_l)$ and $\mathbb{H} := \mathbb{H}_{[N]}$. For any $\sigma$-algebra $\mathscr{C}$ over $\mathbb{H}_A$, let $\langle\mathscr{C}\rangle$ denote the cylindrical extension of $\mathscr{C}$ on $\mathbb{H}$. Let $\mathscr{H}_A := \langle\mathscr{F}\otimes(\otimes_{l\in A}\mathscr{U}_l)\otimes(\otimes_{l\in A}\mathscr{M}_l)\rangle$, $\mathscr{H} = \mathscr{H}_{[N]}$. We denote by $\mathbb{I}_{l^-}$ and $\mathbb{I}_{l^+}$ the spaces of *information available* to agent $l$ *before* and *after* additional sharing, respectively, and by $\mathscr{I}_{l^-} \subseteq \mathscr{H}$ and $\mathscr{I}_{l^+} \subseteq \mathscr{H}$ the associated $\sigma$-algebra. The spaces and random variables of agent $l = (i,h)$ in the intrinsic model are related to those in the state-space model as follows: $\forall l = (i,h) \in [N], \mathbb{U}_l = \mathcal{A}_{i,h}, \mathbb{M}_l = \mathcal{M}_{i,h}, \mathbb{I}_{l^-} = \mathcal{T}_{i,h^-}, \mathbb{I}_{l^+} = \mathcal{T}_{i,h^+}, U_l = a_{i,h}, M_l = m_{i,h}, I_{l^-} = \tau_{i,h^-}, I_{l^+} = \tau_{i,h^+}$. For notational convenience, for any random variable $B$ in LTC and the $\sigma$-algebra $\mathscr{B}$ generated by $B$, we overload $\sigma(B)$ to denote the cylindrical extension of $\mathscr{B}$ on $\mathbb{H}$, i.e., $\sigma(B) = \langle\mathscr{B}\rangle$.

# G. Other Supplementary Results

## G-A Optimality of Deterministic Strategies

We now show a supplementary result that for the formulated LTC problem, it does not lose optimality to consider *deterministic* strategies as introduced in §II. For any LTC problem $\mathcal{L}$, consider generic, stochastic communication and control strategy spaces: $\forall i \in [n],\ h \in [H],\ \mathcal{G}^{m,S}_{i,h} := \{g^{m,S}_{i,h} : \Omega^m_{i,h} \times \mathcal{T}_{i,h^-} \to \mathcal{M}_{i,h}\},\ \mathcal{G}^{\mathrm{a},S}_{i,h} := \{g^{\mathrm{a},S}_{i,h} : \Omega^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h} \times \mathcal{T}_{i,h^+} \to \mathcal{A}_{i,h}\}$, where $\{\Omega^m_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n],h\in[H]}, \{\Omega^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n],h\in[H]}$ are the sets of random seeds which could be correlated to each other across agents and timesteps. Note that these strategy classes include those of the strategies randomized over the action sets, i.e., $\forall i \in [n],\ h \in [H],\ \mathcal{G}^{m,S}_{i,h} := \{g^{m,S}_{i,h} : \mathcal{T}_{i,h^-} \to \Delta(\mathcal{M}_{i,h})\},\ \mathcal{G}^{\mathrm{a},S}_{i,h} := \{g^{\mathrm{a},S}_{i,h} : \mathcal{T}_{i,h^+} \to \Delta(\mathcal{A}_{i,h})\}$. Also, we denote by $\mathcal{G}^{\mathrm{a},S}_h, \mathcal{G}^{m,S}_h$ the *joint* stochastic control and communication spaces at timestep $h$, respectively. Similarly, we define the objective under the stochastic strategies as

$$\forall g^{\mathrm{a},S}_{1:H} \in \mathcal{G}^{\mathrm{a},S}_{1:H}, g^{m,S}_{1:H} \in \mathcal{G}^{m,S}_{1:H}, \qquad J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{\mathrm{a},S}_{1:H}, g^{m,S}_{1:H}) := \mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{L}}\left[\sum_{h=1}^{H}(r_h - \kappa_h)\,\middle|\, g^{\mathrm{a},S}_{1:H}, g^{m,S}_{1:H}\right].$$

**Lemma G.1.** It does not lose optimality to consider deterministic control and communication strategies in LTC. Namely, for any LTC problem $\mathcal{L}$,

$$\max_{g^{\mathrm{a},S}_{1:H}\in\mathcal{G}^{\mathrm{a},S}_{1:H}, g^{m,S}_{1:H}\in\mathcal{G}^{m,S}_{1:H}} J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{\mathrm{a},S}_{1:H}, g^{m,S}_{1:H}) = \max_{g^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}\in\mathcal{G}^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}, g^{m}_{1:H}\in\mathcal{G}^{m}_{1:H}} J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}, g^{m}_{1:H}). \tag{G.1}$$

*Proof.* For any $i \in [n], h \in [H]$, since space $\mathcal{G}^{m,S}_{i,h}$ covers space $\mathcal{G}^{m}_{i,h}$ and space $\mathcal{G}^{\mathrm{a},S}_{i,h}$ covers space $\mathcal{G}^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h}$, we have that

$$\max_{g^{\mathrm{a},S}_{1:H}\in\mathcal{G}^{\mathrm{a},S}_{1:H}, g^{m,S}_{1:H}\in\mathcal{G}^{m,S}_{1:H}} J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{\mathrm{a},S}_{1:H}, g^{m,S}_{1:H}) \geq \max_{g^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}\in\mathcal{G}^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}, g^{m}_{1:H}\in\mathcal{G}^{m}_{1:H}} J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}, g^{m}_{1:H}). \tag{G.2}$$

In the other direction, from the tower property, for any $g^{\mathrm{a},S}_{1:H} \in \mathcal{G}^{\mathrm{a},S}_{1:H}, g^{m,S}_{1:H} \in \mathcal{G}^{m,S}_{1:H}$

$$J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{\mathrm{a},S}_{1:H}, g^{m,S}_{1:H}) = \mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{L}}\left[\sum_{h=1}^{H}(r_h - \kappa_h)\,\middle|\, g^{\mathrm{a},S}_{1:H}, g^{m,S}_{1:H}\right] = \mathbb{E}\left[\mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{L}}\Big[\sum_{h=1}^{H}(r_h - \kappa_h)\,\Big|\, \{g^{\mathrm{a},S}_{i,h}[\omega^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h}]\}_{i\in[n],h\in[H]}, \{g^{m,S}_{i,h}[\omega^{m}_{i,h}]\}_{i\in[n],h\in[H]}\Big]\right],$$

where $\omega^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h} \in \Omega^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h}$, $\omega^{m}_{i,h} \in \Omega^{m}_{i,h}$ are random seeds, and $g^{\mathrm{a},S}_{i,h}[\omega^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h}] \in \mathcal{G}^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h}, g^{\mathrm{a},S}_{i,h}[\omega^{m}_{i,h}] \in \mathcal{G}^{m}_{i,h}$ are deterministic

strategies defined as

$$\forall \tau_{i,h^-} \in \mathcal{T}_{i,h^-}, g^{m,S}_{i,h}[\omega^m_{i,h}](\tau_{i,h^-}) := g^{m,S}_{i,h}(\omega^m_{i,h}, \tau_{i,h^-}),$$
$$\forall \tau_{i,h^+} \in \mathcal{T}_{i,h^+}, g^{\mathrm{a},S}_{i,h}[\omega^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h}](\tau_{i,h^+}) := g^{\mathrm{a},S}_{i,h}(\omega^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h}, \tau_{i,h^+}).$$

Therefore, we have

$$\begin{aligned} J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{\mathrm{a},S}_{1:H}, g^{m,S}_{1:H}) &= \mathbb{E}\left[\mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{L}}\Big[\sum_{h=1}^{H}(r_h - \kappa_h)\,\Big|\,\{g^{\mathrm{a},S}_{i,h}[\omega^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h}]\}, \{g^{m,S}_{i,h}[\omega^m_{i,h}]\}\Big]\right] \\ &\le \max_{\{\omega^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n],h\in[H]}, \{\omega^m_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n],h\in[H]}} \mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{L}}\left[\sum_{h=1}^{H}(r_h - \kappa_h)\,\Big|\,\{g^{\mathrm{a},S}_{i,h}[\omega^{\mathrm{a}}_{i,h}]\}, \{g^{m,S}_{i,h}[\omega^m_{i,h}]\}\right] \\ &\le \max_{g^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}\in\mathcal{G}^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}, g^m_{1:H}\in\mathcal{G}^m_{1:H}} J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}, g^m_{1:H}) \end{aligned}$$

holds for any $g^{\mathrm{a},S}_{1:H} \in \mathcal{G}^{\mathrm{a},S}_{1:H}, g^{m,S}_{1:H} \in \mathcal{G}^{m,S}_{1:H}$. Hence, we further get

$$\max_{g^{\mathrm{a},S}_{1:H}\in\mathcal{G}^{\mathrm{a},S}_{1:H}, g^{m,S}_{1:H}\in\mathcal{G}^{m,S}_{1:H}} J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{\mathrm{a},S}_{1:H}, g^{m,S}_{1:H}) \le \max_{g^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}\in\mathcal{G}^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}, g^m_{1:H}\in\mathcal{G}^m_{1:H}} J_{\mathcal{L}}(g^{\mathrm{a}}_{1:H}, g^m_{1:H}). \tag{G.3}$$

Combining Equations (G.2) and (G.3), we prove Equation (G.1). □

## G-B Conditions Leading to Assumption IV.7

As a minimal requirement for computational tractability (for both Dec-POMDPs and LTCs), Assumption IV.7 is needed for the one-step tractability of the team-decision problem involved in the value iteration in Algorithm 6. We now adapt several such structural conditions from [14] to the LTC setting, which lead to this assumption and have been studied in the literature. Note that since we need to do planning in the approximate model $\mathcal{M}$, which is oftentimes constructed based on the original problem $\mathcal{L}$ and the approximate beliefs $\{\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{M},c}_h(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h|\widehat{c}_h)\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$, we necessarily need conditions on models $\mathcal{L}$, $\mathcal{M}$, and the beliefs $\{\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{M},c}_h(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h|\widehat{c}_h)\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$ that $\mathcal{M}$ is consistent with, to ensure Assumption IV.7 holds, for which we refer to as the **Part (1)** and **Part (2)** of the conditions below, respectively.

- **Turn-based structures. Part (1):** At each timestep $h \in [\overline{H}]$, there is only one agent, denoted as $ct(h) \in [n]$, that can affect the state transition. More concretely, the transition dynamics take the forms of $\mathbb{T}_h : \mathcal{S} \times \mathcal{A}_{ct(h),h} \to \Delta(\mathcal{S})$. Additionally, we assume the reward function admits an additive structure such that $\mathcal{R}_h(s_h, a_h) = \sum_{i\in[n]} \mathcal{R}_{i,h}(s_h, a_{i,h})$ for some functions $\{\mathcal{R}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n]}$. Meanwhile, since only agent $ct(h)$ takes the action, we assume the increment of the common information satisfies $z^{\mathrm{b}}_{h+1} = \chi_{h+1}(p_{h^+}, a_{ct(h),h}, o_{h+1})$. **Part (2):** No additional requirement. Such a structure has been commonly studied in (fully observable) stochastic games and multi-agent RL [40, 41].
- **Nested private information. Part (1):** No additional requirement. **Part (2):** At each timestep $h = 2t$ with $t \in [H]$, all the agents form a *hierarchy* according to the private information they possess, in the sense that $\forall\, i, j \in [n], j < i, \overline{p}_{j,h} = Y^{i,j}_h(\overline{p}_{i,h})$ for some function $Y^{i,j}_h$. More formally, the approximate belief satisfies that $\mathbb{P}^{\mathcal{M},c}_h(\overline{p}_{j,h} = Y^{i,j}_h(\overline{p}_{i,h})|\overline{p}_{i,h}, \widehat{c}_h) = 1$. Such a structure has been investigated in [42] with heuristic search, and in [14] with finite-time complexity analysis when there is no additional sharing to decide/learn.

- **Factorized structures. Part (1):** At each timestep $h \in [\overline{H}]$, the state $s_h$ can be partitioned into $n$ local states, i.e., $s_h = (s_{1,h}, s_{2,h}, \cdots, s_{n,h})$. Meanwhile, the transition kernel takes the product form of $\mathbb{T}_h(s_{h+1}|s_h, a_h) = \prod_{i=1}^n \mathbb{T}_{i,h}(s_{i,h+1}|s_{i,h}, a_{i,h})$, the emission also takes the product form of $\mathbb{O}_h(o_h|s_h) = \prod_{i=1}^n \mathbb{O}_{i,h}(o_{i,h}|s_{i,h})$, and the communication cost and reward functions can be decoupled into $n$ terms such that $\mathcal{K}_h(z_h^{\mathrm{a}}) = \sum_{i=1}^n \mathcal{K}_{i,h}(z_{i,h}^{\mathrm{a}}), \mathcal{R}_h(s_h, a_h) = \sum_{i=1}^n \mathcal{R}_{i,h}(s_{i,h}, a_{i,h})$. **Part (2):** At each timestep $h \in [\overline{H}]$, the approximate common information is also factorized so that $\widehat{c}_h = (\widehat{c}_{1,h}, \widehat{c}_{2,h}, \cdots, \widehat{c}_{n,h})$ and its evolution satisfies that $\widehat{c}_{i,h} = \widehat{\phi}_{i,h}(\widehat{c}_{i,h-1}, \overline{z}_{i,h-1})$ for some function $\widehat{\phi}_{i,h}$. Correspondingly, the approximate beliefs need to satisfy that $\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},c}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h|\widehat{c}_h) = \Pi_{i=1}^n \mathbb{P}_{i,h}^{\mathcal{M},c}(\overline{s}_{i,h}, \overline{p}_{i,h}|\widehat{c}_{i,h})$ for some functions $\{\mathbb{P}_{i,h}^{\mathcal{M},c}\}_{i\in[n],h\in[\overline{H}]}$. Such a structure, under general information sharing protocols, can lead to non-classical IS. In this case, it may be viewed as an example of non-classical ISs where the agents have no incentive for signaling [12, §3.8.3].

**Lemma G.2.** Given any LTC problem $\mathcal{L}$, let $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ be the Dec-POMDP after reformulation, strict expansion, and refinement. For any $\mathcal{M}$ to be the approximate model of $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ and $\{\mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},c}\}_{h\in[\overline{H}]}$ to be the approximate belief, if they satisfy any of the 3 conditions above, Then, Equation (E.1) in Algorithm 6 can be solved with time complexity $\max_{h\in[\overline{H}]} \mathrm{poly}\,(|\overline{\mathcal{P}}_h|, |\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h|, |\overline{\mathcal{S}}|)$.

*Proof.* For any $h \in [\overline{H}]$, if $h = 2t-1, t \in [H]$, from Assumption III.4 and the construction of $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$, since we need to find the optimal strategy of $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ in the spaces $\overline{g}_h \in \overline{\mathcal{G}}_h = \{g : \overline{\mathcal{C}}_h \to \overline{\mathcal{A}}_h\}$ for all $h \in [\overline{H}]$, where we recall that $\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h = \mathcal{M}_t$ is joint communication action space. Then, $\Gamma_h = \mathcal{M}_t$ has cardinality $|\Gamma_h| = |\mathcal{M}_t|$, and $\gamma^*_{1:n,h}$ can be computed as $\gamma^*_{1:n,h} \in \mathrm{argmax}_{\gamma_{1:n,h}\in\Gamma_h} Q_h^{*,\mathcal{M}}(\widehat{c}_h, \gamma_{1:n,h})$ by enumerating all possible $\gamma_{1:n,h} \in \Gamma_h$, with a complexity of $|\mathcal{M}_t|$.

If $h = 2t, t \in [H]$, we prove the result case by case:

- **Nested private information:** We first define the $u_{i,h} \in \mathcal{U}_{i,h} := \{(\prod_{j=1}^i \overline{\mathcal{P}}_{j,h}) \times (\prod_{j=1}^{i-1} \overline{\mathcal{A}}_{j,h}) \to \overline{\mathcal{A}}_{i,h}\}$ and slightly abuse the notation for $Q_h^{*,\mathcal{M}}$ as follows

$$Q_h^{*,\mathcal{M}}(\widehat{c}_h, u_{1,h}, \cdots, u_{n,h}) := \sum_{\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h, \overline{a}_h, \overline{s}_{h+1}, \overline{o}_{h+1}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},c}(\overline{s}_h, \overline{p}_h|\widehat{c}_h) \Pi_{i=1}^n \mathbb{1}[\overline{a}_{i,h} = u_{i,h}(\overline{p}_{1:i,h}, \overline{a}_{1:i-1,h})] \overline{\mathbb{T}}_h(\overline{s}_{h+1}|\overline{s}_h, \overline{a}_h)$$
$$\overline{\mathbb{O}}_{h+1}(\overline{o}_{h+1}|\overline{s}_{h+1})[\overline{\mathcal{R}}_h(\overline{s}_h, \overline{a}_h, \overline{p}_h) + V_{h+1}^{*,\mathcal{M}}(\widehat{c}_{h+1})].$$

  Since the space of $\mathcal{U}_{i,h}$ covers the space of $\Gamma_{i,h}$, Then, for the $u^*_{1:n,h}$ to be an optimal one that maximizes the $Q_h^{*,\mathcal{M}}$, we have

$$Q_h^{*,\mathcal{M}}(\widehat{c}_h, u^*_{1,h}, \cdots, u^*_{n,h}) = \max_{\{u_{i,h}\in\mathcal{U}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n]}} Q_h^{*,\mathcal{M}}(\widehat{c}_h, u_{1,h}, \cdots, u_{n,h}) \geq \max_{\{\gamma_{i,h}\in\Gamma_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n]}} Q_h^{*,\mathcal{M}}(\widehat{c}_h, \gamma_{1,h}, \cdots, \gamma_{n,h}).$$

  Meanwhile, due to the nested private information condition, for any $\overline{p}_h \in \overline{\mathcal{P}}_h$, there must exist $\gamma'_{1:n,h}$ such that $\gamma'_{1:n,h}$ output the same actions as $u^*_{1:n,h}$ under $\overline{p}_h$. Therefore, we can conclude that

$$\max_{\{u_{i,h}\in\mathcal{U}_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n]}} Q_h^{*,\mathcal{M}}(\widehat{c}_h, u_{1,h}, \cdots, u_{n,h}) = \max_{\{\gamma_{i,h}\in\Gamma_{i,h}\}_{i\in[n]}} Q_h^{*,\mathcal{M}}(\widehat{c}_h, \gamma_{1,h}, \cdots, \gamma_{n,h}).$$

  Therefore, we can solve Equation (E.1) and compute $\gamma^*_{1:n,h}$ from computing $u^*_{1:n,h}$, which can be solved with complexity $\mathrm{poly}(|\overline{\mathcal{P}}_h|, |\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h|, |\overline{\mathcal{S}}|)$.

- **Turn-based structures:** For any $\gamma_{ct(h),h} \in \Gamma_{ct(h),h}, \gamma_{-ct(h),h}, \gamma'_{-ct(h),h} \in \Gamma_{-ct(h),h}$, where $ct(h)$ is the

controller at timestep $h$, it holds that for any $\widehat{c}_h$:

$$
\begin{aligned}
&Q_h^{*,\mathcal{M}}(\widehat{c}_h, \gamma_{ct(h),h}, \gamma_{-ct(h),h}) \\
&= \sum_{\bar{s}_h, \bar{p}_h, \bar{s}_{h+1}, \bar{o}_{h+1}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},c}(\bar{s}_h, \bar{p}_h | \widehat{c}_h) \overline{\mathbb{T}}_h(\bar{s}_{h+1} | \bar{s}_h, \gamma_{ct(h),h}(\bar{p}_{ct(h),h}), \gamma_{-ct(h),h}(\bar{p}_{-ct(h),h})) \\
&\quad \overline{\mathbb{O}}_{h+1}(\bar{o}_{h+1} | \bar{s}_{h+1}) [\overline{\mathcal{R}}_h(\bar{s}_h, \gamma_h(\bar{p}_h)) + V_{h+1}^{*,\mathcal{M}}(\widehat{c}_{h+1})] \\
&= \sum_{\bar{s}_h, \bar{p}_h, \bar{s}_{h+1}, \bar{o}_{h+1}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},c}(\bar{s}_h, \bar{p}_h | \widehat{c}_h) \overline{\mathbb{T}}_h(\bar{s}_{h+1} | \bar{s}_h, \gamma_{ct(h),h}(\bar{p}_{ct(h),h}) \overline{\mathbb{O}}_{h+1}(\bar{o}_{h+1} | \bar{s}_{h+1}) [\overline{\mathcal{R}}_h(\bar{s}_h, \gamma_{ct(h),h}(\bar{p}_{ct(h),h})) + V_{h+1}^{*,\mathcal{M}}(\widehat{c}_{h+1})], \\
&\qquad + \sum_{i \neq ct(h)} \sum_{\bar{s}_h, \bar{p}_h} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},c}(\bar{s}_h, \bar{p}_h | \widehat{c}_h) \overline{\mathcal{R}}_{i,h}(\bar{s}_h, \gamma_{i,h}(\bar{p}_{i,h})) := \sum_{i \in [n]} U_{i,h}(\widehat{c}_h, \gamma_{i,h}),
\end{aligned}
$$

where the last step is due to the fact that $\widehat{c}_{h+1} = \widehat{\phi}_{h+1}(\widehat{c}_h, \bar{z}_{h+1})$. Note that we can write $\overline{\mathcal{R}}_h(\bar{s}_h, \bar{a}_h, \bar{p}_h)$ as $\overline{\mathcal{R}}_h(\bar{s}_h, \bar{a}_h)$ since $h$ is even. Then, Equation (E.1) can be solved with respect to each individual $\gamma_{i,h}$ with total complexity $\text{poly}(|\overline{\mathcal{S}}|, |\overline{\mathcal{P}}_h|, |\overline{\mathcal{A}}_h|)$.

- **Factorized structures:** Note that for any $h \in [\overline{H}]$, we can write the reward function of $\mathcal{D}'_{\mathcal{L}}$ as $\overline{\mathcal{R}}(\bar{s}_h, \bar{a}_h, \bar{p}_h) = \sum_{i=1}^n \overline{\mathcal{R}}(\bar{s}_{i,h}, \bar{a}_{i,h}, \bar{p}_{i,h}), \forall \bar{s}_h, \bar{a}_h, \bar{p}_h$. Then, for any $h \in [\overline{H}]$, $\widehat{c}_h \in \widehat{\mathcal{C}}_h, \gamma_h \in \Gamma_h$, we use backward induction to prove that, there exist $n$ functions $\{F_{i,h}\}_{i \in [n]}$ such that

$$
Q_h^{*,\mathcal{M}}(\widehat{c}_h, \gamma_h) = \sum_{i=1}^n F_{i,h}(\widehat{c}_{i,h}, \gamma_{i,h}).
$$

It holds for $h = \overline{H}$ since $Q_{\overline{H}}^{*,\mathcal{M}}(\widehat{c}_{\overline{H}}, \gamma_{\overline{H}}) = \sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{\bar{s}_{i,\overline{H}}, \bar{p}_{i,\overline{H}}} \mathbb{P}_{i,\overline{H}}^{\mathcal{M},c}(\bar{s}_{i,\overline{H}}, \bar{p}_{i,\overline{H}} | \widehat{c}_{i,\overline{H}}) \overline{\mathcal{R}}_{i,\overline{H}}(\bar{s}_{i,\overline{H}}, \gamma_{i,h}(\bar{p}_{i,\overline{H}}), \bar{p}_{i,\overline{H}})$. For any $h \leq \overline{H} - 1$, it holds that

$$
\begin{aligned}
Q_h^{*,\mathcal{M}}(\widehat{c}_h, \gamma_h) &= \sum_{\bar{s}_h, \bar{p}_h, \bar{s}_{h+1}, \bar{o}_{h+1}} \mathbb{P}_h^{\mathcal{M},c}(\bar{s}_h, \bar{p}_h | \widehat{c}_h) \overline{\mathbb{T}}_h(\bar{s}_{h+1} | \bar{s}_h, \gamma_h(\bar{p}_h)) \overline{\mathbb{O}}_{h+1}(\bar{o}_{h+1} | \bar{s}_{h+1}) \\
&\qquad \left[ \sum_{i=1}^n \overline{\mathcal{R}}_{i,h}(\bar{s}_{i,h}, \gamma_{i,h}(\bar{p}_{i,h}), \bar{p}_{i,h}) + F_{i,h+1}(\widehat{c}_{i,h+1}, \widehat{g}_{i,h+1}^*(\widehat{c}_{i,h+1})) \right] \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{\bar{s}_{i,h}, \bar{p}_{i,h}, \bar{s}_{i,h+1}, \bar{o}_{i,h+1}} \mathbb{P}_{i,h}^{\mathcal{M},c}(\bar{s}_{i,h}, \bar{p}_{i,h} | \widehat{c}_{i,h}) \overline{\mathbb{T}}_h(\bar{s}_{i,h+1} | \bar{s}_{i,h}, \gamma_{i,h}(\bar{p}_{i,h})) \\
&\qquad \overline{\mathbb{O}}_{i,h+1}(\bar{o}_{i,h+1} | \bar{s}_{i,h+1}) [\overline{\mathcal{R}}_{i,h}(\bar{s}_{i,h}, \gamma_{i,h}(\bar{p}_{i,h}), \bar{p}_{i,h}) + F_{i,h+1}(\widehat{c}_{i,h+1}, \widehat{g}_{i,h+1}^*(\widehat{c}_{i,h+1}))] \\
&=: \sum_{i=1}^n F_{i,h}(\widehat{c}_{i,h}, \gamma_{i,h}).
\end{aligned}
$$

Then, by induction, we know that it holds for any $h \in [\overline{H}]$. We can define $\widehat{g}_{i,h}^*(\widehat{c}_h) \in \text{argmax}_{\gamma_{i,h} \in \Gamma_{i,h}} F_{i,h}(\widehat{c}_{i,h}, \gamma_{i,h})$, and thus solve Equation (E.1) with complexity $\sum_{i=1}^n \text{poly}(|\overline{\mathcal{S}}_i|, |\overline{\mathcal{A}}_{i,h}|, |\overline{\mathcal{P}}_{i,h}|)$.

This completes the proof. □

Note that, strictly speaking, the time-complexity given in Lemma G.2 does not satisfy Assumption IV.7 yet, since $|\overline{\mathcal{P}}_h|$ may not be necessarily small and polynomial in the LTC parameters

$|\mathcal{S}|, |\mathcal{O}_h|, |\mathcal{A}_h|, |\mathcal{M}_h|, H$. For the examples in §A, more specifically, one can show that $|\overline{\mathcal{P}}_h|$ is indeed polynomial in these parameters (when viewing the delay $d$ of sharing, if it exists, as a constant), which led to the final quasi-polynomial complexity guarantees in Theorem IV.8 and Theorem IV.9 (see their proofs for the formal arguments).

## H. Examples in the Venn Diagram Figure 2b

Here, we show some examples of the areas ①-⑤ in the Venn diagram in Figure 2b. Note that, unless otherwise noted, the diagram here concerns the common scenarios where the transition kernel $\{\mathbb{T}_h\}_{h\in[H]}$ and observation emission $\{\mathbb{O}_h\}_{h\in[H]}$ are *non-degenerate*, i.e., for any agent $i \in [n]$ and timestep $h \in [H]$, the change of state $s_h$ can influence the observation $o_{i,h}$, and the action $a_{i,h}$ can influence the state $s_{h+1}$.

- **①: Multi-agent MDP [43] with historical states.** The Dec-POMDPs satisfying that for any $h \in [H], i \in [n], \mathcal{O}_{i,h} = \mathcal{S}, \mathbb{O}_{i,h}(s|s) = 1, c_h = \{s_{1:h}\}, p_h = \emptyset$ lie in the area ①.

- **②: Uncontrolled state process without any historical information.** The Dec-POMDPs satisfying that for any $h \in [H], i \in [n], s_h, a_h, a'_h, \mathbb{T}_h(\cdot|s_h, a_h) = \mathbb{T}_h(\cdot|s_h, a'_h), c_h = \emptyset, p_{i,h} = \{o_{i,h}\}$ lie in the area ②.

- **③: Dec-POMDPs with sQC information structure, perfect recall, and Assumptions III.5 and III.7.** One-step delayed information sharing (**Example 1** in §A) lies in this area.

- **④: State controlled by one controller with no sharing and only observability of the controller.** We consider a Dec-POMDP $\mathcal{D}$. The state dynamics are controlled by only one agent (for convenience, agent 1), and only agent 1 has observability, i.e., $\mathbb{T}_h(\cdot|s_h, a_{1,h}, a_{-1,h}) = \mathbb{T}_h(\cdot|s_h, a_{1,h}, a'_{-1,h})$ for all $s_h, a_{1,h}, a_{-1,h}, a'_{-1,h}$, and $\mathcal{O}_{-1,h} = \emptyset$. There is no information sharing, i.e., $c_h = \emptyset, p_{1,h} = \{o_{1:h}, a_{1:h-1}\}, p_{j,h} = \{a_{j,1:h-1}\}, \forall j \neq 1$. Then, $\forall j \neq 1, h_1 < h_2 \in [H]$, agent $(1, h_1)$ does not influence $(j, h_2)$, since $\tau_{j,h_2} = \{a_{j,1:h_2-1}\}$ is not influenced by agent $(1, h_1)$. Therefore, $\mathcal{D}$ is sQC and has perfect recall, but $\mathcal{D}$ does not have SI-CIBs, since the underlying state $s_h$ is influenced by $g_{1,1:h-1}$. This is essentially because $\mathcal{D}$ does not satisfy Assumption III.7. Thus, $\mathcal{D}$ lies in the area ④.

- **⑤: One-step delayed observation sharing and two-step delayed action sharing.** The Dec-POMDPs satisfying that for any $h \in [H], i \in [n], c_h = \{o_{1:h-1}, a_{1:h-2}\}, p_{i,h} = \{a_{i,h-1}, o_{i,h}\}$ lie in the area ⑤.

# I. Additional Figures

The additional figures, Figure 5 and Figure 6, illustrate the paradigm and the timeline of the LTC problems considered in this paper.

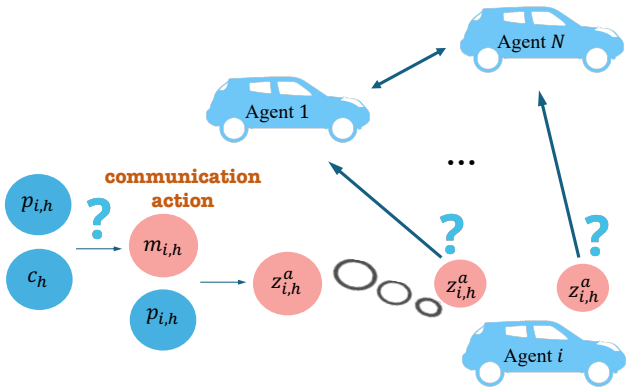



Figure 5: Illustrating the learning-to-communicate problem considered in this paper.

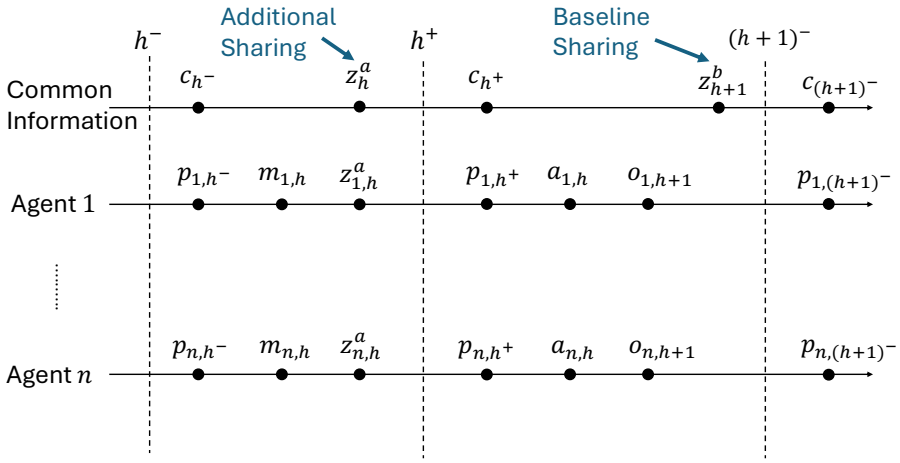



Figure 6: Timeline of the information sharing and information evolution protocols in the learning-to-communicate problem considered.